

Apex Corruption causes Violent Protests*

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Abstract

We document that *apex* corruption scandals—corrupt acts implicating top-level politicians—cause immediate and persistent increases in violent protests. Using a panel of 176 corruption scandals across 23 countries in Latin America from 2008 to 2018, merged with daily protest counts, we show that the daily count of violent protests rises sharply after scandals implicating a President or Other Apex official—by about 0.06 protests per country-day in the month following disclosure, roughly 1.7 times the pre-scandal baseline—while scandals implicating non-apex officials produce no such immediate response, and a pooled test rejects equality of the two effects. The response appears within a week of disclosure and persists even in a four month window. It is specific to apex corruption: neither football match losses nor currency depreciations, two other high-salience national shocks, move violent protests. Our findings identify a high-frequency, high-magnitude channel through which corruption shapes the political environment in democracies.

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1 Introduction

Political violence is among the most consequential outcomes a democracy can experience. Civil unrest disrupts economic activity, displaces investment, and—when met with state violence in return—erodes the social contract that legitimizes the regime. An influential economic literature has linked political violence to economic shocks (Miguel et al. 2004; McGuirk and Burke 2020), to commodity rents and network structure (König et al. 2017; Dube and Vargas 2013), to the foundations of state capacity (Besley and Persson 2011), and in recent work to abrupt withdrawals of foreign assistance (Rohner et al. 2026). Related work shows that protests themselves can produce durable political effects (Madestam et al. 2013; Bursztyn et al. 2021). The contribution of political shocks to events that change citizens’ beliefs about who governs them, however, has received considerably less attention. In this paper we argue that disclosures of apex corruption are one such shock, and that the behavioral consequences for political violence are large, immediate, and persistent.

Corruption has been long studied, with known costs for growth and public goods provision (Mauro 1995; Treisman 2007; Olken 2007; Olken and Pande 2012; Glaeser and Saks 2006). In the past two decades, citizens’ perceptions of corruption prevalence have risen (Cantoni et al. 2024), and corruption scandals associated to *apex* politicians have drawn more attention from news outlets in recent years (Rivera et al. 2024); perhaps unsurprisingly due to the expansion of social media, which reduces the cost of diffusing information and enables news outlets to reach broader audiences (Enikolopov et al. 2018; Tufekci 2024; DellaVigna and Kaplan 2007). Even though exposing corruption scandals on news outlets can have positive desired effects, such as political accountability or crackdowns of corruption networks (Ferraz and Finan 2011a; Arias et al. 2019, 2022), it can also have negative undesired effects on democratic values (Ajzenman 2021; Rivera et al. 2024) and away from the polling booths. Public exposure of malfeasance by sitting officials changes what citizens believe about who governs them and about the rules under which the government operates. The most consequential corruption-related political moments of the last decade, such as Brazil’s Lava Jato¹, were mobilization events, not electoral ones.

We document that apex corruption—corrupt acts implicating top-level politicians—triggers immediate and persistent increases in violent protests. Using a hand-curated panel of 176 corruption scandals across 23 Latin American countries from 2008 to 2018, merged with daily protest counts from the Mass Mobilization (MM) project (Clark and Regan 2016), we establish four facts. First, the daily count of violent protests rises sharply following scandals implicating a President or Other Apex official, while the count of peaceful protests is largely unaffected; scandals implicating Congressmen,

¹See [this video](#) for more information on the scandal.

lower judiciary, and other non-apex officials leave protest patterns broadly unchanged, and we can reject that the two effects are equal. Second, the effect appears within a week of disclosure and the point estimate remains positive even four months later, with no evidence of pre-trends. Third, the response is specific to apex corruption: neither national-team football losses (see e.g., Depetris-Chauvin et al. 2020) nor currency depreciations—two other high-salience, plausibly as-good-as-randomly-timed national shocks—move violent protests. Fourth, exploring heterogeneity by the 2008 level of democracy, the response is present across countries and, if anything, somewhat larger and more persistent in higher-democracy countries, though the high- versus low-democracy difference is not statistically significant.

2 Method

2.1 Study Design and Measures

Our empirical analyses exploit the randomness of corruption scandal disclosures in Latin American news outlets between 2008 and 2018. In particular, we use an interrupted time-series design in which we compare protest occurrences in countries with scandals before and after the scandal occurs. Our analysis dataset is created by: (i) Scraping the Twitter accounts from news outlets in Latin America to identify the calendar date in which a scandal in a given country is first reported², (ii) create an event-window of $T \in \{30, 120\}$ days before and after the scandal, (iii) merge the country-day count of protests from the MM data to create a ‘scandal-protest’ dataset for a given country in a given calendar-date window, and lastly, (iv) append all such scandal-protest datasets to build the analysis dataset.

The MM dataset is available for the period 1990–2020, and it includes information on the date, size, and location of any episode in which 50 or more protesters publicly demonstrate against the State. If a protest lasts X days, we code the occurrence of a protest at date $t, t+1, \dots, t+X-1$. If the same protest is associated with more than one date (e.g., because the news source for the protest cannot accurately identify whether it is a continued or a new protest), then we keep the date of the earliest protest. For a protest to be classified as “violent”, “[t]he violence could include anything from riotous behavior that destroys property to shooting at the police or military” (Clark and Regan 2016). Our main outcome is the number of protests occurring in a given country-date. We focus on the years 2008–2018, given that our corruption scandals data is available for those years.

Importantly, our recollection of scandals allows us to identify the position of the implicated politician. We then look at the scandals and manually classify them in three categories: (i) “President” includes

²We keep the date of the first news report to (a) be able to estimate the effect of a scoop, and (b) avoid double-counting a scandal due to follow-up news reports on it.

scandals in which the implicated official is a President (current or former), (ii) “Other Apex” includes scandals in which the implicated official is either a Governor or Supreme Court Justice, and (iii) “Non-Apex” includes scandals in which the implicated official is a Congressman, lower judiciary, or other lower-rank officials. Throughout, we group the President and Other Apex scandals together (“apex”; 63 scandals) and contrast them with the Non-Apex scandals (113 scandals).

We use Ordinary Least Squares (OLS) to estimate the following equation on each of our Apex and Non-Apex samples:

$$Y_{c(s)t} = \beta \mathbb{1}\{t \geq \text{Scandal Date}_{c(s)}\} + \alpha_d + \lambda_m + \theta_{cy} + \varepsilon_{c(s)t} \quad (1)$$

where α_d denote day of the week fixed effects, λ_m denote month of the year fixed effects, θ_{cy} denote country-year fixed effects, $\text{Scandal Date}_{c(s)}$ is the date in which corruption scandal s in country c occurs, Y_{ct} denotes the outcome of interest in country c at date t , and $\varepsilon_{c(s)t}$ is an idiosyncratic error term.

To trace dynamics we replace $\mathbb{1}\{t \geq \text{Scandal Date}_{c(s)}\}$ in Equation 1 with a saturated set of 30-day bin indicators for four months before/after the scandal. The reference category in each time-to-event graph is the bin immediately before disclosure (i.e., $w_{s,t} \in [-30, -1]$).

The identification assumption we rely on for our estimates to be interpreted as causal is that conditional on country-year, month-of-year, and day-of-week fixed effects, the within-year date of disclosure of a scandal is as-good-as-randomly assigned in relation to the protest baseline of the country. The country-year fixed effects absorb every source of country-year-level confounding such as pre-existing political instability, electoral calendars, or institutional reforms. The day-of-week and month-of-year fixed effects absorb weekly and seasonal cycles in protest activity.

3 Results

3.1 Apex corruption increases violent protests

Table 2 reports OLS estimates of the post-scandal effect on violent and peaceful protests, split by the political rank of the implicated official. Panel A restricts the sample to Apex scandals; Panel B restricts to Non-Apex scandals. Each panel reports eight outcome–window cells: violent and peaceful protest *counts* on the ± 30 - and ± 120 -day windows, and the corresponding violent/peaceful *shares*³. The contrast is stark. In the Apex panel, the daily count of violent protests rises by 0.060 per country-day

³We define the share outcomes at the country-day level by dividing the number of violent (peaceful) protests by the total protests, and impute a 0 if there are no protests in a given day. Given that there is only one protest in most cases for country-days in which there is mobilization, our outcomes are highly correlated and the corresponding estimates are very similar.

in the ± 30 -day window ($p < 0.01$)—about 1.7 times the pre-scandal baseline of 0.036—and by 0.021 in the ± 120 -day window ($p < 0.1$). In the Non-Apex panel the immediate (± 30 -day) violent effect is essentially zero (0.000), with only a smaller, delayed increase of 0.016 at the ± 120 -day horizon ($p < 0.05$). Strikingly, peaceful protests move little in either panel at either horizon.

To make the Apex-vs-Non-Apex contrast explicit, Table 1 pools the two subsamples into a single specification and formally tests whether the post-scandal effect differs between them. For each outcome and window we estimate

$$Y_{c(s)t} = \beta_{\text{Apex}} \text{Post}_{st} \mathbf{1}\{\text{Apex}_s\} + \beta_{\text{NA}} \text{Post}_{st} \mathbf{1}\{\text{Non-Apex}_s\} + \alpha_d + \lambda_m + \theta_{cy} + \varepsilon_{c(s)t},$$

where Apex_s ($\text{Non} - \text{Apex}_s$) indicates a Apex (Non-Apex) scandal, and the row “ p -value: Pres+Other Apex = Non-Apex” reports the two-sided p -value for $H_0 : \beta_{\text{Apex}} = \beta_{\text{Non-Apex}}$. In this pooled specification the immediate (± 30 -day) violent-protest effect is 0.048 for apex scandals ($p < 0.01$) versus -0.003 for non-apex scandals, and we reject equality of the two ($p = 0.020$). At the ± 120 -day horizon both are positive (0.022 for apex, $p < 0.05$; 0.012 for non-apex), though they are no longer statistically distinguishable ($p = 0.411$). The *immediate* violent response to corruption is thus concentrated among apex scandals.

Table 1. Apex scandals cause violent mobilization while Non-Apex scandals do not.

	± 30 -Day Window		± 60 -Day Window		± 90 -Day Window	
	(1) Violent Protests	(2) Peaceful Protests	(3) Violent Protests	(4) Peaceful Protests	(5) Violent Protests	(6) Peaceful Protests
Post $\times$ Apex	0.052*** (0.019)	-0.007 (0.013)	0.040*** (0.014)	-0.008 (0.009)	0.027** (0.011)	-0.005 (0.009)
Post $\times$ Non-Apex	-0.004 (0.008)	0.019 (0.013)	0.004 (0.007)	0.006 (0.013)	0.004 (0.007)	-0.002 (0.010)
p -value: Apex = Non-Apex	0.025	0.238	0.044	0.395	0.086	0.809
p -value: Apex > Non-Apex (one-sided)	0.012	0.881	0.022	0.803	0.043	0.595
Mean (Pre-Scandal)	0.020	0.053	0.021	0.056	0.024	0.057
Observations	10736	10736	21296	21296	31856	31856
Number of Scandals	176	176	176	176	176	176
R-squared	0.171	0.474	0.158	0.396	0.134	0.348

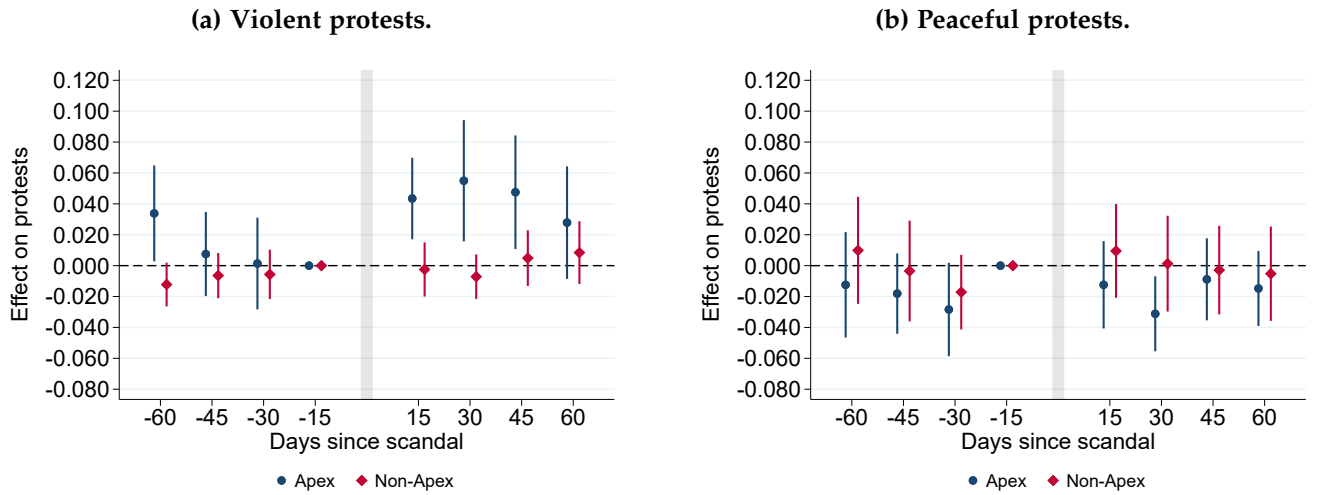
OLS estimates of β_{Apex} and $\beta_{\text{Non-Apex}}$ from the pooled specification above, on the same eight outcome–window cells as Table 2. The row “ p -value: Pres+Other Apex = Non-Apex” reports the two-sided p -value for $H_0 : \beta_{\text{Apex}} = \beta_{\text{Non-Apex}}$. Standard errors in parentheses are clustered at the country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin level. Same fixed effects and sample period as Table 2. Significance: * $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

3.2 Protest dynamics around apex corruption scandals

Figure 1 traces the dynamics of the effect, replacing the post-scandal indicator with a fully saturated set of 15-day event-time bin indicators over the ± 60 -day window, and estimated separately on the two

subsamples of Table 2. In the Apex subsample, violent protests (??) show arguably no pre-trend and then jump at disclosure, remaining elevated in the month that follows before converging back to the pre-scandal levels; peaceful protests (??) show no immediate increase, but they do however slightly increase in the months that follow, though by a small magnitude. In the Non-Apex subsample, violent protests (??) do not increase by large amounts with scandal disclosures, and the response is delayed. Overall, Non-Apex scandals cause no effects—positive or negative—on peaceful protests (??). The absence of a pre-trend in every panel supports the identifying assumption that the within-year timing of disclosure is as good as random relative to the protest baseline.

Figure 1. Protest dynamics: Apex vs. Non-Apex (± 60 -day window, 15-day bins).



OLS estimates of the event-time coefficients $\{\beta_k^{\text{Apex}}\}$ (navy circles) and $\{\beta_k^{\text{NA}}\}$ (maroon diamonds) from a pooled event-study specification that interacts 15-day event-time bin indicators with the apex and non-apex flags, estimated *jointly* on the pooled sample. The bin immediately preceding disclosure ($w_{s,t} \in [-15, -1]$) is the omitted reference for each group; the faint vertical band marks the disclosure cutoff. Vertical bars are 90% confidence intervals; standard errors clustered at country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin. An observation is a country-scandal-date. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

3.3 The protest response is specific to apex corruption

Is the violent-protest response a general reaction to salient national news, or is it specific to apex corruption? To answer this question, Table 2 benchmarks the corruption effect against two other high-salience national shocks whose timing is plausibly as-good-as-random with respect to the protest baseline: national-team football (soccer) match losses and currency depreciation episodes. Each shock is estimated using Equation 1 and the same eight outcome-window columns (counts and shares), but changing the post-scandal indicator for an indicator of a national football team loss, or a month-to-month depreciation of the exchange rate of more than 5%. The table reproduces Panels A and B of

Table 2 so that both headline corruption regressions can be read directly against the two benchmarks. The apex-corruption effect on violent protests in the ± 30 -day window (0.060, $p < 0.01$) is an order of magnitude larger than—and statistically unlike—the corresponding football (0.006) and currency-depreciation (0.004) estimates, neither of which is distinguishable from zero. The mobilization response is thus specific to apex corruption, not a generic reaction to salient national events.

Table 2. Violent protests increase after apex corruption scandal disclosures.

	± 30 -Day Window		± 60 -Day Window		± 90 -Day Window	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
	Violent	Peaceful	Violent	Peaceful	Violent	Peaceful
Panel A: Apex						
Post Event	0.055*** (0.016)	0.005 (0.009)	0.040*** (0.014)	-0.001 (0.008)	0.019 (0.013)	0.005 (0.010)
Mean (Pre-Event)	0.028	0.015	0.037	0.019	0.045	0.021
Observations	3843	3843	7623	7623	11403	11403
Number of Events	63	63	63	63	63	63
R-squared	0.290	0.076	0.264	0.050	0.253	0.077
Panel B: Non-Apex						
Post Event	-0.000 (0.005)	0.010 (0.010)	0.009 (0.006)	0.001 (0.012)	0.013* (0.007)	-0.006 (0.010)
Mean (Pre-Event)	0.017	0.075	0.012	0.076	0.012	0.076
Observations	6893	6893	13673	13673	20453	20453
Number of Events	113	113	113	113	113	113
R-squared	0.113	0.564	0.102	0.468	0.084	0.404
Panel C: Football match losses						
Post Event	0.006 (0.005)	0.002 (0.012)	0.010 (0.006)	0.005 (0.013)	0.005 (0.006)	0.011 (0.013)
Mean (Pre-Event)	0.009	0.043	0.013	0.036	0.010	0.036
Observations	10004	10004	19844	19844	29684	29684
Number of Events	164	164	164	164	164	164
R-squared	0.674	0.598	0.646	0.393	0.529	0.344
Panel D: Currency depreciations						
Post Event	0.004 (0.010)	-0.003 (0.008)	-0.003 (0.007)	-0.012* (0.007)	-0.007 (0.006)	-0.012* (0.006)
Mean (Pre-Event)	0.025	0.027	0.024	0.030	0.027	0.030
Observations	9638	9638	19118	19118	28598	28598
Number of Events	158	158	158	158	158	158
R-squared	0.331	0.275	0.348	0.169	0.346	0.144

OLS estimates of β from Equation 1. Columns are violent and peaceful protest counts at four event-window widths: ± 30 days (cols. 1–2), ± 60 (cols. 3–4), ± 90 (cols. 5–6) and ± 120 (cols. 7–8). Panel A: Apex scandals (President, Governors and Supreme Court Justices; 63 scandals). Panel B: Non-Apex scandals (Congressmen, lower judiciary, and other officials; 113 scandals). Panel C: national-team football match losses. Panel D: currency depreciation episodes (a month-on-month depreciation of the exchange rate of more than 5%). An observation is a country-day inside the event window of the corresponding event. All specifications include country-by-year, month-of-year, and day-of-week fixed effects; standard errors (in parentheses) are clustered at the country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin level. “Mean (Pre-Event)” is the average outcome over the same $\pm$ window as the column (the 30 days before the event for the ± 30 columns, the 60 days before for the ± 60 columns, and so on). Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded. Significance: * $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

3.4 Heterogeneity by the level of democracy

A natural question is whether these patterns of mobilization are driven by the country’s democratic environment. There are at least two related, yet opposite, hypotheses about how democratic level of a country interacts with mobilization patterns. On the one hand, citizens in countries with higher levels of democracy may not mobilize, since strong democratic institutions in their countries can punish corrupt officials and remove them from office once proven guilty. On the other hand, precisely because citizens in highly democratic countries have higher standards for accountability, they may choose to mobilize in order to call democratic institutions into action. Our evidence suggests this second behavior is more likely the explanation.

Table 3 splits the panel of countries at the median of their 2008 level of democracy—measured by V-Dem’s Electoral Democracy Index (Coppedge et al. 2024)—and interacts the post-scandal indicator with the resulting above-/below-median classification. The violent-protest response is positive in both groups but, if anything, larger and more persistent in the *above*-median (higher-democracy) countries: the ± 30 -day effect is 0.021 ($p < 0.05$) in higher-democracy countries versus 0.009 ($p < 0.1$) in lower-democracy ones, and at the ± 120 -day horizon it is 0.024 ($p < 0.01$) versus 0.005 (not significant). However, we cannot statistically distinguish the two ($p = 0.245$ and 0.115 for the ± 30 - and ± 120 -day violent-count effects), so this heterogeneity is suggestive rather than conclusive.

Table 3. Effect by 2008 level of democracy.

	± 30 -Day Window		± 60 -Day Window		± 90 -Day Window		± 120 -Day Window	
	(1) Violent Protests	(2) Peaceful Protests	(3) Violent Protests	(4) Peaceful Protests	(5) Violent Protests	(6) Peaceful Protests	(7) Violent Protests	(8) Peaceful Protests
Post $\times$ High Democracy (2008)	0.021** (0.008)	0.013 (0.008)	0.023** (0.010)	0.003 (0.009)	0.019** (0.009)	-0.004 (0.008)	0.024*** (0.008)	-0.008 (0.008)
Post $\times$ Low Democracy (2008)	0.009* (0.005)	0.005 (0.012)	0.009* (0.005)	-0.002 (0.016)	0.004 (0.007)	-0.002 (0.013)	0.004 (0.009)	-0.010 (0.012)
p-value: High = Low	0.245	0.539	0.238	0.807	0.183	0.896	0.116	0.891
Mean (Pre-Scandal)	0.020	0.053	0.021	0.056	0.024	0.057	0.023	0.057
Observations	10736	10736	21296	21296	31856	31856	42416	42416
Number of Scandals	176	176	176	176	176	176	176	176
R-squared	0.160	0.473	0.154	0.396	0.133	0.348	0.128	0.300

OLS estimates of β_{High} and β_{Low} (Post $\times$ above-/at-or-below-median 2008 democracy) on the same eight outcome-window cells as Table 2. Countries are split at the median of V-Dem’s `v2x_polyarchy` in 2008 (16 panel countries; Venezuela excluded). The row “p-value: High = Low” tests $H_0 : \beta_{\text{High}} = \beta_{\text{Low}}$. Same fixed effects, clustering, and sample as Table 2. Significance: * $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

4 Discussion

The evidence we have presented suggests citizens do not respond uniformly to all types of corruption: they respond sharply, immediately and durably when the implicated official is at the apex of the political spectrum, and they barely respond when the implicated official sits at the lower tier of the hierarchy. Furthermore, the response concentrates on violent protests and persists even in a four month window. The peaceful margin stays essentially flat over both horizons and regardless of whether the scandal implicates an Apex or Non-Apex politician. Our findings underscore the fact that corruption is a tangible behavioral shock to the local (and perhaps even regional) political environment, not just an attitudinal one. The stakes citizens hold in the continuation in office of a corrupt official appear to govern whether citizens mobilize, and how they do so. The joint pattern—a persistent rise in violent protests with no corresponding change on the peaceful margin—is consistent with, though our design does not establish, citizens turning to violent rather than peaceful channels when a scandal undercuts their confidence in the officials meant to be held accountable.

Our findings contribute to three literatures. First, the economics-of-conflict literature has documented that political violence responds to economic shocks (König et al. 2017; McGuirk and Burke 2020; Dube and Vargas 2013; Besley and Persson 2011; Berman et al. 2011; Rohner et al. 2026). We introduce a *political* shock—public disclosure of apex corruption—and show that it produces mobilization responses of comparable magnitude to the ones caused by economic shocks. Second, the corruption and accountability literature has documented that disclosures of malfeasance change voting behavior (Ferraz and Finan 2008, 2011a,b; Avis et al. 2018; Arias et al. 2019). The slow electoral horizon has tended to obscure that the same disclosures can have very fast, non-electoral consequences (Madestam et al. 2013; Bursztyn et al. 2021). Our high-frequency design uncovers a channel through which apex corruption shapes the political environment in democracies within days of public disclosures, well before subsequent elections come into play. Third, the protest channel is the behavioral complement of the attitudinal evidence from our companion paper (Rivera et al. 2024), which documents that apex corruption scandals erode support for democracy and democratic institutions, and also reduce political participation.

Our results help reconcile part of the mixed results in the existing literature on the political consequences of corruption disclosures. Studies of local level corruption have produced muted estimates of disclosure’s electoral consequences, with some finding modest accountability gains in Brazil and Spain (Ferraz and Finan 2008, 2011a; Avis et al. 2018; Costas-Pérez et al. 2012) and others finding null or even demobilizing effects (Chong et al. 2015; Anduiza et al. 2013; Pavão 2018; Arias et al. 2022). We argue that the dispersion in municipal estimates reflects the limited political stakes at

that level. In particular, when the implicated official is one of many municipal officeholders, citizens have weaker incentives to incur the costs of mobilization. Within our sample, scandals implicating Congressmen, lower judiciary and lower rank officials have *immediate* (30-day) post-scandal effects on violent protests statistically indistinguishable from zero, whereas the effect of scandals implicating a President or Other Apex official is large and immediate.

A “salience of stakeholders” view rationalizes this (Acemoglu and Robinson 2006, 2012; Jha 2013; Jha and Shayo 2019; Jha 2022). Citizens’ political behavior responds to the political weight of *what* is being disclosed. Apex corruption, thus, affects citizens’ perceived stakes of the political bargain, particularly when the implicated official is at the apex of the political hierarchy. The contrast between high-stakes apex scandals and low-stakes lower-officials scandals parallels the contrast between high-stakes elections and routine governance in studies of political accountability (Martinez-Bravo et al. 2022). Notably, this response does not require weak institutions to appear: it is present across our sample and, if anything, somewhat stronger in the more democratic countries, where citizens plausibly hold higher expectations of accountability—and enjoy greater latitude to voice them—when those expectations are violated (Acemoglu et al. 2019, 2024; Depetris-Chauvin et al. 2020).

Our empirical analyses have some limitations worth noting. Our identification strategy relies on the timing of apex corruption disclosures, not on the timing of the corrupt act itself. If the timing of disclosures is correlated with pre-existing political conditions that affect mobilization (violent or peaceful), our estimates could then be biased. Somewhat reassuringly, the pre-scandal estimates in Figure 1 show no evidence of pre-existing trends in mobilization. A second limitation comes from the fact that the MM dataset is constructed by looking at news sources reporting on mobilization events. Small protests may thus be underreported as they are not big enough to draw media attention, or protests occurring in geographically remote areas may also be left out. This would induce measurement error in our estimates, but if anything this would bias our estimates toward zero. And finally, our scandal sample is limited to Latin American democracies in the 2008–2018 period, thus limiting the external validity of our findings insofar as different regions in the world may mobilize differently in response to corruption scandals. One could also expect different results when shortening/expanding the time scope of the analysis if one believes that the cumulative amount of apex corruption episodes affect the extent to which citizens mobilize.

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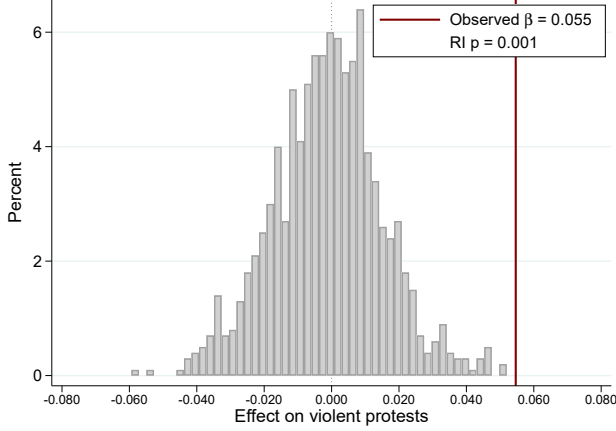
Supplementary Materials

S1 Randomization inference by apex-partition subsample

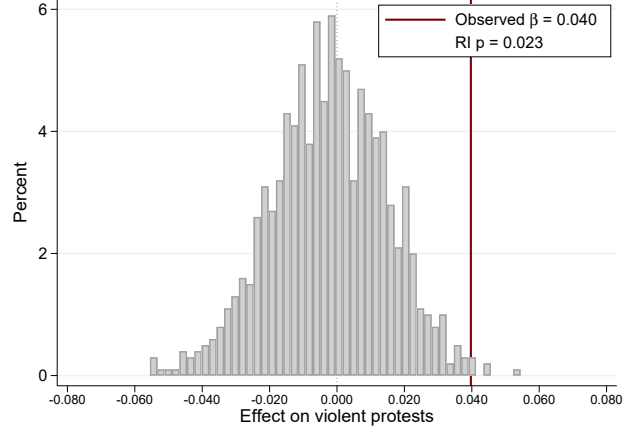
We complement the headline estimates with a randomization-inference (permutation) test, run separately on the two subsamples of Table 2. In each of 1,000 replications and for each scandal we draw a placebo disclosure date uniformly at random within the scandal’s original country-year, rejecting any draw whose $\pm T$ -day window would overlap a real disclosure date in the same country (with an unconditional fallback over all countries and 2008–2018 dates after 20 failed within-country-year attempts). We rebuild the $\pm T$ -day event-window panel around the accepted placebo dates and re-estimate the headline OLS specification. Figures S1–S4 plot the resulting placebo $\hat{\beta}$ distributions; the maroon vertical line marks the observed $\hat{\beta}$ from the corresponding cell of Table 2, and the legend reports that observed $\hat{\beta}$ together with the two-sided randomization-inference p -value. For violent protests the observed effect sits in the upper tail—most sharply for the Apex subsample—while for the Non-Apex subsample and for peaceful protests it lies within the placebo mass.

Figure S1. Randomization inference, Apex subsample: violent protests.

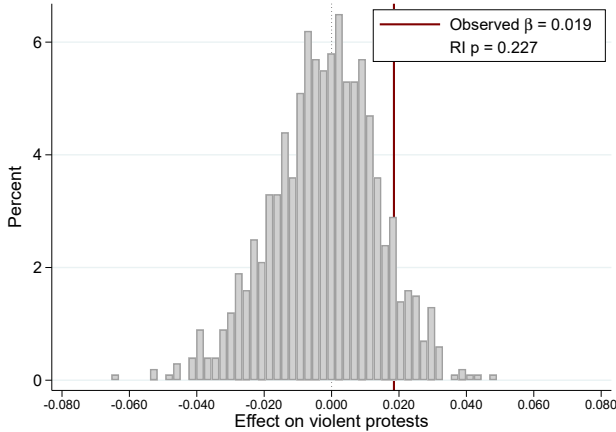
(a) ± 30 -day window.



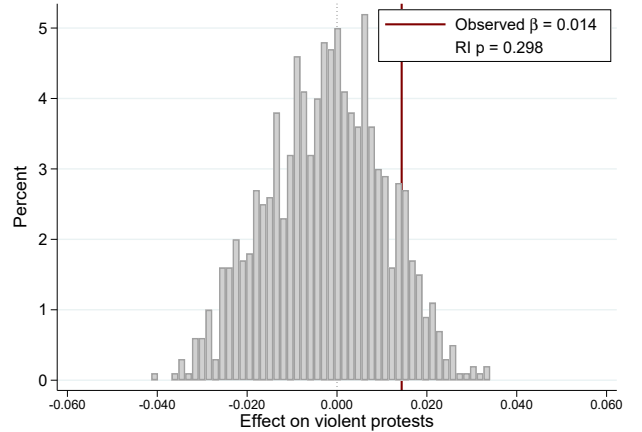
(b) ± 60 -day window.



(c) ± 90 -day window.

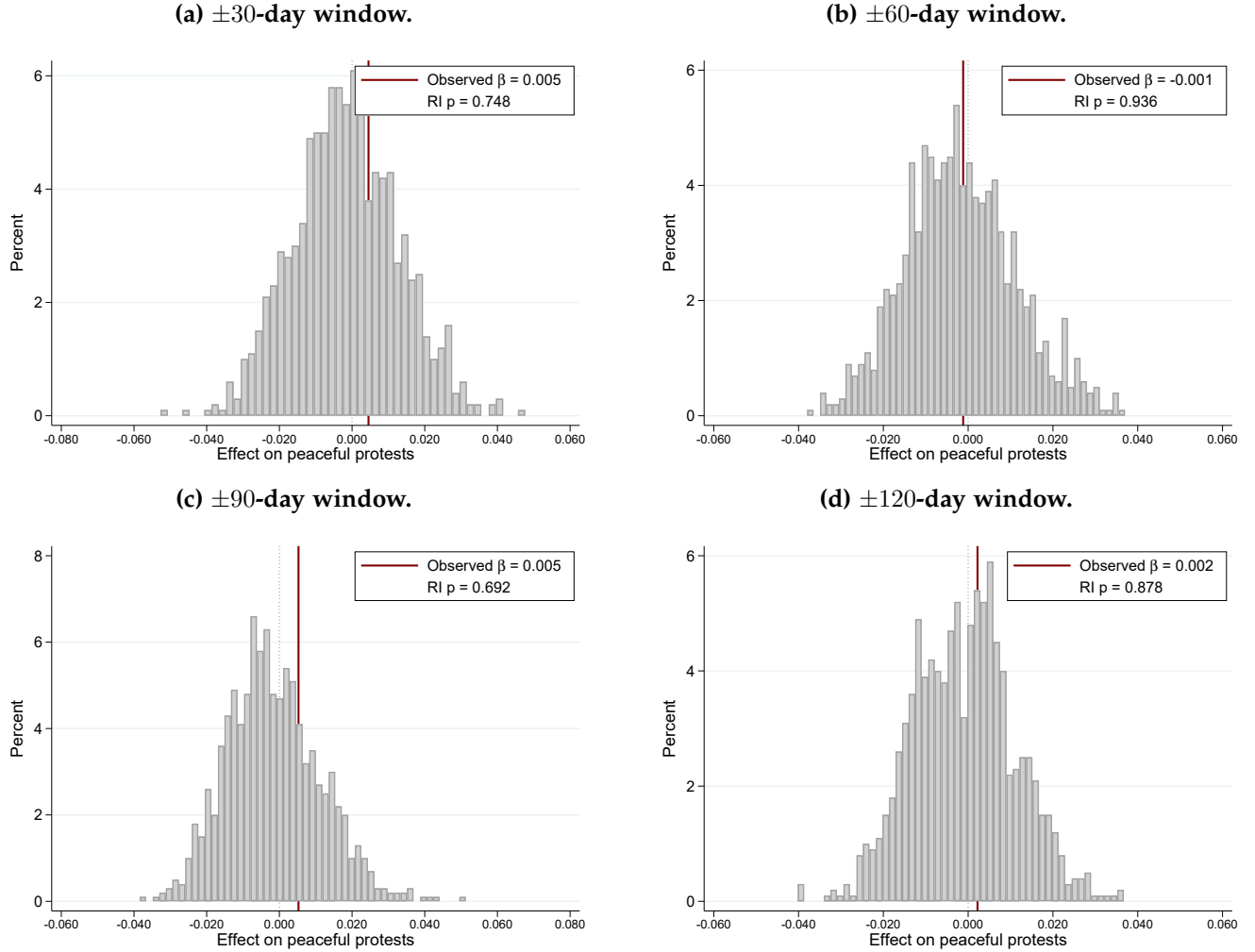


(d) ± 120 -day window.



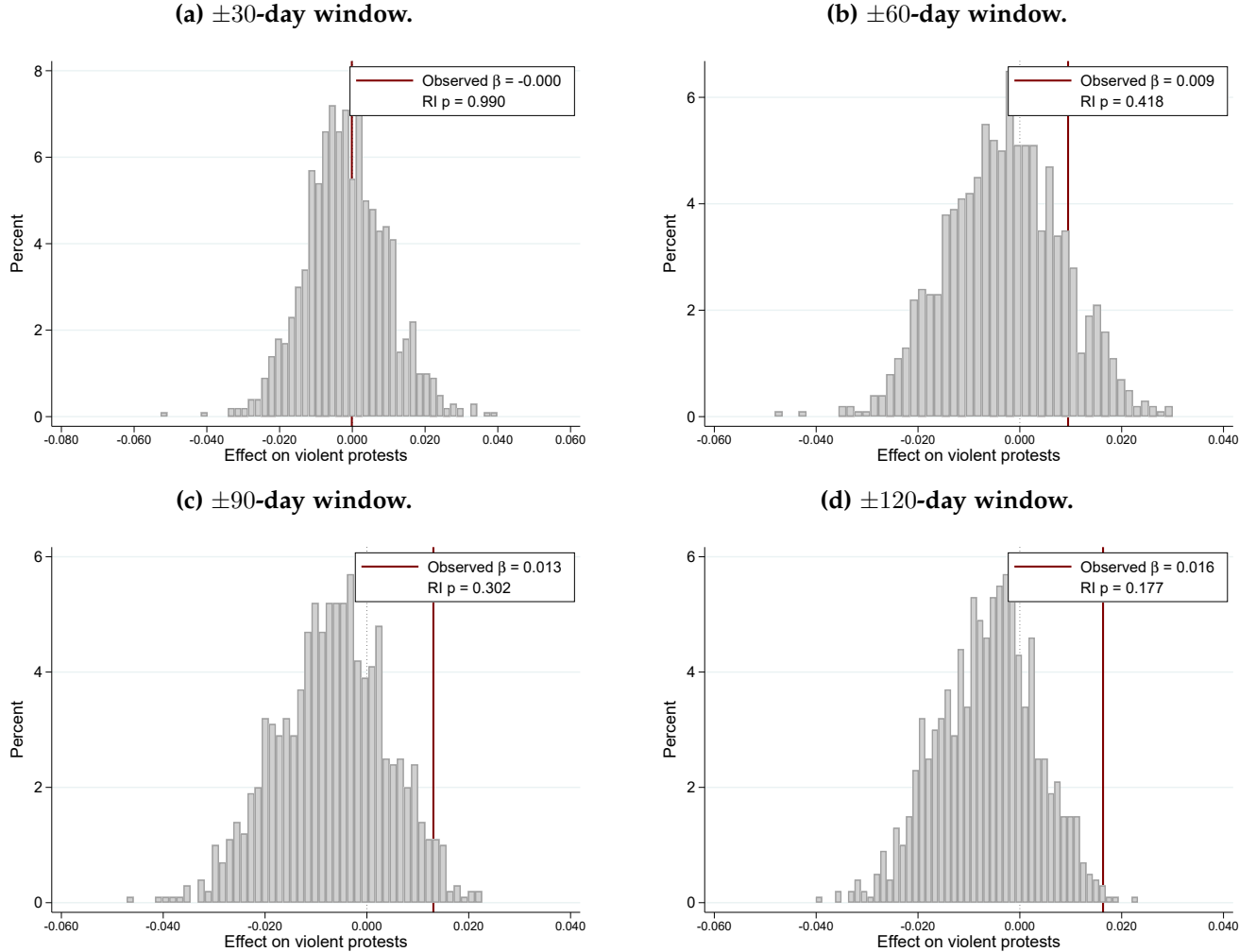
Randomization inference for violent protests on the Apex subsample. Each histogram is the distribution of 1,000 placebo estimates of the post-scandal effect, obtained by redrawing each of the 63 apex scandals' disclosure dates at random within its own country-year and re-estimating Equation 1 on the $\pm T$ event window; the four panels correspond to $T \in \{30, 60, 90, 120\}$ days. The x-axis is scaled to span both the placebo distribution and the observed estimate. The maroon vertical line marks the observed $\hat{\beta}$ on the apex subsample at the corresponding window; the top-right legend reports that observed $\hat{\beta}$ and the two-sided randomization-inference p -value, the share of placebo estimates with $|\hat{\beta}_{\text{placebo}}| \geq |\hat{\beta}_{\text{obs}}|$. Standard errors clustered at country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

Figure S2. Randomization inference, Apex subsample: peaceful protests.



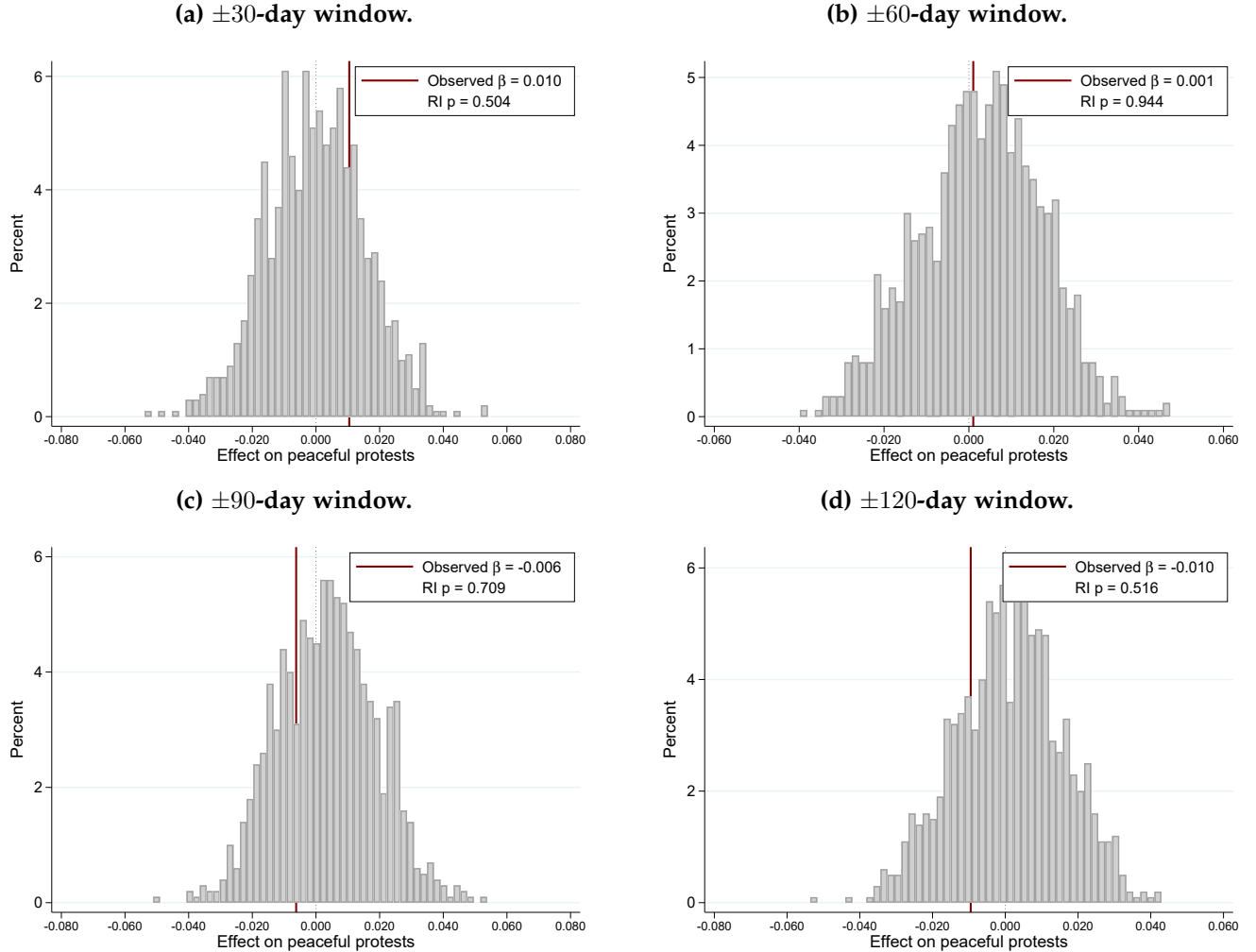
Randomization inference for peaceful protests on the Apex subsample. Each histogram is the distribution of 1,000 placebo estimates of the post-scandal effect, obtained by redrawing each of the 63 apex scandals' disclosure dates at random within its own country-year and re-estimating Equation 1 on the $\pm T$ event window; the four panels correspond to $T \in \{30, 60, 90, 120\}$ days. The maroon vertical line marks the observed $\hat{\beta}$ on the apex subsample at the corresponding window; the top-right legend reports that observed $\hat{\beta}$ and the two-sided randomization-inference p -value, the share of placebo estimates with $|\hat{\beta}_{\text{placebo}}| \geq |\hat{\beta}_{\text{obs}}|$. Standard errors clustered at country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

Figure S3. Randomization inference, Non-Apex subsample: violent protests.



Randomization inference for violent protests on the Non-Apex subsample. Each histogram is the distribution of 1,000 placebo estimates of the post-scandal effect, obtained by redrawing each of the 113 non-apex scandals' disclosure dates at random within its own country-year and re-estimating Equation 1 on the $\pm T$ event window; the four panels correspond to $T \in \{30, 60, 90, 120\}$ days. The maroon vertical line marks the observed $\hat{\beta}$ on the non-apex subsample at the corresponding window; the top-right legend reports that observed $\hat{\beta}$ and the two-sided randomization-inference p -value, the share of placebo estimates with $|\hat{\beta}_{\text{placebo}}| \geq |\hat{\beta}_{\text{obs}}|$. Standard errors clustered at country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

Figure S4. Randomization inference, Non-Apex subsample: peaceful protests.

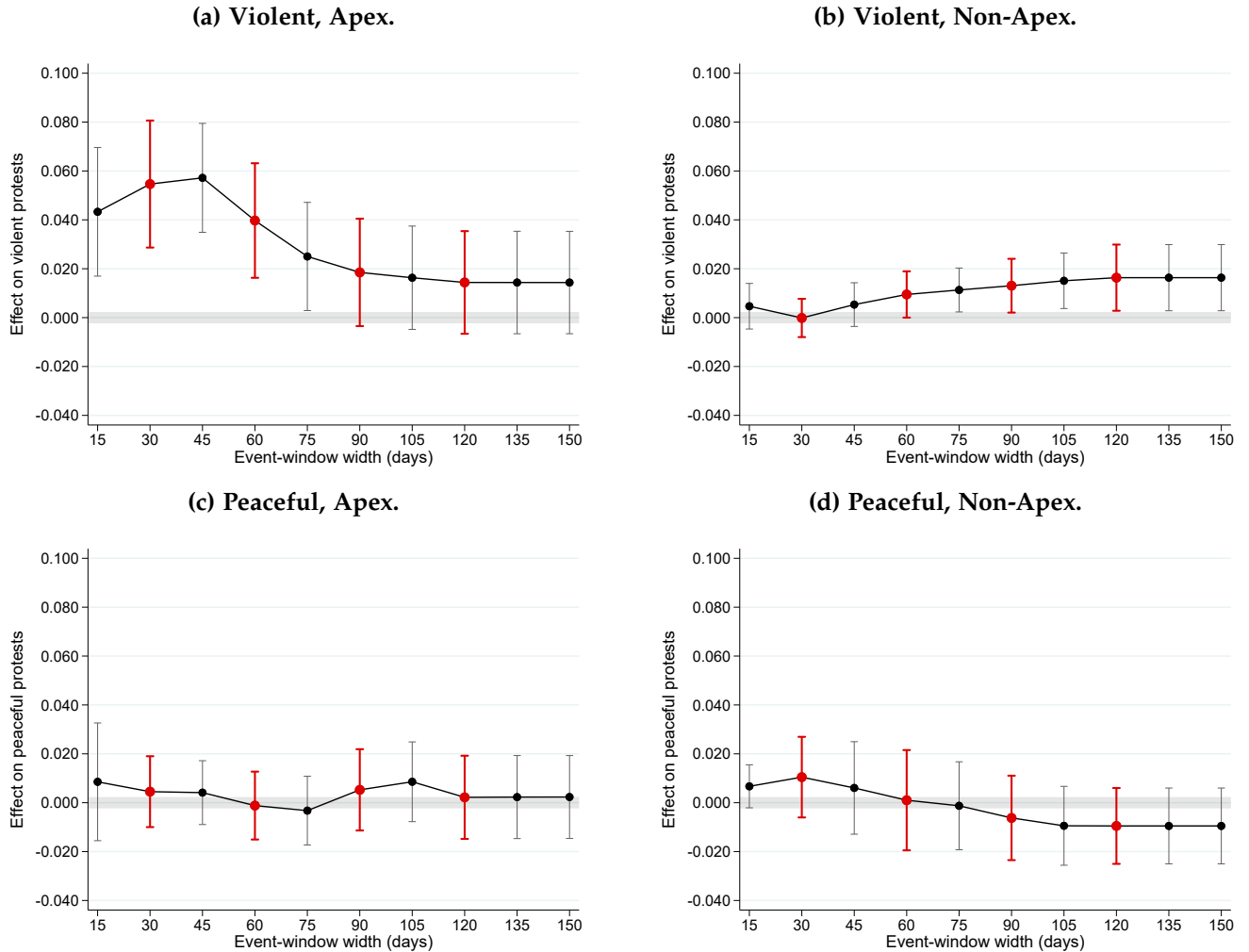


Randomization inference for peaceful protests on the Non-Apex subsample. Each histogram is the distribution of 1,000 placebo estimates of the post-scandal effect, obtained by redrawing each of the 113 non-apex scandals' disclosure dates at random within its own country-year and re-estimating Equation 1 on the $\pm T$ event window; the four panels correspond to $T \in \{30, 60, 90, 120\}$ days. The maroon vertical line marks the observed $\hat{\beta}$ on the non-apex subsample at the corresponding window; the top-right legend reports that observed $\hat{\beta}$ and the two-sided randomization-inference p -value, the share of placebo estimates with $|\hat{\beta}_{\text{placebo}}| \geq |\hat{\beta}_{\text{obs}}|$. Standard errors clustered at country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

S2 Sensitivity to the event-window width

We re-estimate the headline OLS specification at every event-window width $T \in \{15, 30, 45, \dots, 150\}$ days and plot the point estimate against T with a 90% confidence interval. Figure S5 places the Apex and Non-Apex subsamples *side by side*—violent protests in the top row, peaceful in the bottom—on a *common y-axis across all four panels*, so the Apex and Non-Apex responses can be compared directly by eye. The four widths reported in Table 2 ($T = 30, 60, 90, 120$) are highlighted in red; the effect on violent protests in the Apex subsample is positive across the full range of windows, while the Non-Apex response stays close to zero.

Figure S5. Window-width sensitivity: Apex vs. Non-Apex.

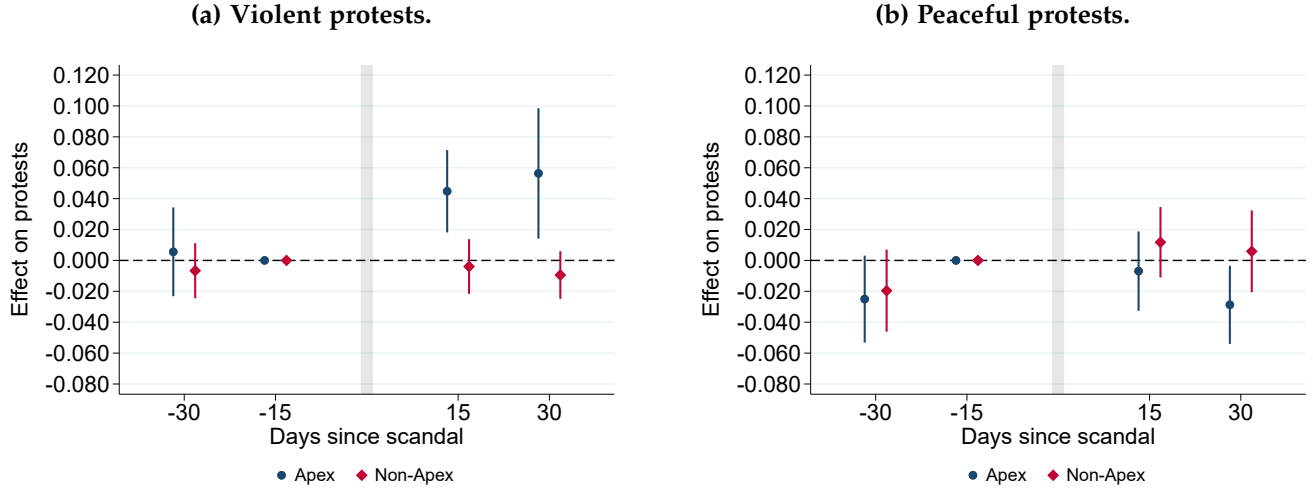


For each $T \in \{15, 30, \dots, 150\}$ we re-estimate the headline OLS specification on the event-window panel restricted to $|w_{st}| \leq T$, separately on the 63 Apex and 113 Non-Apex scandals. Vertical bars are 90% confidence intervals; the markers at $T = 30, 60, 90, 120$ (the widths in Table 2) are highlighted in red. All four panels share a common y-axis so Apex and Non-Apex are directly comparable. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

S3 Pooled event studies at other window widths

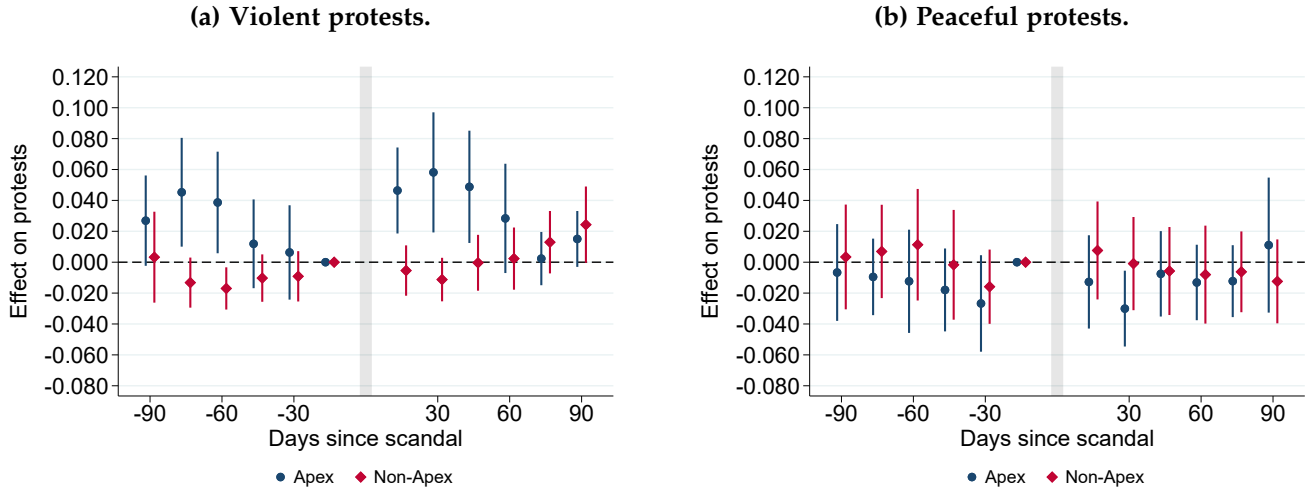
Figure 1 in the main text reports the pooled event study—the apex and non-apex event-time paths estimated jointly (??), directly comparable to the aggregate contrast in Table 1—at the ± 60 -day window. Figures S6–S8 report the same specification at the ± 30 , ± 90 , and ± 120 -day windows. Within each figure the violent and peaceful panels share a common y-axis.

Figure S6. Pooled event study, ± 30 -day window (15-day bins).



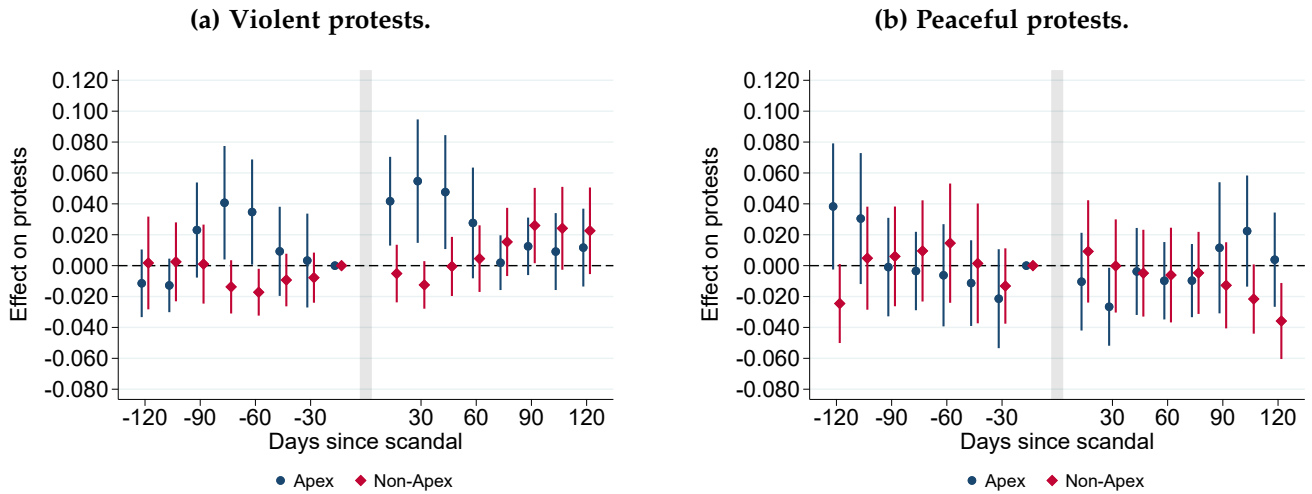
Pooled event study (??): event-time coefficients for the Apex (navy circles) and Non-Apex (maroon diamonds) groups, estimated jointly on the pooled sample, at the ± 30 -day window. The bin immediately preceding disclosure ($w_{s,t} \in [-15, -1]$) is the omitted reference for each group. Vertical bars are 90% confidence intervals; SE clustered at country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

Figure S7. Pooled event study, ± 90 -day window (15-day bins).



Pooled event study (??): event-time coefficients for the Apex (navy circles) and Non-Apex (maroon diamonds) groups, estimated jointly on the pooled sample, at the ± 90 -day window (15-day bins). The bin immediately preceding disclosure ($w_{s,t} \in [-15, -1]$) is the omitted reference for each group. Vertical bars are 90% confidence intervals; standard errors clustered at country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

Figure S8. Pooled event study, ± 120 -day window (15-day bins).

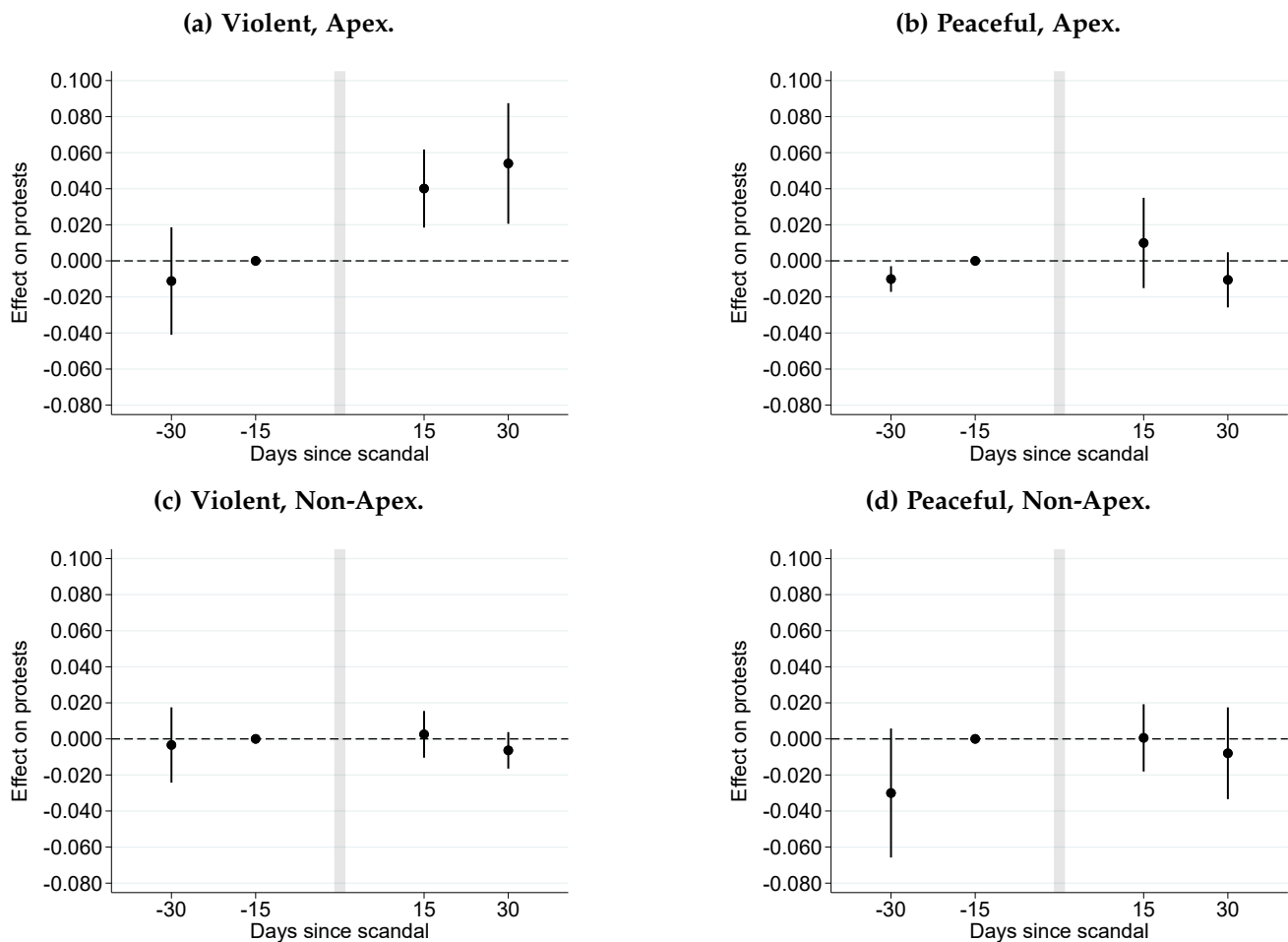


Pooled event study (??): event-time coefficients for the Apex (navy circles) and Non-Apex (maroon diamonds) groups, estimated jointly on the pooled sample, at the ± 120 -day window (15-day bins). The bin immediately preceding disclosure ($w_{s,t} \in [-15, -1]$) is the omitted reference for each group. Vertical bars are 90% confidence intervals; standard errors clustered at country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

S4 Event studies by subsample (15-day bins)

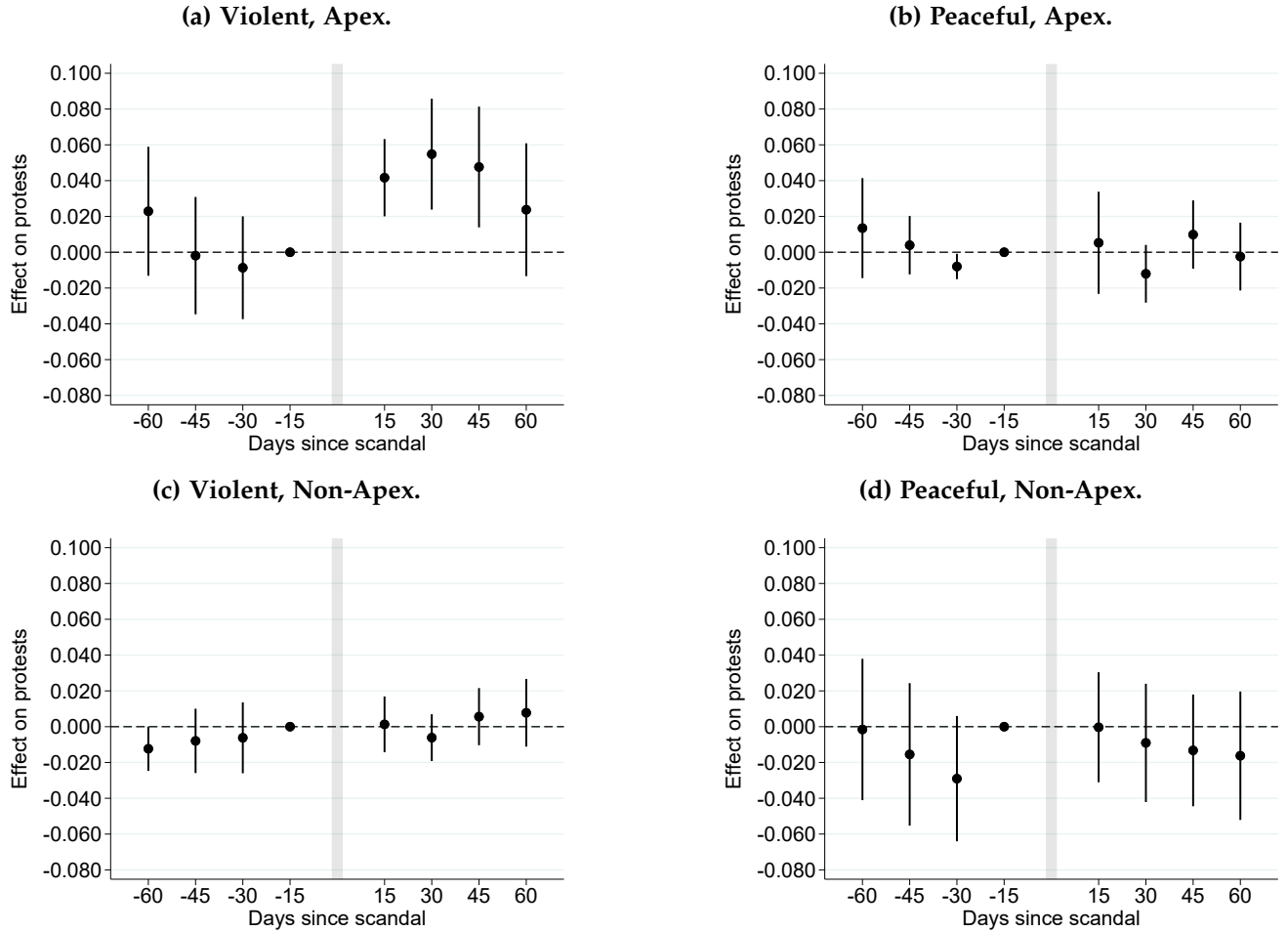
Figure 1 in the main text reports the *pooled* event study, in which the apex and non-apex paths are estimated jointly. As a complement, this section reports the *subsample* version—the event study estimated separately on the Apex and Non-Apex samples—at all four widths, $T \in \{30, 60, 90, 120\}$ days, keeping 15-day bins throughout. Within each figure all four panels—violent and peaceful, Apex and Non-Apex—share a common y-axis range, so the estimates can be compared by eye and the zero line is aligned across panels.

Figure S9. Event studies, ± 30 -day window (15-day bins).



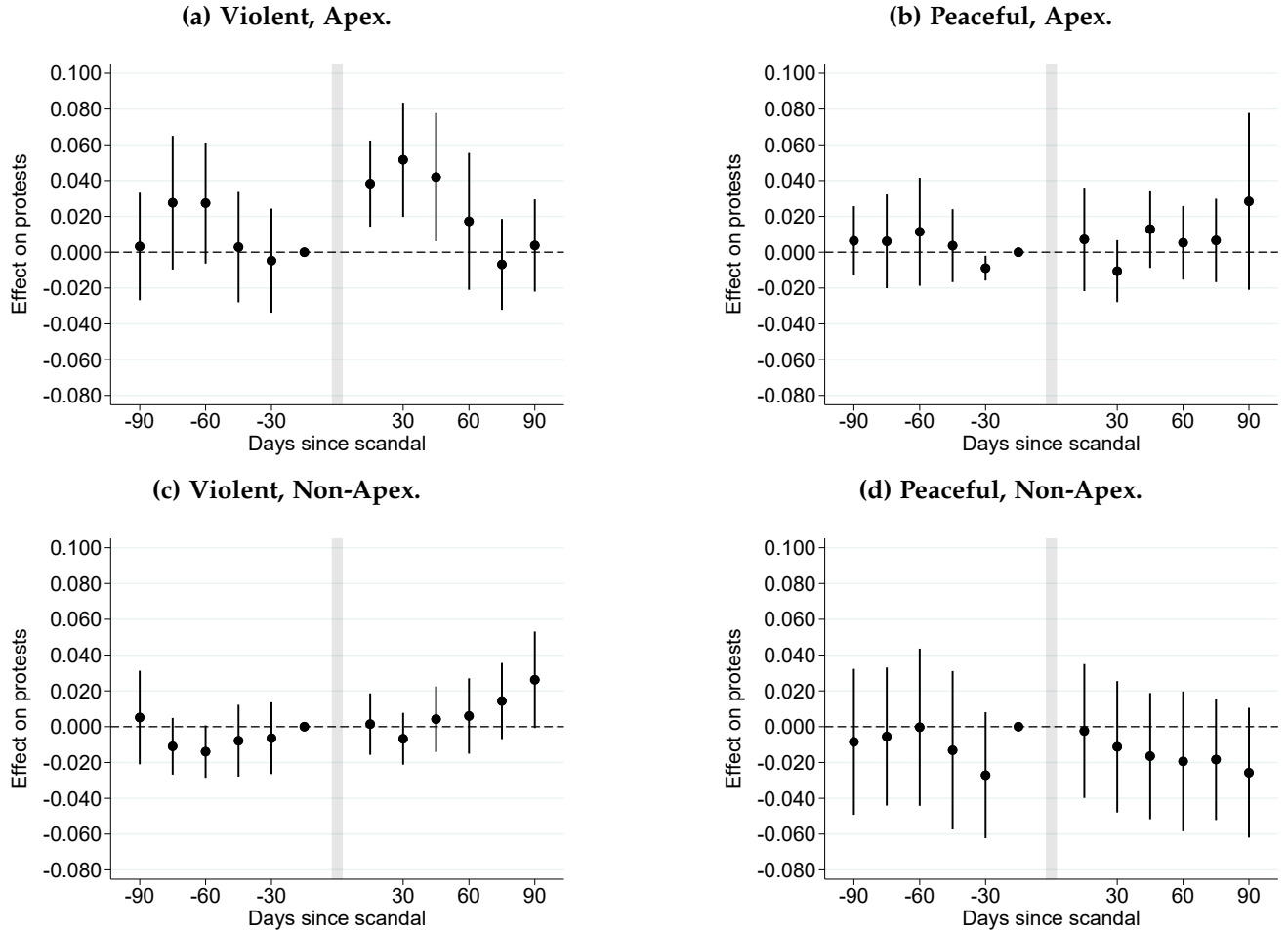
OLS event study estimated separately on the Apex and Non-Apex subsamples, on 15-day event-time bin indicators over the ± 30 -day window (Equation 1 with the post indicator replaced by a saturated set of event-time bins). The four panels are violent and peaceful protests $\times$ Apex and Non-Apex; the reference bin (the 15 days before disclosure) is normalized to zero and shown at its position, and the faint thick vertical line marks the disclosure cutoff. All four panels share a common y-axis. Vertical bars are 90% confidence intervals; standard errors clustered at country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

Figure S10. Event studies, ± 60 -day window (15-day bins).



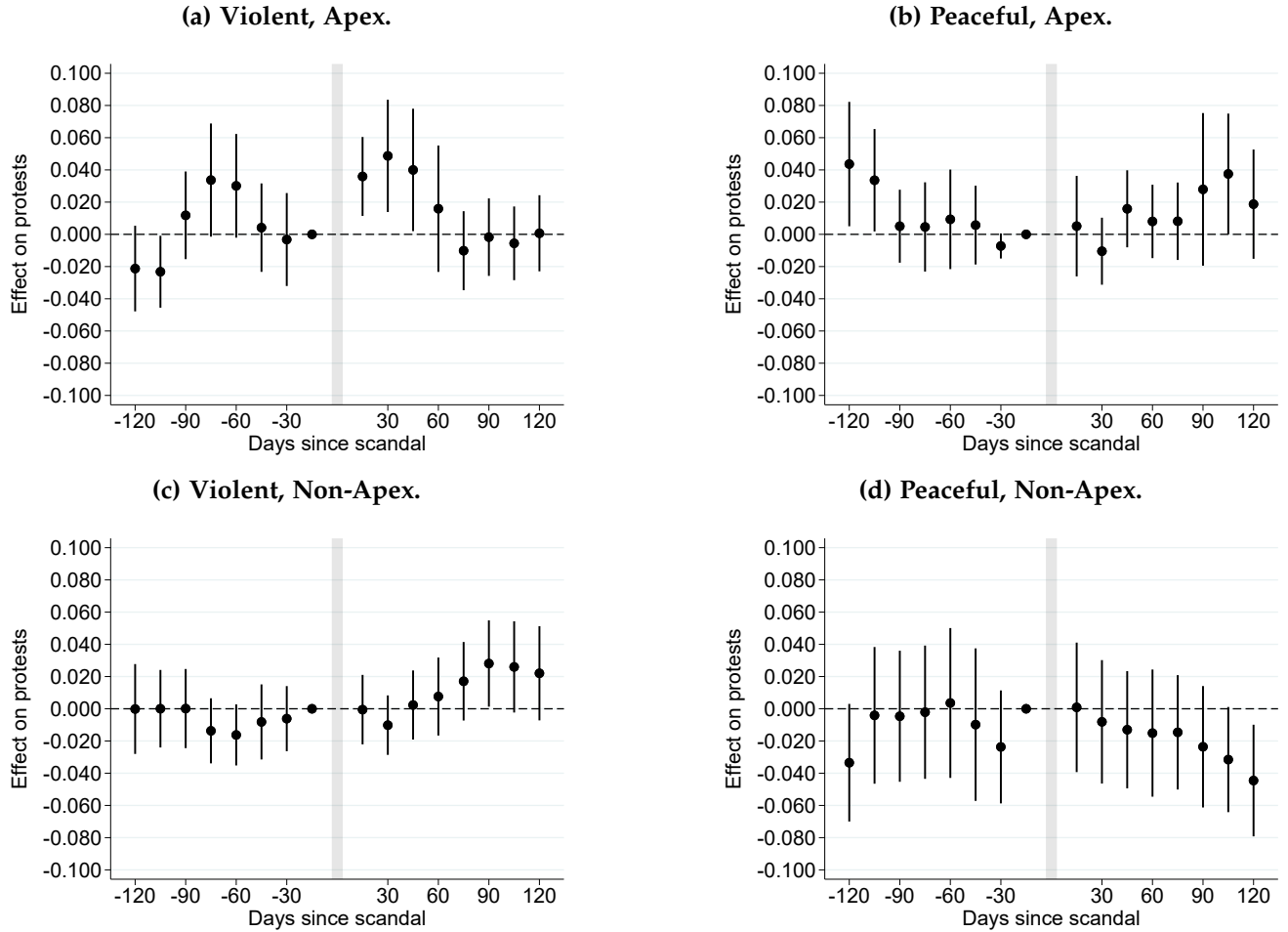
OLS event study estimated separately on the Apex and Non-Apex subsamples, on 15-day event-time bin indicators over the ± 60 -day window. The four panels are violent and peaceful protests $\times$ Apex and Non-Apex; the reference bin (the 15 days before disclosure) is normalized to zero and shown at its position, and the faint thick vertical line marks the disclosure cutoff. All four panels share a common y-axis. Vertical bars are 90% confidence intervals; standard errors clustered at country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

Figure S11. Event studies, ± 90 -day window (15-day bins).



OLS event study estimated separately on the Apex and Non-Apex subsamples, on 15-day event-time bin indicators over the ± 90 -day window. The four panels are violent and peaceful protests $\times$ Apex and Non-Apex; the reference bin (the 15 days before disclosure) is normalized to zero and shown at its position, and the faint thick vertical line marks the disclosure cutoff. All four panels share a common y-axis. Vertical bars are 90% confidence intervals; standard errors clustered at country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

Figure S12. Event studies, ± 120 -day window (15-day bins).

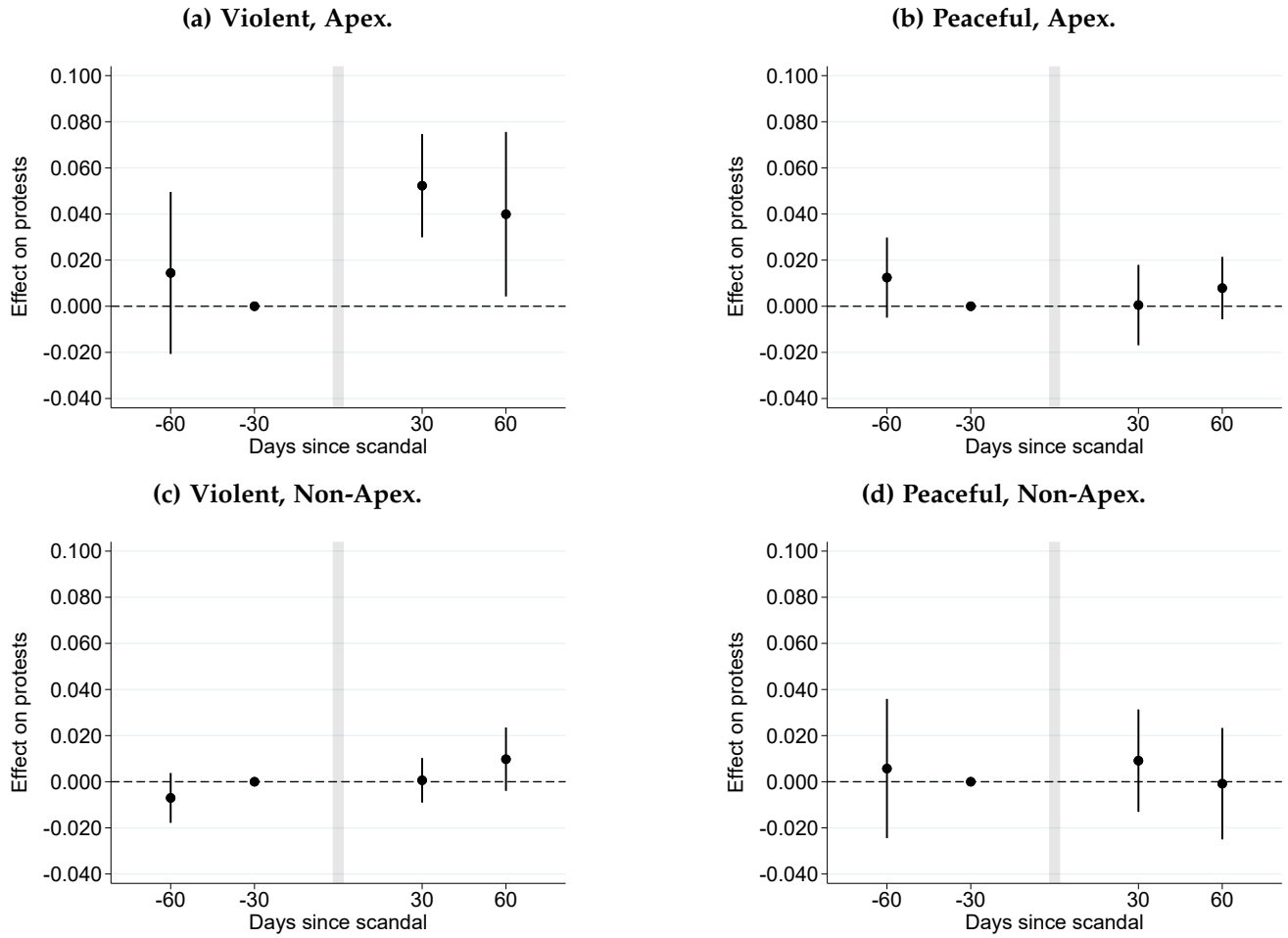


OLS event study estimated separately on the Apex and Non-Apex subsamples, on 15-day event-time bin indicators over the ± 120 -day window. The four panels are violent and peaceful protests $\times$ Apex and Non-Apex; the reference bin (the 15 days before disclosure) is normalized to zero and shown at its position, and the faint thick vertical line marks the disclosure cutoff. All four panels share a common y-axis. Vertical bars are 90% confidence intervals; standard errors clustered at country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

S5 Event studies with 30-day bins

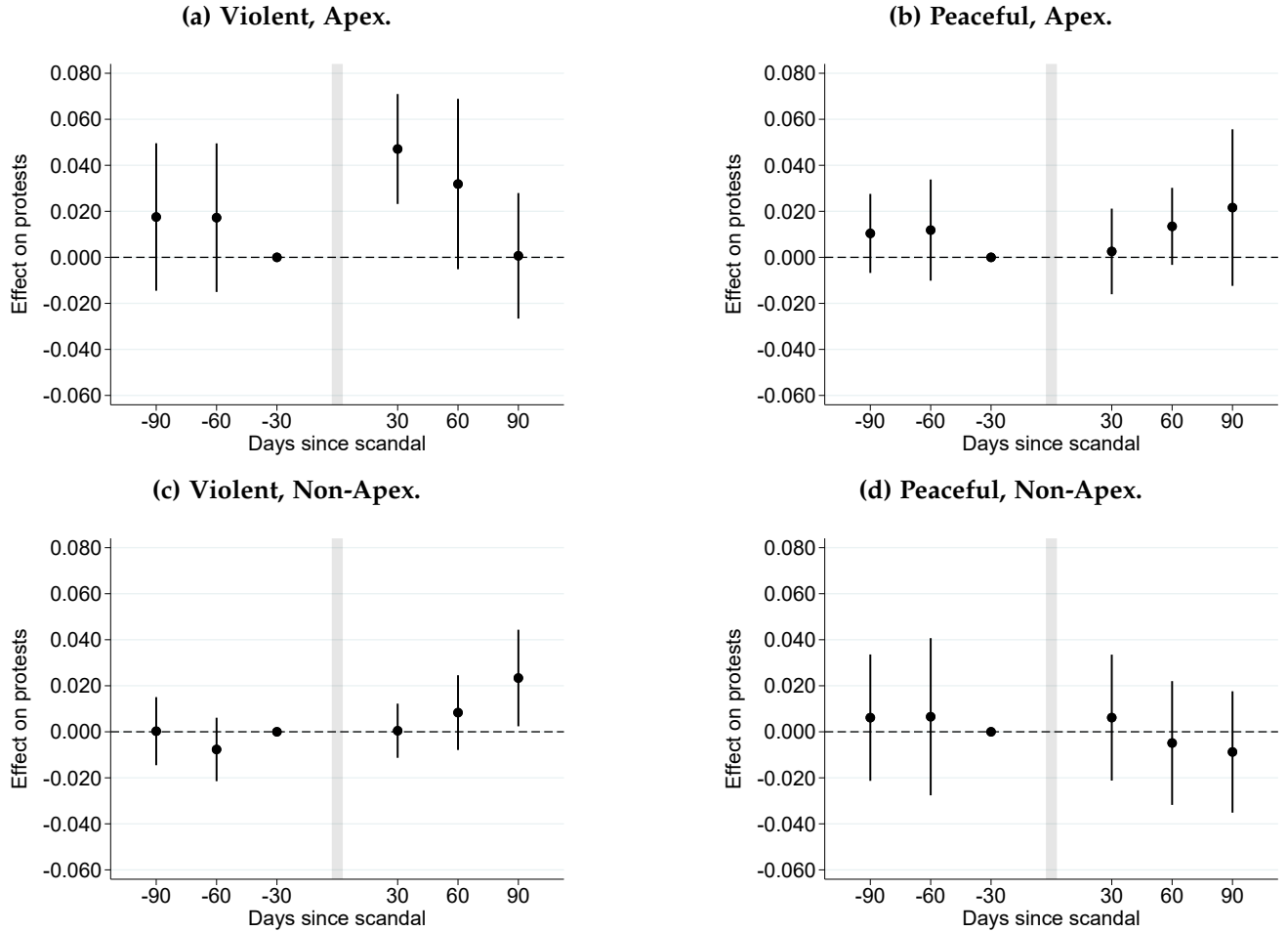
Figures S13–S15 reproduce the event studies using 30-day bins instead of the 15-day bins used in the main text, for $T \in \{60, 90, 120\}$ (the ± 30 -day window admits only one bin per side at this width and is therefore omitted). As above, the four panels within each figure share a common y-axis.

Figure S13. Event studies, ± 60 -day window (30-day bins).



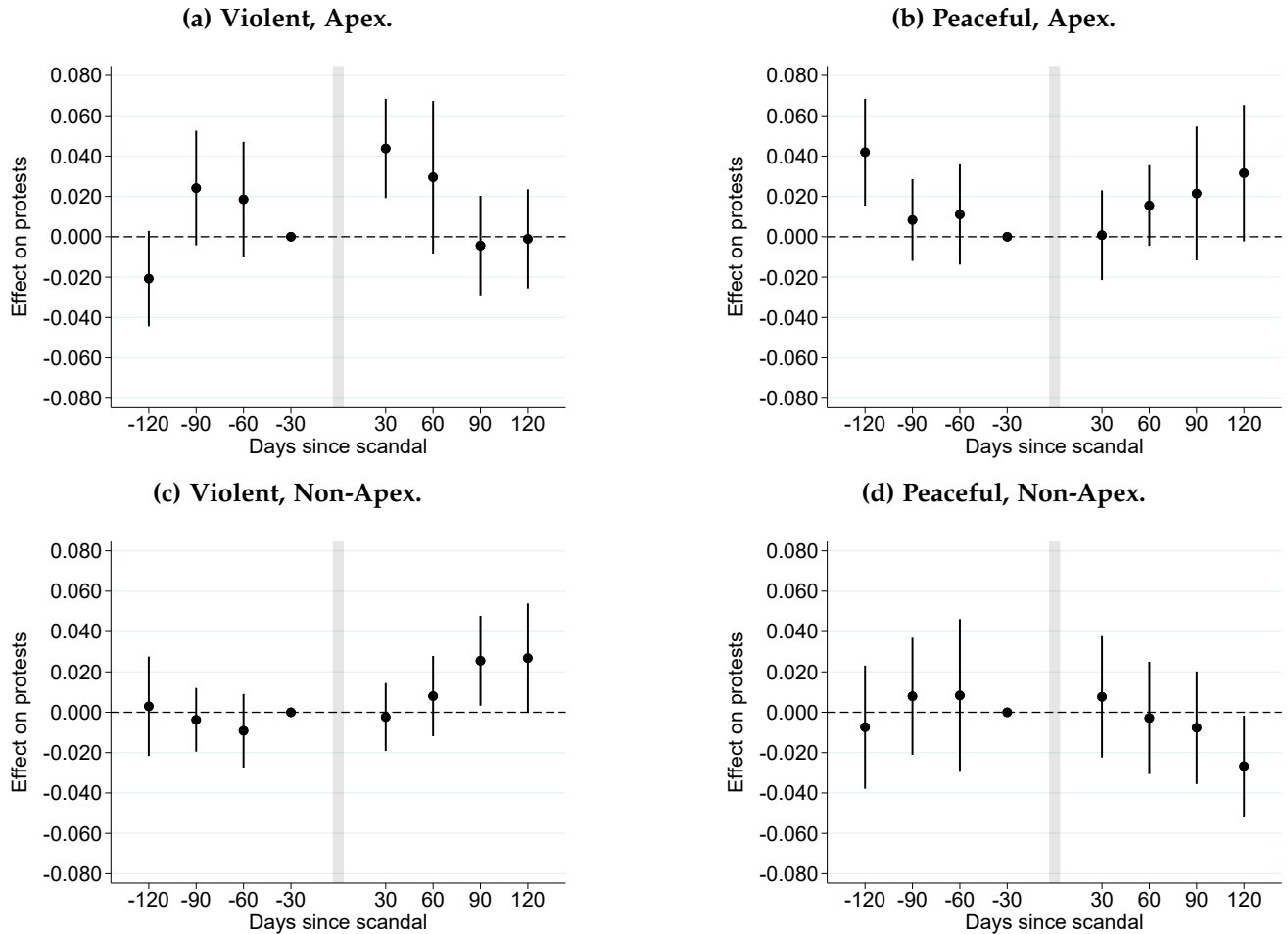
OLS event study estimated separately on the Apex and Non-Apex subsamples, on 30-day event-time bin indicators over the ± 60 -day window (the 30-day-bin analog of the main-text event studies). The four panels are violent and peaceful protests $\times$ Apex and Non-Apex; the reference bin (the 30 days before disclosure) is normalized to zero and shown at its position, and the faint thick vertical line marks the disclosure cutoff. All four panels share a common y-axis. Vertical bars are 90% confidence intervals; standard errors clustered at country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

Figure S14. Event studies, ± 90 -day window (30-day bins).



OLS event study estimated separately on the Apex and Non-Apex subsamples, on 30-day event-time bin indicators over the ± 90 -day window. The four panels are violent and peaceful protests $\times$ Apex and Non-Apex; the reference bin (the 30 days before disclosure) is normalized to zero and shown at its position, and the faint thick vertical line marks the disclosure cutoff. All four panels share a common y-axis. Vertical bars are 90% confidence intervals; standard errors clustered at country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

Figure S15. Event studies, ± 120 -day window (30-day bins).



OLS event study estimated separately on the Apex and Non-Apex subsamples, on 30-day event-time bin indicators over the ± 120 -day window—the 30-day-bin counterpart to the main-text [Figure 1](#). The four panels are violent and peaceful protests $\times$ Apex and Non-Apex; the reference bin (the 30 days before disclosure) is normalized to zero and shown at its position, and the faint thick vertical line marks the disclosure cutoff. All four panels share a common y-axis. Vertical bars are 90% confidence intervals; standard errors clustered at country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

S6 Scandal classification

Each of the 176 scandals in our event-window panel is manually classified by the position of the implicated politician, in two steps. *Step 1 (raw position)*. Starting from the free-text description of each scandal, a research assistant assigns one of five raw codes: **president** (sitting or immediately-former head of state); **governor** (head of a first-order subnational unit); **sc_judge_congressman** (a Supreme Court Justice *or* a national legislator); **other_judiciary** (lower-court judges, prosecutors); and **others** (ministers, agency heads, mayors, and all remaining officials). *Step 2 (splitting sc_judge_congressman)*. Because that raw code lumps constitutional-court justices together with members of Congress, we verify each such row and tag the ones implicating a Supreme Court justice; the re-tagged IDs are 202, NEW26, NEW30, and 332. We then aggregate into three bins: **President** = **president** (45 scandals); **Other Apex** = **governor** plus the four SC-Justice IDs (18 scandals); and **Non-Apex** = **other_judiciary** + **others** + the remaining **sc_judge_congressman** IDs (Congressmen; 113 scandals). Throughout the paper “Apex” pools the President and Other Apex bins (63 scandals).

Table S1 lists every scandal in the panel with its scandal ID, country, year, a short description, and its Apex/Non-Apex classification. The scandal ID is the identifier used to disambiguate the leave-one-out labels in Appendix S14 when a country has more than one scandal in the same year within a group. One earlier borderline case, ID NEW23 (Mexico, 2017), was originally re-tagged as a Supreme Court justice but its source describes a San Luis Potosí case implicating *diputados* (members of Congress); we therefore classify it as Non-Apex. Four scandals had blank descriptions in the classification file; we recovered them from the underlying news source and report them in the table.

Table S1. Classification of the 176 scandals in the event-window panel.

ID	Country	Year	Mini description	Class
11	Argentina	2010	Ricardo Jaime is one of the faces of corruption in Argentina. He has been involved in many...	Non-Apex
46	Argentina	2013	On April 14, 2013, after two years of investigation, the program Periodismo Para Todos (PPT)...	Apex
51	Argentina	2013	The military chief Cesar Milani, who faces complaints for his actions in La Rioja and Tucumán...	Non-Apex
317	Argentina	2015	Marcelo Tinelli, sobre la muerte de Alberto Nisman: Sensación de impunidad, de impotencia y códigos...	Non-Apex
542	Argentina	2015	The Pensar Foundation was investigated in an Argentine judicial process initiated in 2015 and...	Non-Apex
84	Argentina	2015	The former President Cristina Fernandez is accused of fraudulent administration to the detriment of...	Apex
103	Argentina	2016	José López was arrested red-handed when he threw the bags over the wall of the convent in the town...	Non-Apex
155	Argentina	2017	On June 18, 2017, the direct environment of the former Minister of Federal Planning Julio De Vido...	Non-Apex
436	Argentina	2017	Julio De Vido en la causa por las irregularidades en Yacimientos Carboníferos Río Turbio.	Non-Apex

Continued on next page

Table S1 (continued)

ID	Country	Year	Mini description	Class
543	Argentina	2017	The Paradise Papers in Argentina refer to the local repercussion of the scandal pro tax evasion and...	Non-Apex
TWNEWLATINO1	Argentina	2017	Filman a un intendente de Santa Cruz y después lo denuncian por recibir una coima de 2 millones de...	Non-Apex
185	Argentina	2018	Argentina was shaken on Wednesday August 1 2018 by a new corruption scandal, for the alleged...	Non-Apex
45	Bolivia	2012	The Bolivian government faced one of the most serious corruption scandals since the arrival of Evo...	Non-Apex
TWNEWLATINO3	Bolivia	2013	Detienen a ocho funcionarios de YPFB por supuesta corrupción: http://t.co/qkyncBRH7a vía...	Non-Apex
322	Bolivia	2015	Caso Fondo Indígena 12 de febrero de este año tras la publicación de un informe de la Contraloría...	Non-Apex
91	Bolivia	2016	Gabriela Zapata, former partner of President Evo Morales, was arrested on February 26, 2016 as part...	Non-Apex
TWNEWLATINO4	Bolivia	2016	#LoÚltimo Diputada Norma Piérola: Ministro Juan Ramón Quintana comparecerá el jueves 19 en...	Non-Apex
TWNEWLATINO5	Bolivia	2017	#LoÚltimo Detienen al Director Nacional de Derechos Reales, Jorge Bohorquez, por actos de...	Non-Apex
44	Brazil	2012	The Brazilian President, Dilma Rousseff, ordered on November 24, 2012, the dismissal of 18...	Non-Apex
270	Brazil	2013	Lobista envolve líder do governo Dilma em esquema de corrupção. http://t.co/yYUiLyJOhH	Non-Apex
TWNEWLATINO23	Brazil	2013	Roberto Gurgel: sociedade está cansada da impunidade Ayres Britto também defende manifestações nas...	Non-Apex
59	Brazil	2014	The corruption scandal within Petrobras, Brazil's largest company, largely spread on November 14,...	Non-Apex
100	Brazil	2015	On April 15, 2016, Brazilian police arrest the treasurer of the ruling Workers Party, João Vaccari,...	Non-Apex
316	Brazil	2015	Em 14 de janeiro de 2015, Nestor Cerveró foi preso pela Polícia Federal, em decorrência das...	Non-Apex
346	Brazil	2015	PF indicia o ex-diretor da Petrobras Jorge Zelada por corrupção http://t.co/wGVE8ArZAL...	Non-Apex
105	Brazil	2016	On June 22, 2016, Sergio Cabral, former governor of Rio, was accused of charging 5% on every...	Apex
111	Brazil	2016	On September 26, 2016, former minister Antonio Palocci was arrested by the Federal Police of...	Non-Apex
379	Brazil	2016	El 23 de mayo de 2016, surgió una grabación secreta del ministro Jucá, que está bajo investigación...	Non-Apex
NEW2	Brazil	2016	Brazilian authorities raided Lula's home. After the raid, the police detained Lula for questioning.	Apex
TWNEWLATINO6	Brazil	2016	Ministro da Transparência pede demissão após gravações	Non-Apex
104	Brazil	2017	Michel Temer, Brazilian president, was involved in the Petrobras scandal on June 15, 2016. On...	Apex
145	Brazil	2017	On April 11 2017, Odebrecht recognizes payments of more than US 4milliontoLuladaSilva.	Apex
167	Brazil	2017	The Brazilian Federal Police (PF) yesterday found suitcases and boxes full of money in an apartment...	Non-Apex
422	Brazil	2017	Ex-governadores de Brasília são presos por corrupção na Copa https://t.co/Fel4kLnCz8	Apex
NEW1	Brazil	2017	Lula é condenado a 9 anos por corrupção no triplex https://t.co/tXrVHVnbEe https://t.co/FZb8Kq4oWA	Apex
TWNEWLATINO22	Chile	2013	Revelan que diputada que apoyó Ley de Pesca obtuvo millonaria suma de grupo Angelini previa votación	Non-Apex
62	Chile	2014	The Penta case, sometimes also called Pentagate, is a Chilean criminal scandal and case, referring...	Non-Apex
68	Chile	2015	On February 5 2015, Qué Pasa magazine published a report in which it stated that the company...	Non-Apex
NEW3	Chile	2015	Los correos políticos que la fiscalía incautó al grupo Penta	Non-Apex

Continued on next page

Table S1 (continued)

ID	Country	Year	Mini description	Class
TWNEWLATINO7	Chile	2015	Fiscalía solicitó formalización de Hugo Bravo por delito tributario, soborno y lavado de activos....	Non-Apex
403	Chile	2017	23 de enero de 2017, una investigación publicada en Ciper hizo pública una conversación vía correo...	Non-Apex
19	Colombia	2009	Agro Ingreso Seguro scandal began on October 8, 2009, when the magazine Cambio de Colombia,...	Non-Apex
TWNEWLATINO8	Colombia	2011	A los capturados por escándalo en la Dian les imputarán cinco delitos	Non-Apex
TWNEWLATINO9	Colombia	2015	.@WSJ reveló video que sería prueba del FBI para demostrar presunto soborno de altos ejecutivos de...	Non-Apex
130	Colombia	2016	On May 10 2017, it was known that the former governor of Córdoba, Alejandro Lyons, fled to avoid...	Apex
366	Colombia	2016	Sigue el duro pulso entre el presidente Santos y el expresidente Uribe tras la captura del ganadero...	Non-Apex
88	Colombia	2016	On January 25, 2016, the Reficar corruption scandal broke. Although for three years they had been...	Non-Apex
129	Colombia	2017	On January 13, 2017 it was revealed that Gabriel García Morales, former Deputy Minister of...	Non-Apex
135	Colombia	2017	On February 8, 2017, Colombian authorities investigate whether Juan Manuel Santos' presidential...	Apex
156	Colombia	2017	The director of the National Anticorruption Prosecutor's Office of Colombia, Luis Gustavo Moreno,...	Non-Apex
160	Colombia	2017	The investigators of the Odebrecht case claim to have evidence that through Basima Patricia Elías...	Non-Apex
165	Colombia	2017	On August 29, 2017, the Colombian senator for the U Party, Musa Besaile, admitted that he paid...	Non-Apex
TWNEWLATINO10	Colombia	2017	Fue capturado el Director Nacional Contra la Corrupción de @FiscaliaCol. https://t.co/EB2LWpqqU3...	Non-Apex
TWNEWLATINO11	Colombia	2017	Audios prueban que la española Inassa sobornó a políticos colombianos https://t.co/tyDgALJvZy...	Non-Apex
TWNEWLATIN12	Colombia	2018	Fiscal general de la Nación, Néstor Humberto Martínez, entregó detalles de una red de corrupción al...	Non-Apex
TWNEWLATINO13	Colombia	2018	Mermelada tóxica: el caso de corrupción que enredaría al senador Antonio José Correa...	Non-Apex
33	Costa Rica	2011	On November 29, 2011, the Prosecutor's Office charged deputy Jorge Angulo before Chamber III of the...	Non-Apex
318	Costa Rica	2015	Procuradora: Yo no vi el ofrecimiento como soborno #casosoley	Non-Apex
157	Costa Rica	2017	On June 28 2017, 'Cementazo' scandal broke in Costa Rica, where the loan of 31.5millionfromthe...	Non-Apex
437	Costa Rica	2017	Fiscalía investiga si Celso Gamboa incurrió en abuso de autoridad y tráfico de influencias...	Non-Apex
NEW4	Dominican Republic	2016	Casos Tucanos	Non-Apex
NEW35	Dominican Republic	2017	En la mañana del 29 de mayo de 2017 el procurador general de la República, Jean Alain Rodríguez,...	Non-Apex
516	Dominican Republic	2019	#PeriódicoHOY Piden la renuncia inmediata del presidente Danilo Medina por soborno de US\$39.5...	Apex
41	Ecuador	2012	The Cofiec Duzan scandal begins in 2011, when 800,000disappearedfromanEcuadorianbankrunby...	Non-Apex
108	Ecuador	2016	The former manager of Petroecuador, Alex Bravo, is prosecuted for alleged illicit enrichment...	Non-Apex
113	Ecuador	2016	Carlos Pareja, a former official who has held strategic positions in the hydrocarbons sector since...	Non-Apex
NEW5	Ecuador	2016	Inician detenciones por Caso Odebrecht en Ecuador con el ex ministro de energía...	Non-Apex
TWNEWLATINO14	Ecuador	2016	A former manager of Petroecuador (Alex Bravo) was detained on 16 May 2016 for alleged influence...	Non-Apex
153	Ecuador	2017	Ecuador's Prosecutor's Office charged six people on 3 June 2017 in the Odebrecht case, among them...	Non-Apex

Continued on next page

Table S1 (continued)

ID	Country	Year	Mini description	Class
161	Ecuador	2017	On August 3 2017, the president of Ecuador, Lenín Moreno, stripped Vice President Jorge Glas,...	Apex
163	Ecuador	2017	On August 18, 2017, the Ecuadorian Prosecutor's Office carried out an operation to capture former...	Non-Apex
NEW6	Ecuador	2017	El 2 de junio de 2017, se realizaron operaciones coordinadas por la Fiscalía General del Estado en...	Non-Apex
NEW7	Ecuador	2017	Fiscal General anuncia pruebas de corrupción de Carlos Pólit-> https://t.co/kUNz79DdMe	Non-Apex
26	El Salvador	2010	In the night of Saturday, 29 October 2016, the former Salvadorian president Elías Antonio Saca, was...	Apex
303	El Salvador	2014	RT @mariacidon: Bolaños, exministro Gobernación y colaborador, condenados a 3 años por dos delitos:...	Non-Apex
57	El Salvador	2014	Francisco Flores was accused in May 2 2014 of pocketing US\$15million donated by Taiwan, intended...	Apex
392	El Salvador	2016	La Fiscalía capturó este lunes 22 de agosto a quien hasta hace solo ocho meses era fiscal general:...	Non-Apex
395	El Salvador	2016	@FGR_SV: A. Saca, Élmer Charláix, Pablo Gómez y Fco. Rodríguez acusados por delitos de Peculado,...	Apex
182	El Salvador	2018	The Attorney General of El Salvador ordered on Friday, June 8, 2018, the capture of Funes, several...	Apex
190	El Salvador	2018	Former Salvadorian Attorney General Luis Martinez was accused on October 18, 2018 of accepting...	Non-Apex
198	El Salvador	2019	Attorney General Office opens investigation against former Salvadorian president Mauricio Funes for...	Apex
332	Guatemala	2015	#CasoIGSS MP y Cicig señalan a Molina Stalling por delitos de asociación ilícita, tráfico de...	Apex
340	Guatemala	2015	POLÍTICA: Destino incierto. Expresidente del Congreso pierde su candidatura a diputado, tras...	Non-Apex
343	Guatemala	2015	Caso Redes: Gustavo Martínez, ex secretario de Otto Pérez, fue detenido por asociación ilícita y...	Non-Apex
70	Guatemala	2015	Otto Perez Molina, president of Guatemala, resigned on September 2, 2015 due to his involvement in...	Apex
NEW8	Guatemala	2015	Graban al presidente Otto involucrado directamente en el caso la Línea...	Apex
102	Guatemala	2016	Besides La Línea corruption scandal, Perez Molina was also involved with the la cooperacha scandal,...	Apex
381	Guatemala	2016	MP pide procesar a exdiputados por #PlazasFantasma https://t.co/zhPfl8LpOy https://t.co/rIt0GESwW	Non-Apex
393	Guatemala	2016	Familia de Jimmy Morales declara por caso de corrupción. Escuche lo que dijo el mandatario...	Apex
NEW9	Guatemala	2016	El 15 de abril de 2016, a casi un año de descubrir el Caso de La Línea y un día después de que Juan...	Apex
131	Guatemala	2017	On January 18, 2017, the brother and a son of the country's president, who swept to victory with an...	Non-Apex
175	Guatemala	2017	The former Minister of Defense of Guatemala, retired General Williams Mansilla Fernández, was...	Non-Apex
NEW10	Guatemala	2017	Corrupción Micivi: Empresas que pagaron sobornos han recibido 6.7 millardos del Estado...	Non-Apex
451	Guatemala	2018	Álvaro Colom y varios exministros son capturados por #CasoTransurbano. Algunos exfuncionarios ya...	Apex
NEW36	Guatemala	2018	EEUU detiene a excandidato presidencial de Guatemala vinculado con escándalo Odebrecht	Non-Apex
493	Guatemala	2019	Capturados hasta ahora por caso de #FinanciamientoUNE son: - Exsecretario privado de la Presidencia...	Non-Apex
511	Guatemala	2019	El #CasoCompradeVotos que golpea a siete partidos políticos en pleno año electoral...	Non-Apex
NEW13	Honduras	2014	La Comisión Interventora entregó un primer informe en marzo del mismo año, revelando el mayor caso...	Non-Apex

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Table S1 (continued)

ID	Country	Year	Mini description	Class
323	Honduras	2015	Firma investigará corrupción en Instituto de la Propiedad. Lea la nota completa en...	Non-Apex
71	Honduras	2015	The first scandal that shook Honduran president Juan Orlando Hernandez' government was the...	Apex
73	Honduras	2015	Fabio Lobo, son of former Honduran president Porfirio Lobo, was arrested on 20 May 2015 for...	Non-Apex
82	Honduras	2015	Pressured by the US embassy in Tegucigalpa, the Honduran Armed Forces (FAH) had to suspend two of...	Non-Apex
NEW12	Honduras	2017	Devis Leonel Rivera Maradiaga, exlíder del cartel de Los Cachiros, quien se entregó a la DEA en...	Non-Apex
NEW14	Honduras	2017	El equipo integrado UFECIC-MACCIH descubrió a través de sus fiscales e investigaciones una Red de...	Non-Apex
178	Honduras	2018	Former First Lady of Honduras Rosa Elena Bonilla, wife of former Honduran President Porfirio Lobo...	Apex
464	Honduras	2018	Se exhibe caso pandora.	Non-Apex
483	Honduras	2018	#caso arca abierta requerimiento fiscal contra cinco diputados y seis ex diputados hondureños por...	Non-Apex
NEW15	Honduras	2018	Inicia el escandalo conocido con caja chica del hermano	Non-Apex
201	Honduras	2019	On May 30, 2019, US prosecutors unsealed some 2015 documents which revealed that Hernández was...	Apex
206	Honduras	2019	On August 3, 2019, Honduran President Juan Orlando Hernández was identified Friday as a...	Apex
211	Honduras	2019	On October 8, 2019, a former Honduran mayor, who appears before a trial for drug trafficking,...	Apex
29	Mexico	2011	At a press conference on June 24, 2011, Senator Federico Döring exhibited the video that takes up...	Apex
36	Mexico	2012	On January 30, 2012, the federal government ended up admitting that since 2009 it began to...	Apex
292	Mexico	2014	Lsu interinato en la gubernatura regresó como titular a la Secretaria de Gobierno y permaneció en...	Non-Apex
64	Mexico	2014	Casa Blanca scandal began on November 9, 2014, when Aristegui Noticias published a journalistic...	Apex
77	Mexico	2015	The United States joined the investigation carried out by the Mexican Prosecutor's Office against...	Apex
NEW16	Mexico	2015	Audios revelan presuntos sobornos de OHL al gobierno del Estado de México por viaducto Bicentenario	Non-Apex
NEW21	Mexico	2015	Ordena Corte Federal de EU captura del exgobernador Eugenio Hernández Flores	Apex
373	Mexico	2016	#PanamaPapers @EmilioLozoyaAus, ex titular de @Pemex, niega relación en caso de desvío de fondos...	Non-Apex
61	Mexico	2016	On September 14, 2014, lawyer Jaime García Chávez criminally denounced Governor Duarte before the...	Apex
74	Mexico	2016	The second scandal, which includes the former, is the Operation Tornado. Since May 2015, many...	Apex
NEW22	Mexico	2016	En 2016 la revista Expansión junto con Mexicanos contra la corrupción y la impunidad publicó la...	Apex
127	Mexico	2017	Four former Mexican governors reportedly received bribes from Luis Carlos Castillo Cervantes El Rey...	Apex
140	Mexico	2017	On February 21, 2017, it was revealed that the Ministry of Social Development (Sedesol) diverted at...	Non-Apex
166	Mexico	2017	La Estafa Maestra is the name of a journalistic investigation carried out by the Mexican news...	Non-Apex
NEW18	Mexico	2017	El 20 de febrero de 2017 la policía de Veracruz halló una bodega en Córdoba, Veracruz con objetos...	Apex
NEW20	Mexico	2017	El 27 de marzo de 2017, fueron arrestados Javier Garfio Pacheco y Gerardo Villegas Madriles,...	Apex
NEW23	Mexico	2017	Alleged corruption network involving diputados (congressmen) in San Luis Potosi, Mexico; trended...	Non-Apex

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Table S1 (continued)

ID	Country	Year	Mini description	Class
NEW24	Mexico	2017	Gobierno mexicano espía a periodistas, activistas y líderes con software Pegasus: The New York Times	Non-Apex
NEW37	Mexico	2017	Tres exdirectivos de Odebrecht aseguran que Emilio Lozoya, exdirector de Pemex y colaborador del...	Non-Apex
202	Mexico	2019	President Andrés Manuel López Obrador revealed that the United States government notified the...	Apex
NEW19	Mexico	2019	The United States Department of the Treasury declared Roberto Sandoval Castañeda and judge Isidro...	Non-Apex
NEW25	Nicaragua	2018	El subdirector de la Policía Nacional, consuegro de Daniel Ortega, y el tesorero del FSLN son los...	Non-Apex
TWNEWLATIN15	Nicaragua	2018	El subdirector de la Policía Nacional, consuegro de Daniel Ortega, y el tesorero del FSLN son los...	Non-Apex
246	Panama	2012	Ricardo Martinelli es vinculado con un acusado de sobornar a Berlusconi . CNN México. 17 de abril...	Apex
NEW26	Panama	2014	El panameño Alejandro Moncada Luna, designado magistrado de la Corte Suprema de Justicia de Panamá...	Apex
334	Panama	2015	Cristóbal Salerno revela trama de corrupción en Cobranzas del Istmo http://t.co/gLYKfpYen2 vía...	Non-Apex
355	Panama	2015	acusación contra Ricardo Martinelli por los pinchazos. #Corrupción...	Apex
67	Panama	2015	Also, in Panama, on January 28, 2015, an investigation was launched against former president...	Apex
TWNEWLATINO16	Panama	2015	Declaraciones Tamburelli y Guardia involucran a allegados a Martinelli. Esquema del modus operandi...	Non-Apex
133	Panama	2017	Panamanian justice began on January 24 2017 the search for the first 17 people required in the case...	Apex
138	Panama	2017	Panama's President Juan Carlos Varela has been accused by a former advisor Ramon Fonseca of taking...	Apex
168	Panama	2017	On November 20, the first one condemns the case in this country: Jorge Espino, a businessman who...	Non-Apex
212	Panama	2019	The judge of the National Court Ismael Moreno has accused the Spanish multinational Fomento de...	Non-Apex
NEW27	Paraguay	2009	Fiscal de Coronel Oviedo es imputada por pedido de coima: Una agente del ministerio público y su...	Non-Apex
NEW28	Paraguay	2011	Fiscal de Ciudad del Este es detenido por cobro de supuesta coima. En breve ampliaremos.	Non-Apex
284	Paraguay	2013	Destapan caso niñera de oro, escándalo para el presidente de la cámara Víctor Bogado	Non-Apex
NEW29	Paraguay	2013	Detienen por presunta coima a directora administrativa de la Seam http://t.co/ijERb9nCyX	Non-Apex
NEW30	Paraguay	2016	Hijo de Sindulfo Blanco niega haber recibido un vehículo como soborno. https://t.co/zqZ0xtDhCn...	Apex
466	Paraguay	2018	#CaserosDeOro Para evitar el juicio oral y público, el diputado José María Ibáñez reconoció los...	Non-Apex
NEW32	Paraguay	2018	Cae funcionario de la Corte con presunta coima . https://t.co/KC7atX7jx7 https://t.co/VrvIk2kW3F	Non-Apex
214	Paraguay	2019	On November 20, 2019, operation Lava Jato, in which the largest corruption scandal in the history...	Apex
8	Peru	2008	On October 5, 2008, this scandal known as Petro-Audios began on Peru, involving Alberto Quimper,...	Non-Apex
31	Peru	2011	On October 20, 2011, the benches of Fuerza 2011, Alianza por el Gran Cambio (APGC) and Concertación...	Apex
49	Peru	2013	On January 31 2013, the Prosecutor's Office opened a preliminary investigation to Eva Fernerbug,...	Apex
58	Peru	2014	In other news, on May 14 2014, Cesar Alvarez, governor of Ancash, was arrested for leading a...	Apex
75	Peru	2015	On May 31, 2015 another scandal broke when media found that Venezuelan company Kaysamak C.A....	Apex

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Table S1 (continued)

ID	Country	Year	Mini description	Class
80	Peru	2015	Documents on alleged economic movements of Nadine Heredia and purchases that she would have made...	Apex
101	Peru	2016	The United States Drug Control Administration (DEA) is investigating Joaquín Ramírez, secretary...	Non-Apex
132	Peru	2017	On January 20, 2017, Edwin Luyo was arrested in Peru for his involvement in the Odebrecht...	Non-Apex
134	Peru	2017	The former president of Peru, Alejandro Toledo (2001-2006) received a millionaire bribe from the...	Apex
144	Peru	2017	On April 3, 2017, Peruvian Mayor Felix Moreno is investigated for his involvement in the Odebrecht...	Non-Apex
159	Peru	2017	On July 13, 2017, Peruvian justice dictates 18 months of preventive prison to the Humala for the...	Apex
170	Peru	2017	The former mayor of Lima Susana Villarán spoke yesterday on the statement that the Brazilian...	Non-Apex
171	Peru	2017	On December 13 2017, it became public that the Brazilian construction company Odebrecht, prosecuted...	Apex
NEW33	Peru	2017	Marcelo Odebrecht confirmó la entrega de USD 3 millones al ex presidente peruano Ollanta Humala	Apex
158	Peru	2018	The Construction Club is the name given to an alleged illicit concertation of construction...	Non-Apex
177	Peru	2018	On February 28 2018, the former head of Odebrecht in Peru Jorge Barata told Peruvian prosecutors...	Apex
179	Peru	2018	The Kenjivideos scandal is a political scandal that began in Peru on March 20 2018 as part of the...	Apex
183	Peru	2018	On Saturday, July 7, 2018, the news portal IDL-Reporters broadcast a series of audios that involve...	Non-Apex
189	Peru	2018	On 10 October 2018, Fujimori was arrested and placed in provisional detention on charges of money...	Non-Apex
191	Peru	2018	The Peruvian prosecutor José Domingo Pérez, in charge of the investigations in Peru of the...	Apex
196	Peru	2019	Four hours before the end of 2018, the Peruvian prosecutor, Pedro Gonzalo Chávarry, had the idea of...	Non-Apex
199	Peru	2019	On 17 April 2019, former Peruvian presiden Alan García died from a self-inflicted gunshot to the...	Apex
508	Peru	2019	Miguel Atala, ex vicepresidente de PetroPerú, confesó a la fiscalía que sirvió de testaferro para...	Apex
NEW38	Peru	2019	Pedro Chávarry: juez decidió abrir proceso penal a exfiscal de la Nación	Non-Apex

S7 Restricted subsamples: Presidential and Apex

Tables S2 and S3 re-estimate Equation 1 on progressively narrower subsamples: scandals implicating a sitting President only (45 scandals), and Presidents plus Other Apex officials (63 scandals). Each table reports OLS estimates of Equation 1 on the eight outcomes. The violent-protest effect is present in the President-only sample and remains when Other Apex scandals are added.

Table S2. Table 2 restricted to Presidential scandals.

	± 30 -Day Window		± 120 -Day Window		Shares (± 30 -Day)		Shares (± 120 -Day)	
	(1) Violent Protests	(2) Peaceful Protests	(3) Violent Protests	(4) Peaceful Protests	(5) Share Violent	(6) Share Peaceful	(7) Share Violent	(8) Share Peaceful
Post Scandal	0.035* (0.018)	0.006 (0.005)	0.007 (0.008)	-0.003 (0.010)	0.034* (0.018)	0.004 (0.004)	0.006 (0.008)	-0.005 (0.009)
Mean (Pre-Scandal Bin)	0.000	0.015	0.003	0.009	0.000	0.015	0.003	0.009
Observations	2745	2745	10845	10845	2745	2745	10845	10845
Number of Scandals	45	45	45	45	45	45	45	45
R-squared	0.098	0.036	0.114	0.164	0.099	0.034	0.118	0.159

OLS estimates of β from Equation 1 on the eight outcomes (cols. 1–4 counts, cols. 5–8 shares). Subsample: the 45 scandals classified as “President” in Appendix S6. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at the country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin level. Same fixed effects, sample period, and clustering as Table 2.

Table S3. Table 2 restricted to President and Other Apex scandals.

	± 30 -Day Window		± 120 -Day Window		Shares (± 30 -Day)		Shares (± 120 -Day)	
	(1) Violent Protests	(2) Peaceful Protests	(3) Violent Protests	(4) Peaceful Protests	(5) Share Violent	(6) Share Peaceful	(7) Share Violent	(8) Share Peaceful
Post Scandal	0.055*** (0.016)	0.005 (0.009)	0.015 (0.013)	0.002 (0.010)	0.055*** (0.016)	0.004 (0.008)	0.015 (0.013)	-0.001 (0.009)
Mean (Pre-Scandal Bin)	0.037	0.019	0.028	0.015	0.037	0.019	0.027	0.014
Observations	3843	3843	15424	15424	3843	3843	15424	15424
Number of Scandals	63	63	63	63	63	63	63	63
R-squared	0.290	0.076	0.208	0.118	0.296	0.082	0.212	0.116

As in Table S2, restricted to the 63 scandals classified as “President” or “Other Apex” in Appendix S6.

S8 Regression-based hierarchy analysis

Table S4 reports the pooled-regression analogue of the apex partition, splitting the interaction into all three bins. For each outcome and window we estimate

$$Y_{c(s)t} = \beta_{\text{Pres}} \text{Post}_{st} \mathbf{1}\{\text{Pres}_s\} + \beta_{\text{OA}} \text{Post}_{st} \mathbf{1}\{\text{OA}_s\} + \beta_{\text{ONA}} \text{Post}_{st} \mathbf{1}\{\text{ONA}_s\} + \alpha_d + \lambda_m + \theta_{cy} + \varepsilon_{c(s)t},$$

where Pres_s , OA_s , ONA_s are scandal-level indicators for President, Other Apex, and Non-Apex. The specification omits a stand-alone Post term, so each coefficient is the average post-scandal effect for that category, and we report the p -values from pairwise equality tests.

Table S4. Pooled interaction regression: hierarchy of the protest response.

	±30-Day Window		±120-Day Window		Shares (±30-Day)		Shares (±120-Day)	
	(1) Violent Protests	(2) Peaceful Protests	(3) Violent Protests	(4) Peaceful Protests	(5) Share Violent	(6) Share Peaceful	(7) Share Violent	(8) Share Peaceful
Post × President	0.028*** (0.009)	-0.001 (0.009)	0.009 (0.006)	-0.002 (0.010)	0.027*** (0.009)	-0.001 (0.008)	0.009 (0.006)	-0.004 (0.009)
Post × Other Apex	0.112** (0.047)	-0.021 (0.031)	0.057** (0.026)	-0.012 (0.013)	0.113** (0.047)	-0.015 (0.028)	0.058** (0.026)	-0.012 (0.012)
Post × Other Non-Apex	-0.004 (0.007)	0.019 (0.013)	0.011 (0.008)	-0.011 (0.009)	-0.005 (0.007)	0.019 (0.013)	0.011 (0.008)	-0.011 (0.009)
p-value: President = Other Non-Apex	0.006	0.237	0.849	0.501	0.005	0.215	0.828	0.521
p-value: Other Apex = Other Non-Apex	0.028	0.303	0.096	0.954	0.025	0.336	0.093	0.955
p-value: President = Other Apex	0.066	0.478	0.062	0.524	0.058	0.570	0.059	0.554
Mean (Pre-Scandal Bin)	0.027	0.069	0.020	0.053	0.027	0.061	0.020	0.048
Observations	10736	10736	42657	42657	10736	10736	42657	42657
Number of Scandals	176	176	176	176	176	176	176	176
R-squared	0.178	0.474	0.129	0.300	0.186	0.494	0.132	0.292

OLS estimates of β_{Pres} , β_{OA} , β_{ONA} (Post × President, Other Apex, Non-Apex) on the four count outcomes (cols. 1–4) and four share outcomes (cols. 5–8). Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at the country × year × day-bin level. Fixed effects, sample period, and clustering identical to Table 2. Rows labeled “ p -value” report pairwise equality tests across the three category coefficients.

S9 Heterogeneity by democracy: tercile split

Table 3 in the main text splits countries at the *median* of their 2008 democracy score. Table S5 refines that split into *terciles* of V-Dem’s 2008 Electoral Democracy Index: Low (bottom tercile), Medium (middle tercile), and High (top tercile). Alongside the three interaction coefficients, it reports the one-sided p -values for the orderings $\beta_{\text{High}} > \beta_{\text{Medium}}$, $\beta_{\text{Medium}} > \beta_{\text{Low}}$, and $\beta_{\text{High}} > \beta_{\text{Low}}$. The violent-protest effect is, if anything, increasing in democracy: at the ± 90 - and ± 120 -day windows the High-democracy effect exceeds the Low-democracy effect at conventional one-sided significance ($p = 0.040$ and 0.042).

Table S5. Effect by 2008 level of democracy, tercile split.

	± 30 -Day Window		± 60 -Day Window		± 90 -Day Window		± 120 -Day Window	
	(1) Violent Protests	(2) Peaceful Protests	(3) Violent Protests	(4) Peaceful Protests	(5) Violent Protests	(6) Peaceful Protests	(7) Violent Protests	(8) Peaceful Protests
Post $\times$ High Democracy (2008)	0.011* (0.006)	0.012 (0.010)	0.021*** (0.007)	0.005 (0.014)	0.018** (0.009)	-0.005 (0.011)	0.019** (0.008)	-0.011 (0.011)
Post $\times$ Medium Democracy (2008)	0.027* (0.015)	0.014 (0.010)	0.022 (0.018)	-0.006 (0.009)	0.020 (0.017)	-0.005 (0.008)	0.026 (0.018)	-0.009 (0.009)
Post $\times$ Low Democracy (2008)	0.012** (0.006)	0.005 (0.014)	0.010* (0.006)	0.002 (0.018)	0.001 (0.005)	0.001 (0.015)	0.004 (0.004)	-0.005 (0.014)
p-value: High $>$ Medium (one-sided)	0.840	0.570	0.506	0.245	0.543	0.508	0.637	0.561
p-value: Medium $>$ Low (one-sided)	0.196	0.278	0.278	0.670	0.144	0.632	0.121	0.602
p-value: High $>$ Low (one-sided)	0.610	0.333	0.093	0.452	0.040	0.631	0.042	0.644
Mean (Pre-Scandal)	0.020	0.053	0.021	0.056	0.024	0.057	0.023	0.057
Observations	10736	10736	21296	21296	31856	31856	42416	42416
Number of Scandals	176	176	176	176	176	176	176	176
R-squared	0.160	0.473	0.154	0.396	0.133	0.348	0.127	0.300

OLS estimates of β_{High} , β_{Medium} , and β_{Low} , the coefficients on the post-scandal indicator interacted with top-, middle-, and bottom-tercile 2008-democracy flags. Columns are violent and peaceful protest counts at four event-window widths: ± 30 days (cols. 1–2), ± 60 (cols. 3–4), ± 90 (cols. 5–6), and ± 120 (cols. 7–8). The 16 sample countries are grouped into terciles of V-Dem’s Electoral Democracy Index (`v2x_polyarchy`) in 2008. An observation is a country-day inside a scandal’s event window. The rows “p-value: High $>$ Medium,” “Medium $>$ Low,” and “High $>$ Low” report the one-sided p -values for the corresponding orderings of the coefficients. All specifications include country-by-year, month-of-year, and day-of-week fixed effects; standard errors (in parentheses) are clustered at the country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin level. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded. Significance: * $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Pooling the top two terciles into a single “Medium+High” group sharpens the comparison against the bottom tercile. Table S6 reports this Low vs. Medium+High split. The violent-protest effect is larger in the Medium+High group at every window, and the one-sided ordering $\beta_{\text{Medium+High}} > \beta_{\text{Low}}$ is significant at the ± 90 - and ± 120 -day windows ($p = 0.037$ and 0.033).

Table S6. Effect by 2008 level of democracy: Low vs. Medium+High.

	± 30 -Day Window		± 60 -Day Window		± 90 -Day Window		± 120 -Day Window	
	(1) Violent Protests	(2) Peaceful Protests	(3) Violent Protests	(4) Peaceful Protests	(5) Violent Protests	(6) Peaceful Protests	(7) Violent Protests	(8) Peaceful Protests
Post $\times$ Medium+High Democracy (2008)	0.018** (0.007)	0.012 (0.008)	0.021** (0.008)	0.000 (0.008)	0.019** (0.009)	-0.005 (0.007)	0.022** (0.009)	-0.010 (0.007)
Post $\times$ Low Democracy (2008)	0.012** (0.006)	0.005 (0.014)	0.010* (0.006)	0.003 (0.018)	0.001 (0.005)	0.001 (0.015)	0.004 (0.004)	-0.005 (0.014)
p-value: Medium+High = Low	0.547	0.586	0.295	0.898	0.074	0.719	0.066	0.727
p-value: Medium+High > Low (one-sided)	0.273	0.293	0.147	0.551	0.037	0.641	0.033	0.636
Mean (Pre-Scandal)	0.020	0.053	0.021	0.056	0.024	0.057	0.023	0.057
Observations	10736	10736	21296	21296	31856	31856	42416	42416
Number of Scandals	176	176	176	176	176	176	176	176
R-squared	0.160	0.473	0.154	0.396	0.133	0.348	0.127	0.300

OLS estimates of $\beta_{\text{Medium+High}}$ and β_{Low} , the coefficients on the post-scandal indicator interacted with a top-two-tercile (“Medium+High”) and a bottom-tercile (“Low”) 2008-democracy flag. Columns are violent and peaceful protest counts at four event-window widths: ± 30 days (cols. 1–2), ± 60 (cols. 3–4), ± 90 (cols. 5–6), and ± 120 (cols. 7–8). The 16 sample countries are split into terciles of V-Dem’s Electoral Democracy Index (`v2x_polyarchy`) in 2008, and the top two terciles are pooled. An observation is a country-day inside a scandal’s event window. “p-value: Medium+High = Low” reports the two-sided p -value for $H_0 : \beta_{\text{Medium+High}} = \beta_{\text{Low}}$; “p-value: Medium+High > Low (one-sided)” reports the one-sided p -value for $H_1 : \beta_{\text{Medium+High}} > \beta_{\text{Low}}$. All specifications include country-by-year, month-of-year, and day-of-week fixed effects; standard errors (in parentheses) are clustered at the country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin level. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded. Significance: * $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

S10 Democracy: alternative indices and country classification

Table S7 lists the sample countries (sorted by their 2008 V-Dem Electoral Democracy Index) and shows how each is classified—High, Medium, or Low—under four different 2008 democracy measures, so the tercile grouping used throughout is not an artefact of a single index. Table S8 then re-estimates the tercile democracy split of Table S5 using an alternative continuous index, V-Dem’s Liberal Democracy Index, in place of the Electoral index, and Table S9 reports the corresponding Low vs. Medium+High pooled split—the liberal-index analogue of Table S6. Finally, Table S10 repeats the by-level split using Freedom House’s 2008 status (Free vs. Partly Free). The ordering of the effects is preserved throughout.

Table S7. Country democracy classification across four indices.

Country	V-Dem Electoral	V-Dem Liberal	Polity2	Freedom House
Costa Rica	High	High	High	High
Chile	High	High	High	High
Brazil	High	High	Low	High
Peru	High	High	High	High
Argentina	High	High	Low	High
Panama	Medium	Medium	High	High
Bolivia	Medium	Medium	Low	Medium
Mexico	Medium	Medium	Low	High
Dominican Republic	Medium	Low	Low	High
Ecuador	Medium	Low	Low	Medium
Paraguay	Low	Medium	Low	Medium
Guatemala	Low	Low	Low	Medium
Colombia	Low	Medium	Low	Medium
El Salvador	Low	Low	Low	High
Honduras	Low	Low	Low	Medium
Nicaragua	Low	Low	High	Medium

Each country’s High / Medium / Low classification under four 2008 democracy measures: V-Dem Electoral Democracy (`v2x_polyarchy`), V-Dem Liberal Democracy (`v2x_libdem`), Polity2 (`e_polity2`), and Freedom House status (`e_fh_status`; Free / Partly Free / Not Free mapped to High / Medium / Low). For the three continuous indices the classification is the country’s tercile; Polity2 discriminates poorly among these consolidated democracies (its scores cluster near the top), so its tercile split is noisier than the V-Dem indices. Countries are sorted by the V-Dem Electoral index.

Table S8. Effect by 2008 level of democracy, tercile split: V-Dem Liberal Democracy Index.

	±30-Day Window		±60-Day Window		±90-Day Window		±120-Day Window	
	(1) Violent Protests	(2) Peaceful Protests	(3) Violent Protests	(4) Peaceful Protests	(5) Violent Protests	(6) Peaceful Protests	(7) Violent Protests	(8) Peaceful Protests
Post × High Democracy (Liberal, 2008)	0.011* (0.006)	0.012 (0.010)	0.021*** (0.007)	0.005 (0.014)	0.018** (0.009)	-0.005 (0.011)	0.019** (0.008)	-0.011 (0.011)
Post × Medium Democracy (Liberal, 2008)	0.027** (0.012)	0.023** (0.010)	0.020 (0.014)	0.007 (0.011)	0.014 (0.012)	0.006 (0.011)	0.022** (0.011)	0.001 (0.011)
Post × Low Democracy (Liberal, 2008)	0.010* (0.006)	-0.007 (0.016)	0.010 (0.006)	-0.011 (0.021)	0.004 (0.009)	-0.009 (0.016)	0.005 (0.013)	-0.016 (0.014)
p-value: High > Medium (one-sided)	0.891	0.818	0.472	0.547	0.404	0.750	0.586	0.798
p-value: Medium > Low (one-sided)	0.095	0.053	0.257	0.222	0.259	0.229	0.150	0.182
p-value: High > Low (one-sided)	0.432	0.157	0.102	0.258	0.141	0.410	0.172	0.404
Mean (Pre-Scandal)	0.020	0.053	0.021	0.056	0.024	0.057	0.023	0.057
Observations	10736	10736	21296	21296	31856	31856	42416	42416
Number of Scandals	176	176	176	176	176	176	176	176
R-squared	0.160	0.473	0.154	0.396	0.133	0.348	0.127	0.300

As Table S5, but the terciles are formed from V-Dem's 2008 *Liberal Democracy Index* (v2x_libdem) rather than the Electoral index. OLS estimates of β_{High} , β_{Medium} , and β_{Low} (the post-scandal indicator interacted with top-, middle-, and bottom-tercile flags), on violent and peaceful protest counts at the ±30/60/90/120-day windows. The rows report the one-sided p -values for the orderings High > Medium, Medium > Low, and High > Low. All specifications include country-by-year, month-of-year, and day-of-week fixed effects; standard errors (in parentheses) are clustered at the country × year × day-bin level. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded. Significance: * $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Table S9. Effect by 2008 level of democracy (Liberal index): Low vs. Medium+High.

	±30-Day Window		±60-Day Window		±90-Day Window		±120-Day Window	
	(1) Violent Protests	(2) Peaceful Protests	(3) Violent Protests	(4) Peaceful Protests	(5) Violent Protests	(6) Peaceful Protests	(7) Violent Protests	(8) Peaceful Protests
Post × Medium+High Democracy (Liberal, 2008)	0.019*** (0.007)	0.017** (0.008)	0.021*** (0.008)	0.006 (0.009)	0.016** (0.007)	0.000 (0.008)	0.020*** (0.007)	-0.005 (0.008)
Post × Low Democracy (Liberal, 2008)	0.009* (0.006)	-0.007 (0.016)	0.010 (0.006)	-0.011 (0.021)	0.004 (0.009)	-0.009 (0.016)	0.005 (0.013)	-0.016 (0.014)
p-value: Medium+High = Low	0.257	0.166	0.269	0.450	0.312	0.593	0.270	0.525
p-value: Medium+High > Low (one-sided)	0.128	0.083	0.134	0.225	0.156	0.296	0.135	0.263
Mean (Pre-Scandal)	0.020	0.053	0.021	0.056	0.024	0.057	0.023	0.057
Observations	10736	10736	21296	21296	31856	31856	42416	42416
Number of Scandals	176	176	176	176	176	176	176	176
R-squared	0.160	0.473	0.154	0.396	0.133	0.348	0.127	0.300

As Table S6, but the terciles are formed from V-Dem's 2008 *Liberal Democracy Index* (v2x_libdem) rather than the Electoral index, and the top two terciles are pooled. OLS estimates of $\beta_{\text{Medium+High}}$ and β_{Low} (the post-scandal indicator interacted with a top-two-tercile and a bottom-tercile flag), on violent and peaceful protest counts at the ±30/60/90/120-day windows. “ p -value: Medium+High = Low” reports the two-sided p -value for $H_0 : \beta_{\text{Medium+High}} = \beta_{\text{Low}}$; “ p -value: Medium+High > Low (one-sided)” reports the one-sided p -value for $H_1 : \beta_{\text{Medium+High}} > \beta_{\text{Low}}$. All specifications include country-by-year, month-of-year, and day-of-week fixed effects; standard errors (in parentheses) are clustered at the country × year × day-bin level. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded. Significance: * $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Table S10. Effect by 2008 level of democracy: Freedom House status.

	± 30 -Day Window		± 60 -Day Window		± 90 -Day Window		± 120 -Day Window	
	(1) Violent Protests	(2) Peaceful Protests	(3) Violent Protests	(4) Peaceful Protests	(5) Violent Protests	(6) Peaceful Protests	(7) Violent Protests	(8) Peaceful Protests
Post $\times$ Free (Freedom House, 2008)	0.019** (0.008)	0.008 (0.008)	0.022** (0.009)	0.002 (0.009)	0.018** (0.009)	-0.001 (0.007)	0.021*** (0.008)	-0.006 (0.007)
Post $\times$ Partly Free (Freedom House, 2008)	0.011* (0.006)	0.013 (0.014)	0.010* (0.006)	-0.001 (0.017)	0.004 (0.008)	-0.005 (0.014)	0.007 (0.010)	-0.012 (0.013)
p-value: Free = Partly Free	0.378	0.734	0.303	0.855	0.255	0.813	0.242	0.665
p-value: Free > Partly Free (one-sided)	0.189	0.633	0.152	0.427	0.128	0.407	0.121	0.332
Mean (Pre-Scandal)	0.020	0.053	0.021	0.056	0.024	0.057	0.023	0.057
Observations	10736	10736	21296	21296	31856	31856	42416	42416
Number of Scandals	176	176	176	176	176	176	176	176
R-squared	0.160	0.473	0.154	0.396	0.133	0.348	0.127	0.300

The by-democracy-level split using Freedom House's 2008 status (`e_fh_status`) instead of a V-Dem index. Freedom House classifies each country as Free, Partly Free, or Not Free; among the 16 sample countries none is Not Free, so this is a Free (9 countries) vs. Partly Free (7 countries) comparison. OLS estimates of β_{Free} and $\beta_{\text{Partly Free}}$ (the post-scandal indicator interacted with a Free and a Partly-Free flag), on violent and peaceful protest counts at the $\pm 30/60/90/120$ -day windows. "p-value: Free = Partly Free" reports the two-sided p -value for $H_0 : \beta_{\text{Free}} = \beta_{\text{Partly Free}}$; "p-value: Free > Partly Free (one-sided)" reports the one-sided p -value for $H_1 : \beta_{\text{Free}} > \beta_{\text{Partly Free}}$. All specifications include country-by-year, month-of-year, and day-of-week fixed effects; standard errors (in parentheses) are clustered at the country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin level. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded. Significance: * $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

S11 Modern staggered difference-in-differences estimators

Because scandals are staggered in calendar time, a two-way fixed-effects (TWFE) estimator could in principle be contaminated by “forbidden comparisons” between newly- and already-treated units (de Chaisemartin and D’Haultfoeulle 2024; Goodman-Bacon 2021). We therefore re-estimate the effect with three heterogeneity-robust estimators—Sun & Abraham (SA) (Sun and Abraham 2021), Borusyak, Jaravel & Spiess (BJS) (Borusyak et al. 2024), and de Chaisemartin & D’Haultfoeulle (dCDH) (de Chaisemartin and D’Haultfoeulle 2024)—against a TWFE OLS baseline, under two designs, each split by subsample.

Design 1 (stacked by scandal). The design closest to our main event-window specification is a Cengiz-style stack (Cengiz et al. 2019): for each scandal we take the treated country’s $\pm T$ -day (15-day-bin) window together with every country with no scandal of any type in that window as a clean control cohort, and pool the stacks; we report the design at $T \in \{60, 90, 120\}$ days. Table S11 reports the static post-scandal coefficient from each estimator, split into Apex (Panel A) and Non-Apex (Panel B); Figures S16–S18 overlay the four estimators’ event-study paths for violent protests at each window.

Design 2 (first-scandal, 15-day bins). As a complementary check we collapse the data to a country $\times$ 15-day-bin panel and define treatment as a country’s *first* scandal bin, letting each estimator use its native never-treated control group; event time is measured in 15-day bins, exactly as in the OLS event studies of Appendix S4, so the two are directly comparable. We report this design at the ± 60 , ± 90 , and ± 120 -day windows (4, 6, and 8 bins per side). Table S12 collects the static coefficients and Figures S19–S21 the event-study paths. Across both designs and all three estimators, the violent-protest response in the Apex subsample is of the same sign and broad magnitude as the headline estimates, while the Non-Apex subsample stays flat—so the main result is not an artifact of TWFE aggregation. (Outcomes are Mass-Mobilization counts: “Violent” = `mm_violent`, “Non-violent” = `mm_nonviolent`.)

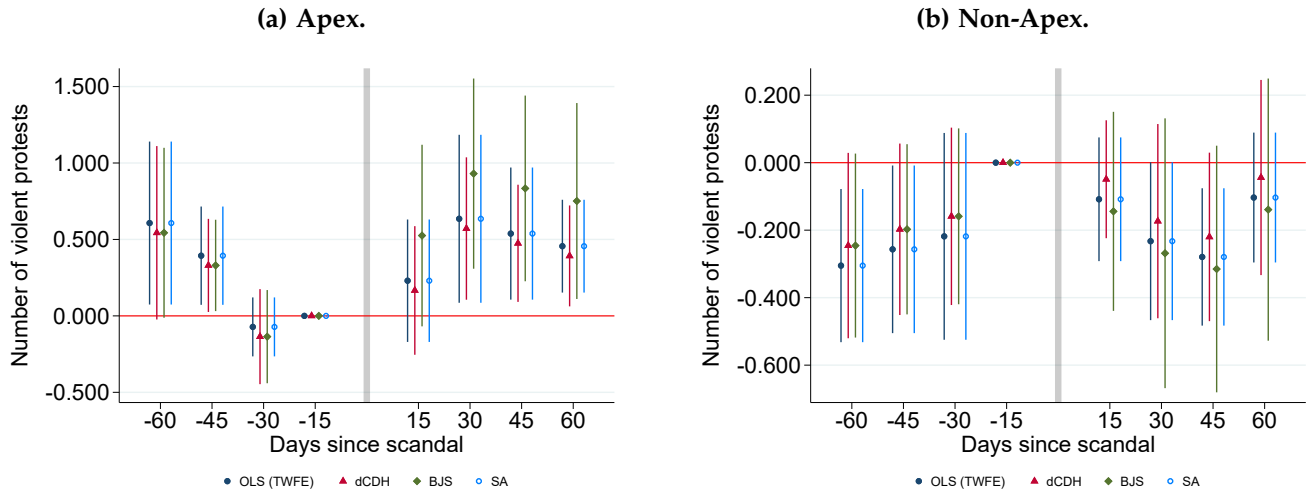
Table S11. Modern DiD estimators, stacked-by-scandal design.

<i>Panel A: Apex</i>								
	Violent Protests				Non-violent Protests			
	±30	±60	±90	±120	±30	±60	±90	±120
OLS (TWFE)	0.511** (0.219)	0.111 (0.091)	-0.005 (0.094)	0.021 (0.089)	0.011 (0.149)	-0.031 (0.114)	0.005 (0.095)	-0.141 (0.101)
dCDH	0.397** (0.160)	0.401*** (0.150)	0.220** (0.102)	0.108 (0.106)	-0.116 (0.230)	-0.078 (0.240)	-0.045 (0.224)	0.020 (0.218)
BJS	0.511** (0.199)	0.111 (0.089)	-0.005 (0.092)	0.021 (0.087)	0.011 (0.145)	-0.031 (0.109)	0.005 (0.090)	-0.141 (0.098)
SA	0.145 (0.146)	0.465*** (0.180)	0.349*** (0.131)	0.242*** (0.087)	-0.071 (0.125)	-0.076 (0.201)	-0.117 (0.208)	-0.068 (0.120)
Observations	5,770	9,504	12,857	15,402	5,770	9,504	12,857	15,402

<i>Panel B: Non-Apex</i>								
	Violent Protests				Non-violent Protests			
	±30	±60	±90	±120	±30	±60	±90	±120
OLS (TWFE)	-0.064 (0.121)	0.077 (0.115)	0.132 (0.100)	0.104 (0.071)	0.062 (0.327)	-0.048 (0.361)	-0.019 (0.282)	-0.011 (0.208)
dCDH	-0.107 (0.118)	-0.122 (0.127)	-0.004 (0.156)	0.057 (0.184)	0.088 (0.182)	-0.074 (0.213)	-0.156 (0.224)	-0.242 (0.234)
BJS	-0.064 (0.118)	0.077 (0.112)	0.132 (0.097)	0.104 (0.069)	0.062 (0.317)	-0.048 (0.350)	-0.019 (0.274)	-0.011 (0.203)
SA	0.001 (0.069)	-0.181** (0.088)	-0.150 (0.119)	-0.054 (0.112)	0.170 (0.171)	0.153 (0.184)	0.116 (0.157)	0.238 (0.150)
Observations	9,895	16,443	22,451	27,880	9,895	16,443	22,451	27,880

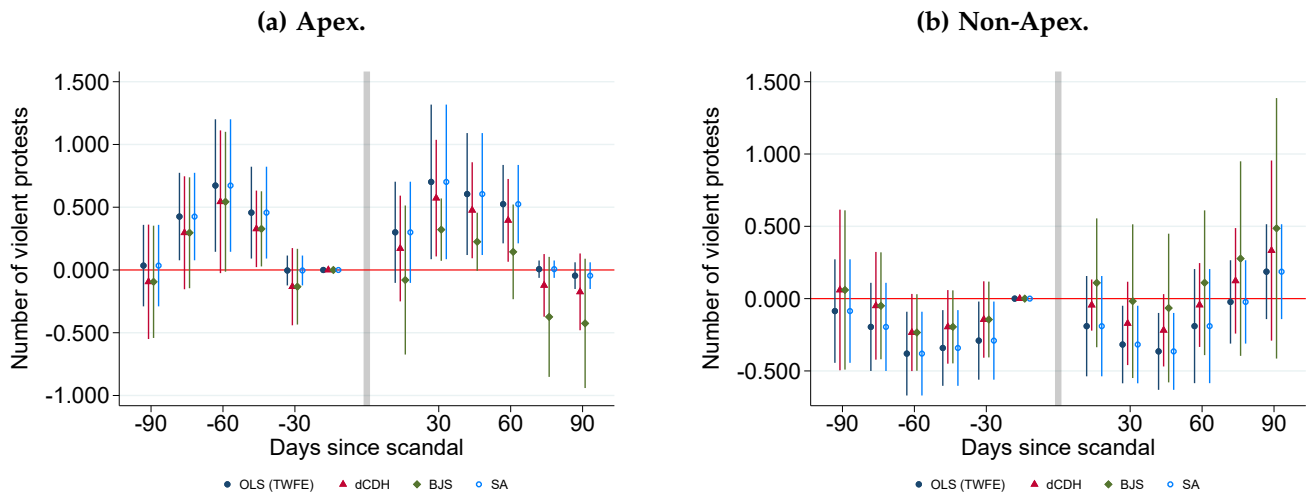
Static post-scandal coefficient (standard error) from four estimators—OLS two-way fixed effects (TWFE), de Chaisemartin–D’Haultfœuille (dCDH), Borusyak–Jaravel–Spiess (BJS), and Sun–Abraham (SA)—on the Cengiz-style stacked-by-scandal panel (country $\times$ 15-day bin; clean-control cohort = countries with no scandal of any type in the $\pm T$ window). Columns are two Mass-Mobilization outcomes—violent protests and non-violent protests—each at the ± 30 -, ± 60 -, ± 90 -, and ± 120 -day windows (2/4/6/8 bins per side). Standard errors clustered at the country level. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded. Significance: * $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Figure S16. Modern DiD event studies (violent protests), stacked-by-scandal design, ± 60 -day window.



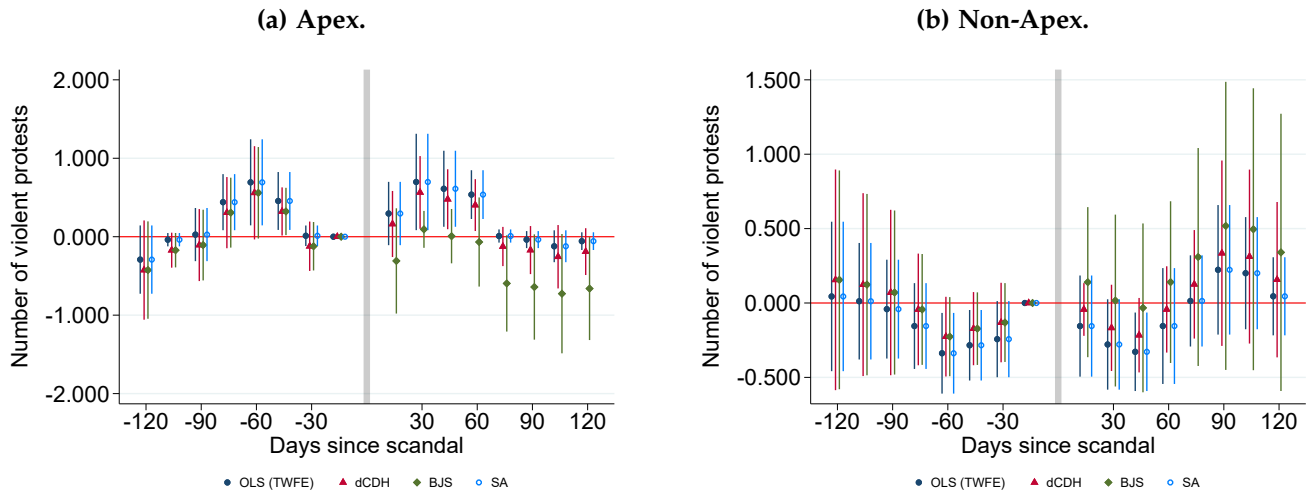
Event-study coefficients on violent protests from four estimators—OLS two-way fixed effects (TWFE), de Chaisemartin-D’Haultfœuille (dCDH), Borusyak-Jaravel-Spiess (BJS), and Sun-Abraham (SA)—overlaid, on the Cengiz-style stacked-by-scandal panel (country $\times$ 15-day bin, ± 60 -day window; clean-control cohort = countries with no scandal of any type in the window). The two panels are the Apex and Non-Apex subsamples; the time axis is in days (15-day bins) and the bin immediately before disclosure (-1) is the reference. Vertical bars are 90% confidence intervals; standard errors clustered at the country level. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

Figure S17. Modern DiD event studies (violent protests), stacked-by-scandal design, ± 90 -day window.



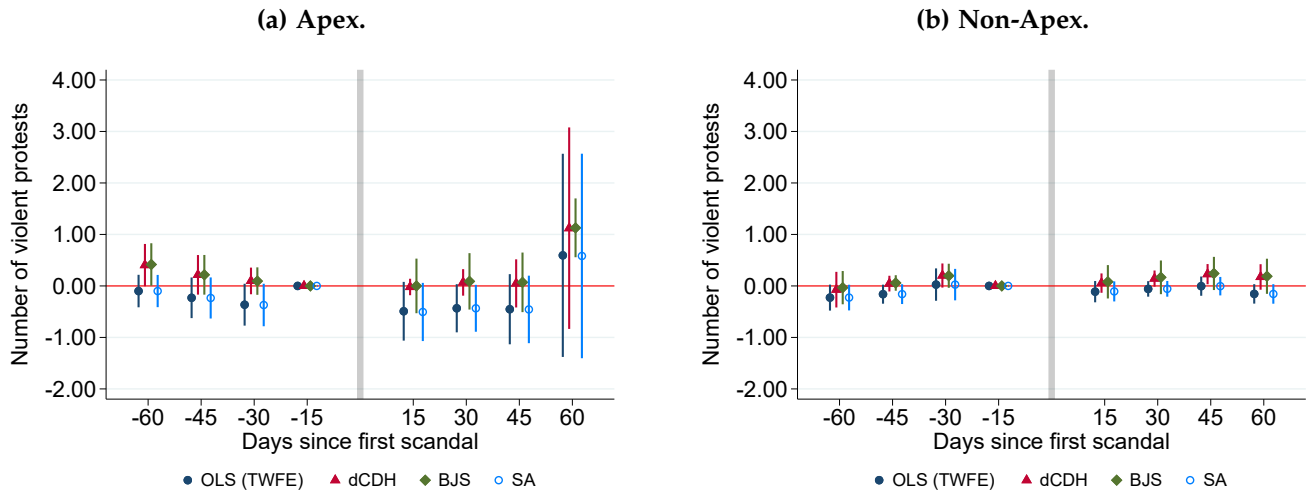
Event-study coefficients on violent protests from four estimators—OLS TWFE, dCDH, BJS, and SA—overlaid, on the Cengiz-style stacked-by-scandal panel (country $\times$ 15-day bin, ± 90 -day window; clean-control cohort = countries with no scandal of any type in the window). The two panels are the Apex and Non-Apex subsamples; time axis in days (15-day bins), reference bin -1 . Vertical bars are 90% confidence intervals; standard errors clustered at the country level. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

Figure S18. Modern DiD event studies (violent protests), stacked-by-scandal design, ± 120 -day window.



Event-study coefficients on violent protests from four estimators—OLS TWFE, dCDH, BJS, and SA—overlaid, on the Cengiz-style stacked-by-scandal panel (country $\times$ 15-day bin, ± 120 -day window; clean-control cohort = countries with no scandal of any type in the window). The two panels are the Apex and Non-Apex subsamples; time axis in days (15-day bins), reference bin -1 . Vertical bars are 90% confidence intervals; standard errors clustered at the country level. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

Figure S19. Modern DiD event studies (violent protests), 15-day bins, ± 60 -day window.



Event-study coefficients on violent protests from four estimators—OLS two-way fixed effects (TWFE), de Chaisemartin-D’Haultfoeuille (dCDH), Borusyak–Jaravel–Spiess (BJS), and Sun–Abraham (SA)—overlaid, estimated on the country $\times$ 15-day-bin staggered panel with treatment defined as each country’s first-scandal bin (never-treated cohort = countries with no subsample scandal), at the ± 60 -day window (4 bins per side). The two panels are the Apex and Non-Apex subsamples; the time axis is in days (15-day bins) and the bin immediately before disclosure (-1 , the 15 days before disclosure) is the reference. Vertical bars are 90% confidence intervals; standard errors clustered at the country level. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

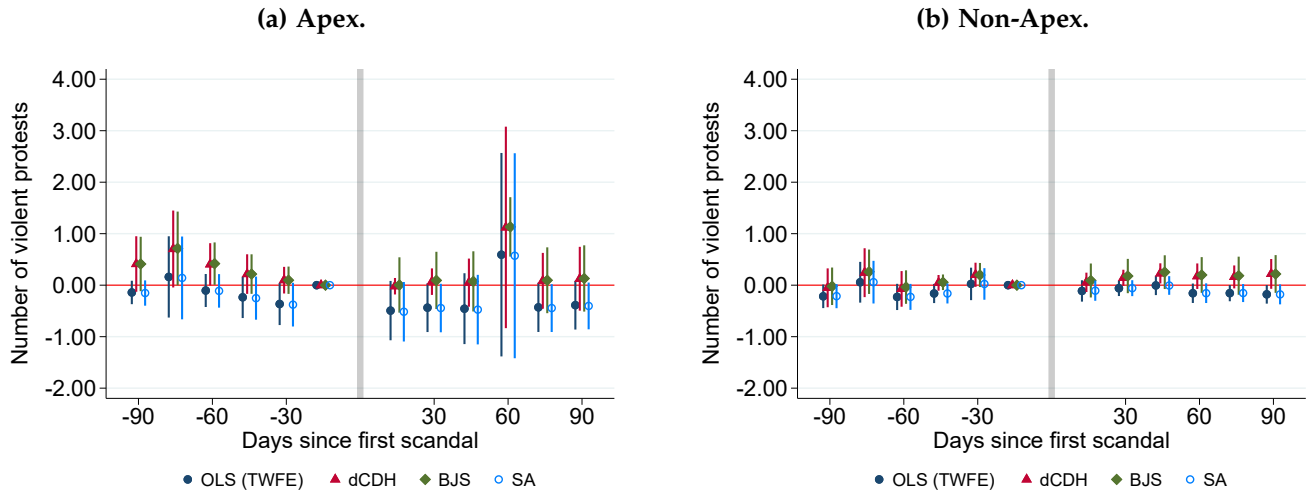
Table S12. Modern DiD estimators, 15-day-bin staggered design.

<i>Panel A: Apex</i>								
	Violent Protests				Non-violent Protests			
	±30	±60	±90	±120	±30	±60	±90	±120
OLS (TWFE)	-0.244 (0.180)	-0.244 (0.180)	-0.244 (0.180)	-0.244 (0.180)	-0.027 (0.168)	-0.027 (0.168)	-0.027 (0.168)	-0.027 (0.168)
dCDH	0.024 (0.116)	0.305 (0.367)	0.238 (0.317)	0.193 (0.315)	0.240 (0.307)	0.315 (0.306)	0.650 (0.607)	0.973 (0.751)
BJS	-0.211 (0.173)	-0.211 (0.173)	-0.211 (0.173)	-0.211 (0.173)	-0.028 (0.114)	-0.028 (0.114)	-0.028 (0.114)	-0.028 (0.114)
SA	-0.461* (0.259)	-0.204 (0.394)	-0.285 (0.307)	-0.337 (0.267)	-0.264 (0.277)	-0.200 (0.211)	0.201 (0.381)	0.565 (0.376)
Observations	6,453	6,453	6,453	6,453	6,453	6,453	6,453	6,453

<i>Panel B: Non-Apex</i>								
	Violent Protests				Non-violent Protests			
	±30	±60	±90	±120	±30	±60	±90	±120
OLS (TWFE)	-0.407 (0.282)	-0.407 (0.282)	-0.407 (0.282)	-0.407 (0.282)	0.253 (0.186)	0.253 (0.186)	0.253 (0.186)	0.253 (0.186)
dCDH	0.099 (0.093)	0.150 (0.094)	0.163 (0.107)	0.178 (0.123)	0.004 (0.188)	-0.399 (0.511)	-0.461 (0.635)	-0.519 (0.693)
BJS	-0.466** (0.222)	-0.466** (0.222)	-0.466** (0.222)	-0.466** (0.222)	0.048 (0.085)	0.048 (0.085)	0.048 (0.085)	0.048 (0.085)
SA	-0.081 (0.082)	-0.081 (0.066)	-0.110* (0.058)	-0.133** (0.059)	0.518 (0.582)	0.085 (0.309)	0.030 (0.216)	-0.021 (0.170)
Observations	6,752	6,752	6,752	6,752	6,752	6,752	6,752	6,752

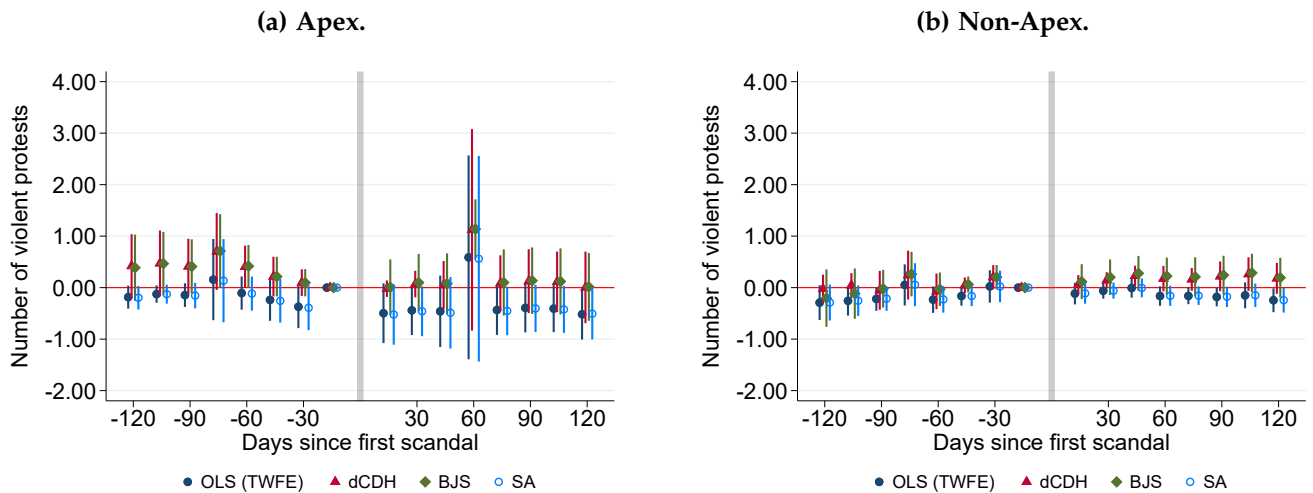
Static post-treatment coefficient (standard error) from four estimators—OLS two-way fixed effects (TWFE), de Chaisemartin–D’Haultfœuille (dCDH), Borusyak–Jaravel–Spiess (BJS), and Sun–Abraham (SA)—on the country $\times$ 15-day-bin staggered panel, with treatment defined as each country’s first-scandal bin. The control cohort is restricted to country-years with no scandal of any type, and protest counts are zero on no-protest days. Columns are two Mass-Mobilization outcomes—violent protests and non-violent protests—each at the ± 30 -, ± 60 -, ± 90 -, and ± 120 -day windows (2/4/6/8 bins per side). Standard errors clustered at the country level. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded. Significance: * $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Figure S20. Modern DiD event studies (violent protests), 15-day bins, ± 90 -day window.



Event-study coefficients on violent protests from four estimators—OLS TWFE, dCDH, BJS, and SA—overlaid, estimated on the country $\times$ 15-day-bin staggered panel with treatment defined as each country's first-scandal bin, at the ± 90 -day window (6 bins per side). The two panels are the Apex and Non-Apex subsamples; the time axis is in days (15-day bins) and the bin immediately before disclosure (-1) is the reference. Vertical bars are 90% confidence intervals; standard errors clustered at the country level. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

Figure S21. Modern DiD event studies (violent protests), 15-day bins, ± 120 -day window.

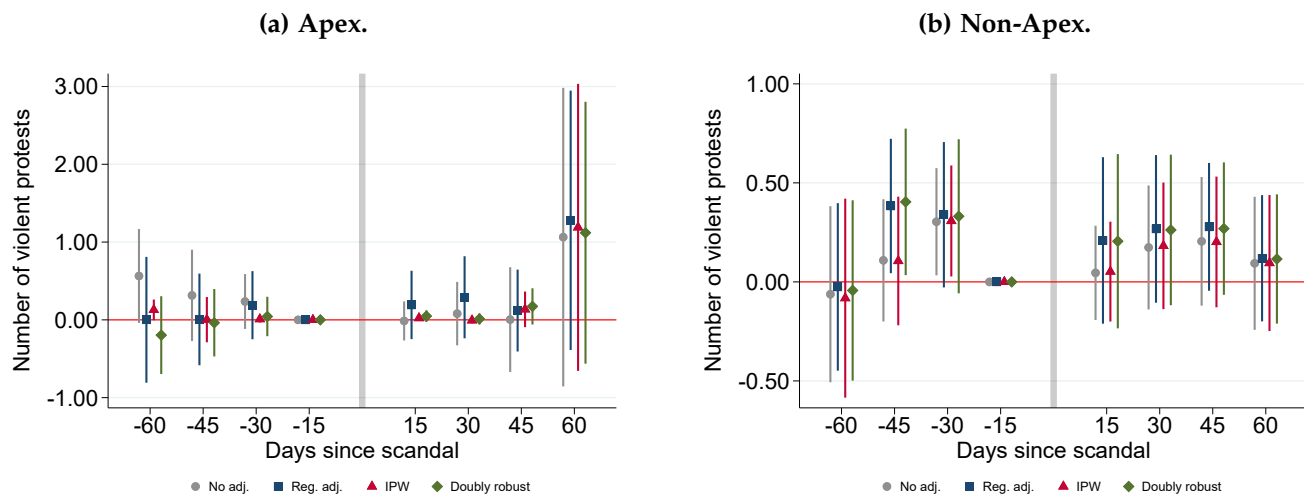


Event-study coefficients on violent protests from four estimators—OLS TWFE, dCDH, BJS, and SA—overlaid, estimated on the country $\times$ 15-day-bin staggered panel with treatment defined as each country's first-scandal bin, at the ± 120 -day window (8 bins per side). The two panels are the Apex and Non-Apex subsamples; the time axis is in days (15-day bins) and the bin immediately before disclosure (-1) is the reference. Vertical bars are 90% confidence intervals; standard errors clustered at the country level. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

S12 Selection-on-observables DiD: regression adjustment and reweighting

As a transparent complement to the heterogeneity-robust estimators of [Appendix S11](#), we condition on the pre-scandal outcome dynamics directly, in the spirit of Acemoglu, Naidu, Restrepo and Robinson ([Acemoglu et al. 2019](#)). [Table S13](#) reports the static (windowed) post-scandal effect from four nested specifications on the country $\times$ 15-day-bin staggered panel: no adjustment (two-way fixed effects), regression adjustment (adding four lags of the outcome), inverse-propensity weighting (reweighting the clean controls by their propensity of being a treated country given a baseline protest covariate), and doubly robust (both). [Figure S22](#) plots the corresponding violent-protest event studies. The apex effect is stable across all four adjustments and the pre-trend test is insignificant throughout.

Figure S22. Selection-on-observables DiD event studies (violent protests, ± 60 -day window).



Violent-protest event studies overlaying the four specifications—no adjustment, regression adjustment (four outcome lags), IPW, and doubly robust—on the country $\times$ 15-day-bin staggered panel, ± 60 -day window; the bin immediately before disclosure (-1) is the reference. Vertical bars are 90% confidence intervals; standard errors clustered at the country level. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

Table S13. Selection-on-observables DiD: windowed ATT and pre-trend test.

Apex sample						
	Violent Protests			Non-violent Protests		
	±60	±90	±120	±60	±90	±120
<i>Panel A: windowed ATT (average post-scandal effect)</i>						
No adjustment	0.283 (0.417)	0.272 (0.400)	0.229 (0.417)	0.302 (0.312)	0.678 (0.568)	1.048 (0.725)
Regression adj.	0.470 (0.369)	0.277 (0.275)	0.217 (0.262)	0.159 (0.146)	0.485 (0.383)	0.544 (0.360)
IPW	0.335 (0.315)	0.229 (0.209)	0.147 (0.166)	0.363 (0.244)	0.757 (0.533)	1.131 (0.709)
Doubly robust	0.338 (0.290)	0.114 (0.098)	0.048 (0.059)	0.183 (0.144)	0.520 (0.394)	0.595 (0.384)
<i>Panel B: pre-trend test, p-value (joint: all lead coefficients = 0)</i>						
No adjustment	0.483	0.548	0.763	0.761	0.376	0.276
Regression adj.	0.858	0.628	0.759	0.941	0.319	0.390
IPW	0.272	0.302	0.433	0.785	0.429	0.320
Doubly robust	0.860	0.370	0.076	0.940	0.283	0.395
Non-Apex sample						
	Violent Protests			Non-violent Protests		
	±60	±90	±120	±60	±90	±120
<i>Panel A: windowed ATT (average post-scandal effect)</i>						
No adjustment	0.130 (0.176)	0.106 (0.185)	0.079 (0.162)	-0.278 (0.542)	-0.350 (0.672)	-0.396 (0.716)
Regression adj.	0.219 (0.203)	0.200 (0.196)	0.179 (0.170)	-0.006 (0.364)	0.039 (0.369)	0.063 (0.378)
IPW	0.133 (0.179)	0.108 (0.189)	0.092 (0.178)	-0.045 (0.713)	-0.095 (0.832)	-0.144 (0.871)
Doubly robust	0.213 (0.208)	0.193 (0.202)	0.181 (0.184)	0.094 (0.516)	0.111 (0.533)	0.117 (0.527)
<i>Panel B: pre-trend test, p-value (joint: all lead coefficients = 0)</i>						
No adjustment	0.209	0.439	0.602	0.232	0.262	0.232
Regression adj.	0.275	0.536	0.377	0.124	0.255	0.404
IPW	0.239	0.481	0.622	0.345	0.409	0.317
Doubly robust	0.321	0.584	0.453	0.159	0.259	0.441

Windowed post-scandal ATT (Panel A) and the joint pre-trend p -value (Panel B, testing that all pre-period lead coefficients are zero) from four specifications—no adjustment (TWFE), regression adjustment (four outcome lags), inverse-propensity weighting, and doubly robust—on the country $\times$ 15-day-bin staggered panel (treatment = each country's first-scandal bin; clean controls = scandal-free country-years). Columns are violent and non-violent protests at the $\pm 60/\pm 90/\pm 120$ -day windows. Standard errors clustered at the country level. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded. Significance: * $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

S13 Regression discontinuity in event time

An alternative to the event-study and difference-in-differences designs treats the scandal disclosure as a *regression discontinuity in time*: the running variable is the number of days since the scandal ($w_{s,t}$), the cutoff is the disclosure date ($w_{s,t} = 0$), and treatment is $\text{Post}_{st} = \mathbf{1}\{w_{s,t} \geq 0\}$. A polynomial in the running variable, allowed to differ on each side of the cutoff, models the smooth pre- and post-scandal trend; the discontinuity at 0 is the immediate effect of disclosure, net of that trend. This handles the incoming pre-scandal trend transparently and needs none of the staggered-DiD machinery.

Table S14 reports the estimated jump for the apex and non-apex subsamples, on violent and peaceful protests, for bandwidths $h \in \{30, 60, 90\}$ days and local-linear and local-quadratic polynomials. The local-linear estimate—the standard, and preferred over higher-order polynomials—shows a clear positive discontinuity in violent protests for apex scandals (0.034 at $h = 30$, 0.067 at $h = 60$) and no discontinuity for non-apex scandals or on the peaceful margin. Figure S23 plots the two violent-protest discontinuities: for apex scandals the residualised protest count jumps sharply upward at disclosure, whereas for non-apex scandals the fit is continuous through the cutoff. Reassuringly, the apex pre-scandal trend is, if anything, *downward*, so the upward jump is not an artefact of a rising pre-trend.

Table S14. Regression discontinuity in event time: jump at disclosure.

	Violent Protests			Peaceful Protests		
	$h = 30$	$h = 60$	$h = 90$	$h = 30$	$h = 60$	$h = 90$
<i>Apex</i>						
Local linear	0.034 (0.022)	0.066*** (0.018)	0.056*** (0.016)	0.008 (0.018)	0.008 (0.016)	0.000 (0.014)
Local quadratic	0.038 (0.032)	0.024 (0.024)	0.067*** (0.024)	0.009 (0.022)	0.000 (0.022)	0.012 (0.021)
<i>Non-Apex</i>						
Local linear	0.004 (0.014)	-0.005 (0.008)	-0.001 (0.010)	-0.012 (0.022)	0.010 (0.020)	0.007 (0.021)
Local quadratic	0.013 (0.020)	0.006 (0.016)	-0.005 (0.014)	-0.013 (0.025)	-0.011 (0.031)	0.003 (0.031)

Estimated discontinuity (τ , standard error in parentheses) in the daily protest count at the disclosure cutoff ($w_{s,t} = 0$), from $Y_{c(s)t} = \tau \text{Post}_{st} + f(w_{s,t}) + \text{Post}_{st} \cdot g(w_{s,t}) + \alpha_d + \lambda_m + \theta_{cy} + \varepsilon_{c(s)t}$, where the polynomials f, g are local-linear or local-quadratic in the running variable and, the running variable being centred at 0, the coefficient on Post is exactly the jump at the cutoff. Estimated separately on the apex and non-apex subsamples, on violent and peaceful protest counts, at bandwidths $h \in \{30, 60, 90\}$ days. All specifications include country-by-year, month-of-year, and day-of-week fixed effects; standard errors clustered at the country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin level. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded. Significance: * $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

The result is robust to the polynomial choice—the local-quadratic estimates are in Table S14, and Figure S24 plots the corresponding local-quadratic fits, which likewise jump upward at disclosure for apex scandals only—and to a fully non-parametric fit. Table S15 reports local-polynomial regression-

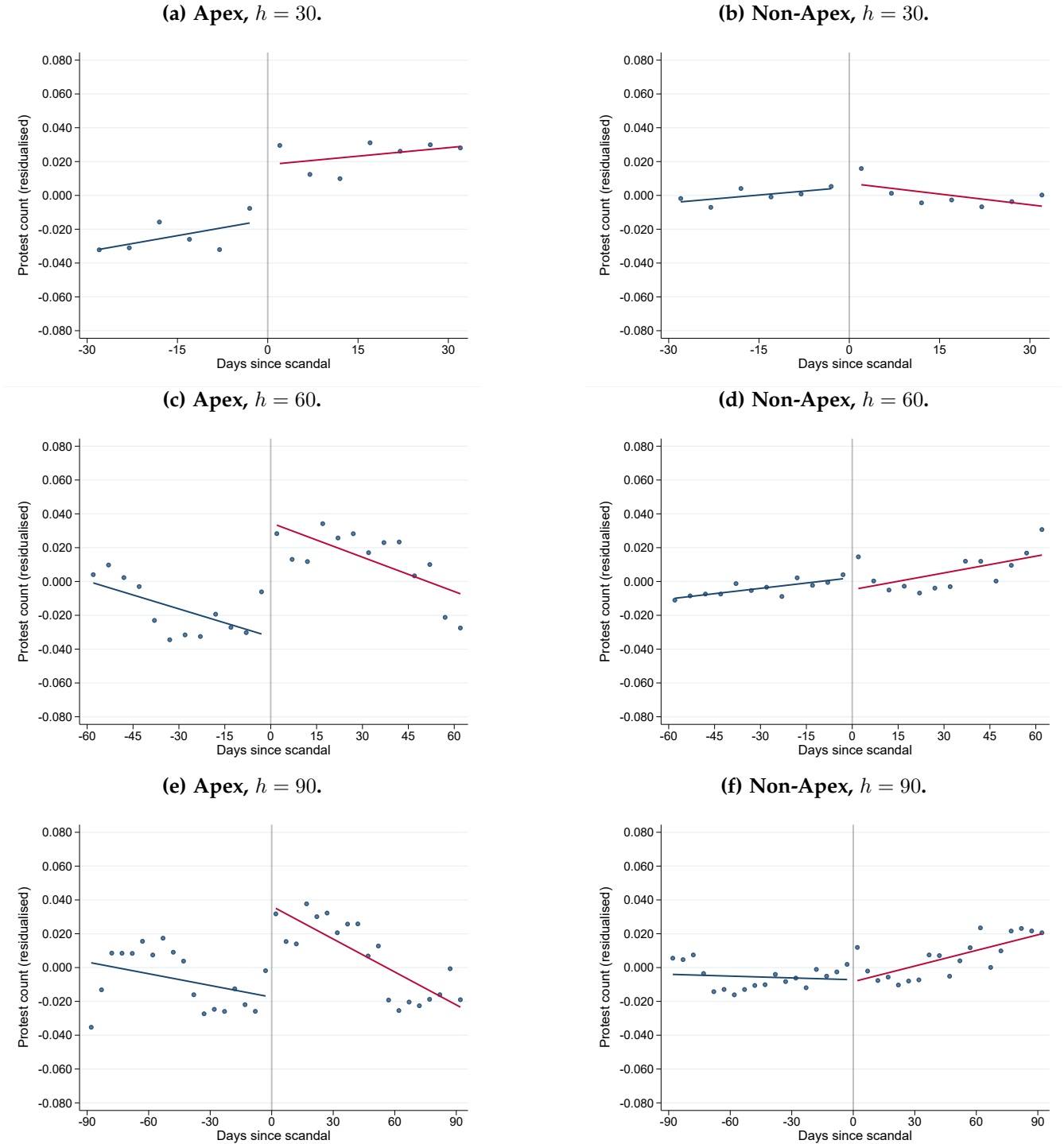
discontinuity estimates (Calonico et al. 2014) at the $\pm 30/60/90$ -day windows, each with its own MSE-optimal, data-driven bandwidth and a triangular kernel, and Figure S25 shows the corresponding local-linear fits with 90% confidence bands. The apex violent discontinuity is positive at every window; with the wider robust confidence bands it is not always individually significant, while the non-apex and peaceful estimates remain null throughout.

Table S15. Regression discontinuity in event time: non-parametric estimate.

	Violent Protests			Peaceful Protests		
	$h = 30$	$h = 60$	$h = 90$	$h = 30$	$h = 60$	$h = 90$
Apex	0.029 (0.031)	0.031 (0.029)	0.030 (0.029)	-0.002 (0.021)	0.004 (0.021)	0.006 (0.021)
Non-Apex	0.012 (0.016)	0.008 (0.017)	0.007 (0.018)	-0.010 (0.023)	-0.013 (0.030)	-0.012 (0.033)

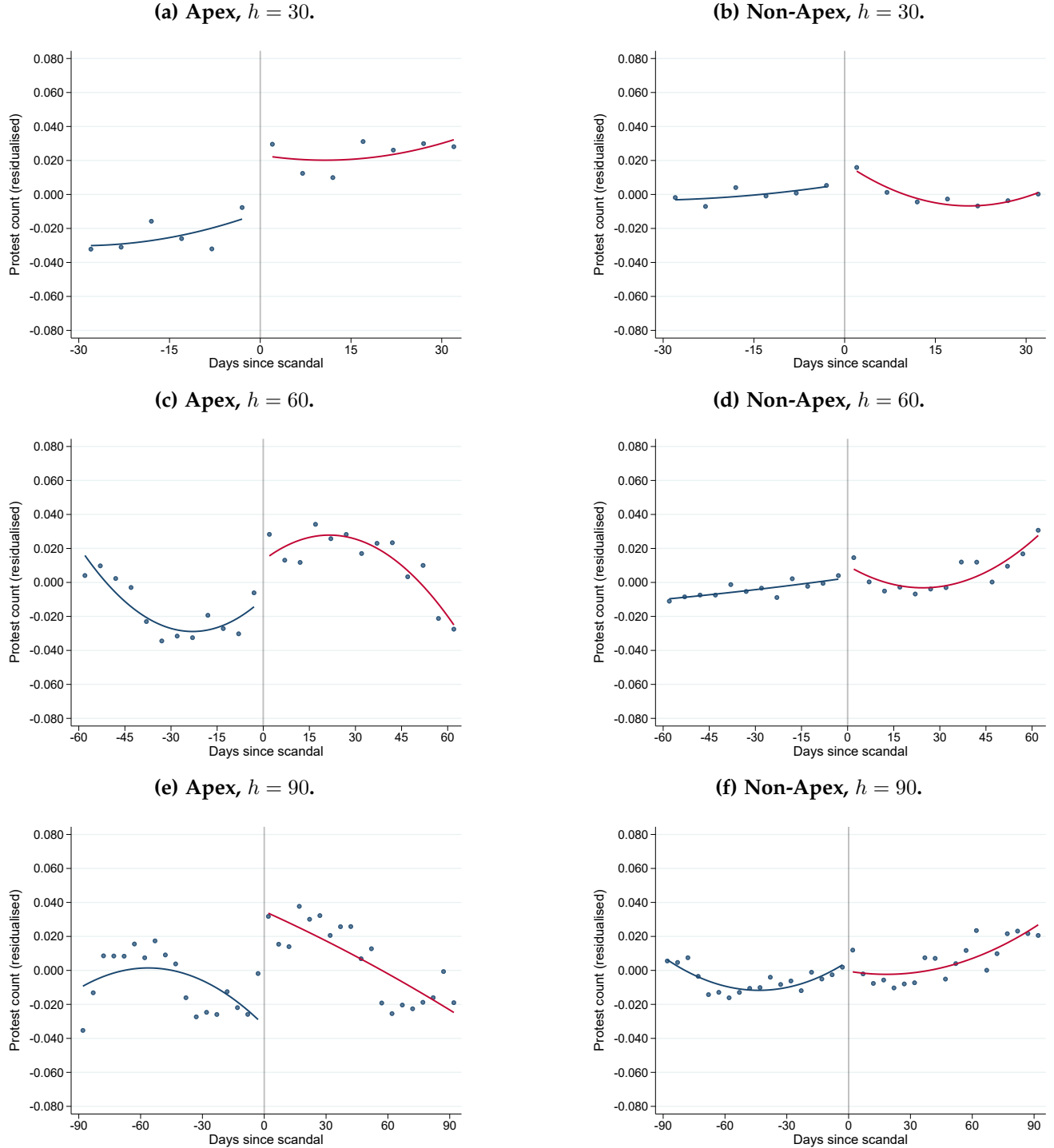
Local-polynomial (local-linear) regression-discontinuity estimate of the jump in the daily protest count at the disclosure cutoff, computed with `rdrobust` (Calonico et al. 2014): triangular kernel, on the outcome residualised on the country-by-year, month-of-year, and day-of-week fixed effects. Estimation is restricted to a ± 30 , ± 60 , or ± 90 day window (columns $h = 30/60/90$), and within each window `rdrobust` selects its own MSE-optimal data-driven bandwidth. Standard errors (in parentheses), clustered at the country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin level, are the robust bias-corrected standard errors. Estimated separately on the apex and non-apex subsamples, on violent and peaceful protest counts. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded. Significance: * $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Figure S23. Regression discontinuity in event time, violent protests, at $h = 30/60/90$ -day bandwidths.



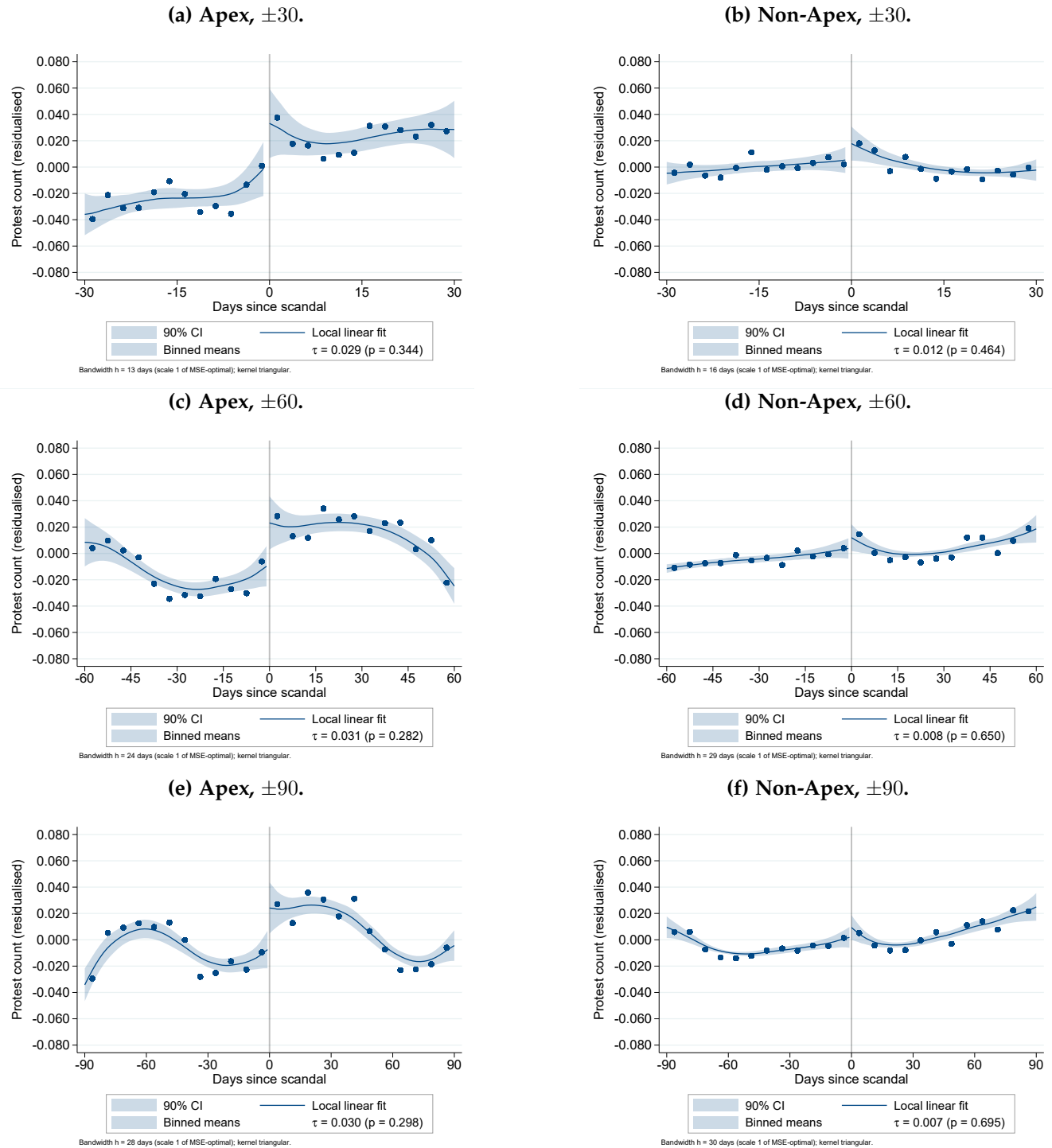
Binned means of the violent-protest count—residualised on the country-by-year, month-of-year, and day-of-week fixed effects—in 5-day bins of the running variable (days since scandal), with local-linear fits on each side of the disclosure cutoff, at the $h = 30$ (top row), $h = 60$ (middle), and $h = 90$ (bottom) bandwidths. For apex scandals (left column) the count jumps upward at $w_{s,t} = 0$ at every bandwidth; for non-apex scandals (right column) the fit is continuous through the cutoff. All regression-discontinuity figures share a common vertical scale so the discontinuities can be compared by eye. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

Figure S24. Regression discontinuity in event time, local-quadratic fit, violent protests, at $h = 30/60/90$ -day bandwidths.



As [Figure S23](#), but with local-quadratic fits on each side of the disclosure cutoff, at the $h = 30$ (top row), $h = 60$ (middle), and $h = 90$ (bottom) bandwidths. Binned means of the violent-protest count, residualised on the country-by-year, month-of-year, and day-of-week fixed effects, in 5-day bins of the running variable. For apex scandals (left column) the count jumps upward at $w_{s,t} = 0$; for non-apex scandals (right column) the fit is continuous through the cutoff. Common vertical scale across all regression-discontinuity figures. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

Figure S25. Regression discontinuity in event time, non-parametric fit, violent protests, at $\pm 30/60/90$ -day windows.



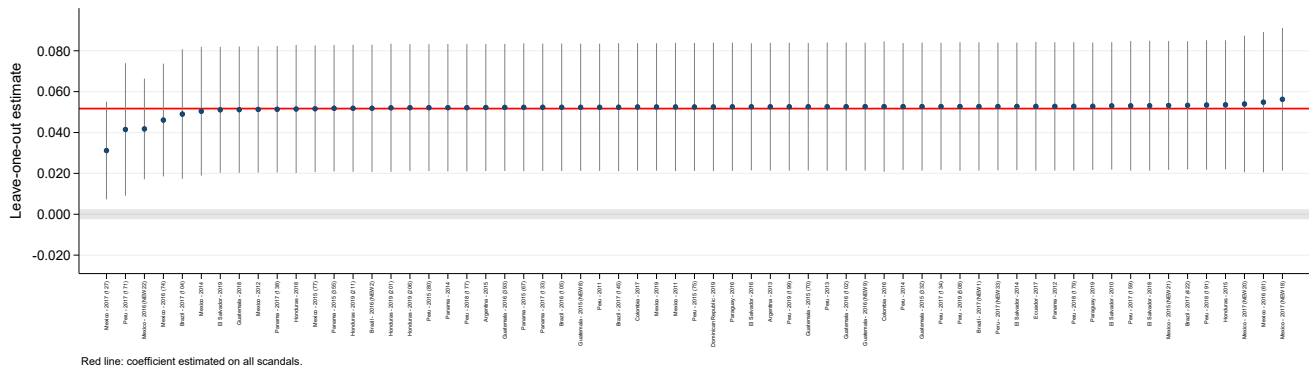
Local-linear fits (triangular kernel, MSE-optimal data-driven bandwidth) with 90% confidence bands, and binned means (12 per side), of the violent-protest count residualised on the country-by-year, month-of-year, and day-of-week fixed effects, on each side of the disclosure cutoff. Each row restricts estimation to a ± 30 (top), ± 60 (middle), or ± 90 (bottom) day window, within which `rdrobust` selects its own MSE-optimal bandwidth; the legend reports the resulting discontinuity estimate τ and its p -value. Apex scandals in the left column, non-apex in the right. Common vertical scale across all regression-discontinuity figures. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

S14 Leave-one-out robustness by scandal

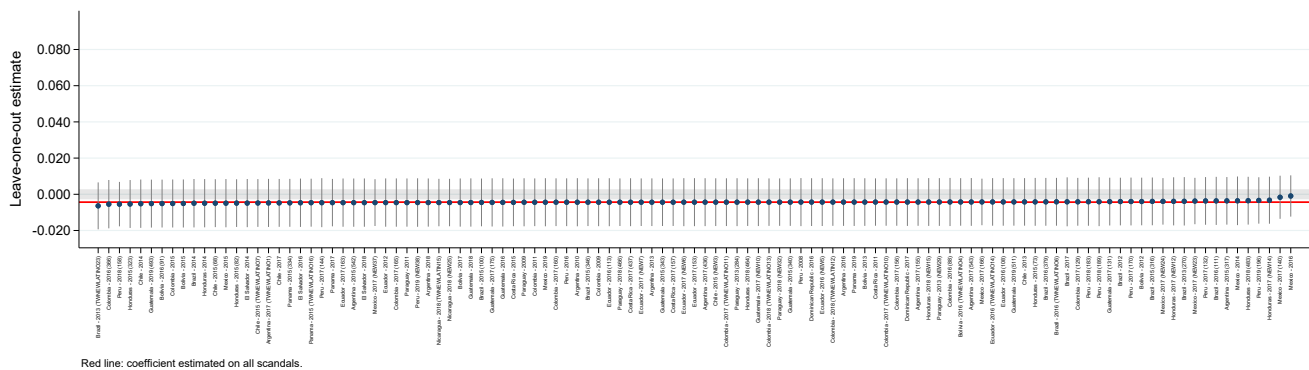
We re-estimate each coefficient on violent protests in the ± 30 -day window, dropping one scandal's event window at a time, for three different splits of the scandals: by scandal type (Apex vs. Non-Apex, Figure S26); by the rank hierarchy of Table S4 (President / Other Apex / Non-Apex, Figure S27); and by the 2008 democracy tercile of the scandal's country (High / Medium / Low, Figure S28). In every case no single scandal drives its coefficient—the leave-one-out estimates cluster tightly on the full-sample line (red). For the apex effect, removing the single most influential scandal lowers β_{Apex} from about 0.048 to 0.029 but leaves it clearly positive. Within each split the panels share a common vertical axis so the magnitudes are directly comparable.

Figure S26. Leave-one-out by scandal type.

(a) Apex: β_{Apex} (Post $\times$ Apex), dropping each apex scandal.



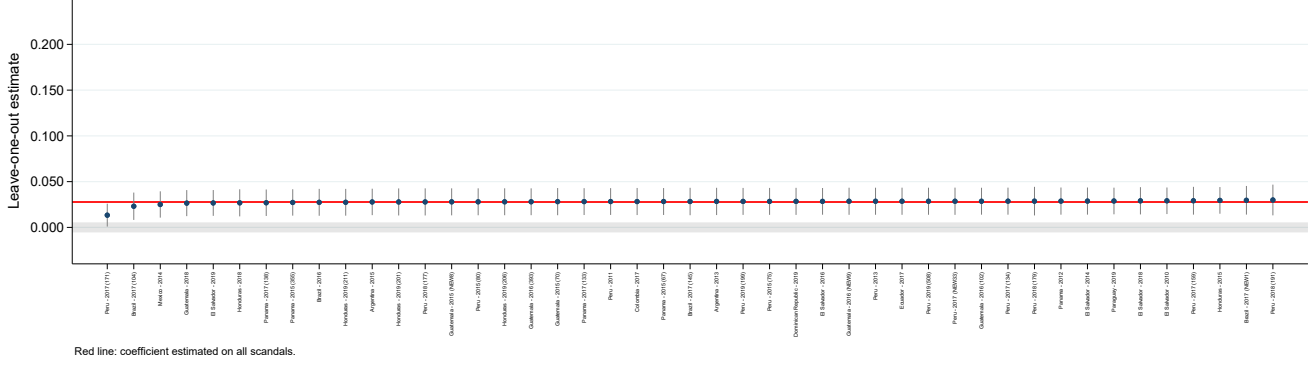
(b) Non-Apex: $\beta_{\text{Non-Apex}}$ (Post $\times$ Non-Apex), dropping each non-apex scandal.



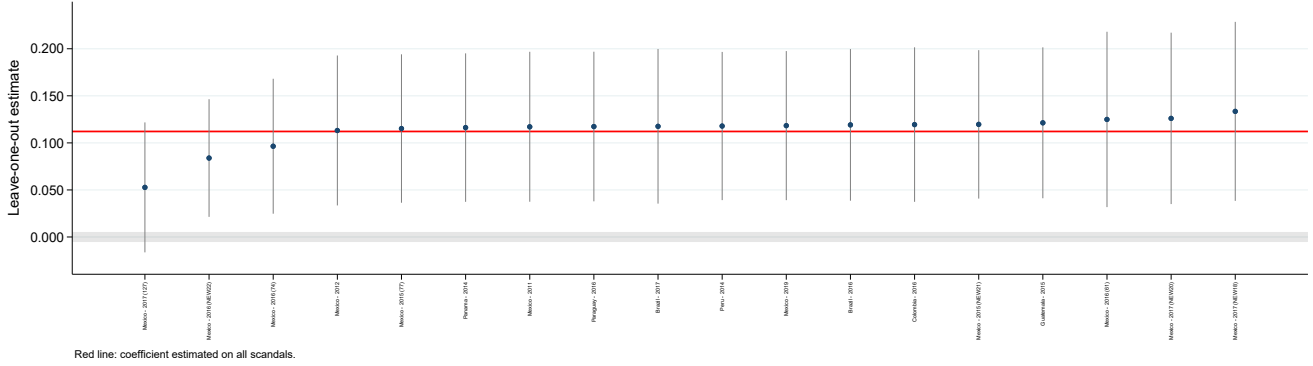
Leave-one-out estimates of the two-group interaction coefficients (??) on violent protests, ± 30 -day window. Each point re-estimates the panel's coefficient—Post $\times$ Apex in (a), Post $\times$ Non-Apex in (b)—dropping the labelled scandal's event window; panel (a) leaves out each of the 63 apex scandals, panel (b) each of the 113 non-apex scandals. Vertical bars are 90% confidence intervals; scandals (x-axis, Country – Year) are sorted by the estimate. The red line is the coefficient on all scandals and the faint line marks zero; the two panels share a common vertical scale. Standard errors clustered at country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

Figure S27. Leave-one-out by rank hierarchy (as in Table S4).

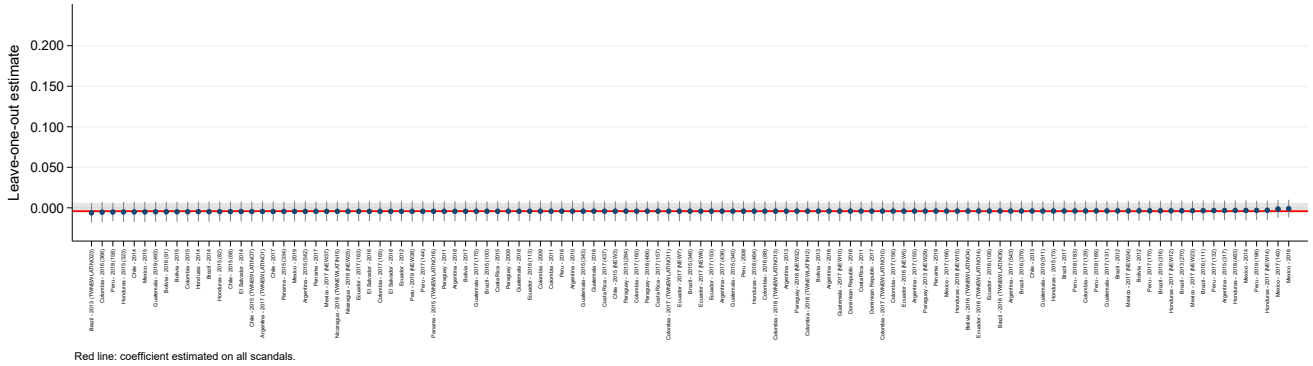
(a) President: $\beta_{\text{President}}$, dropping each Presidential scandal.



(b) Other Apex: $\beta_{\text{Other Apex}}$, dropping each Other-Apex scandal.

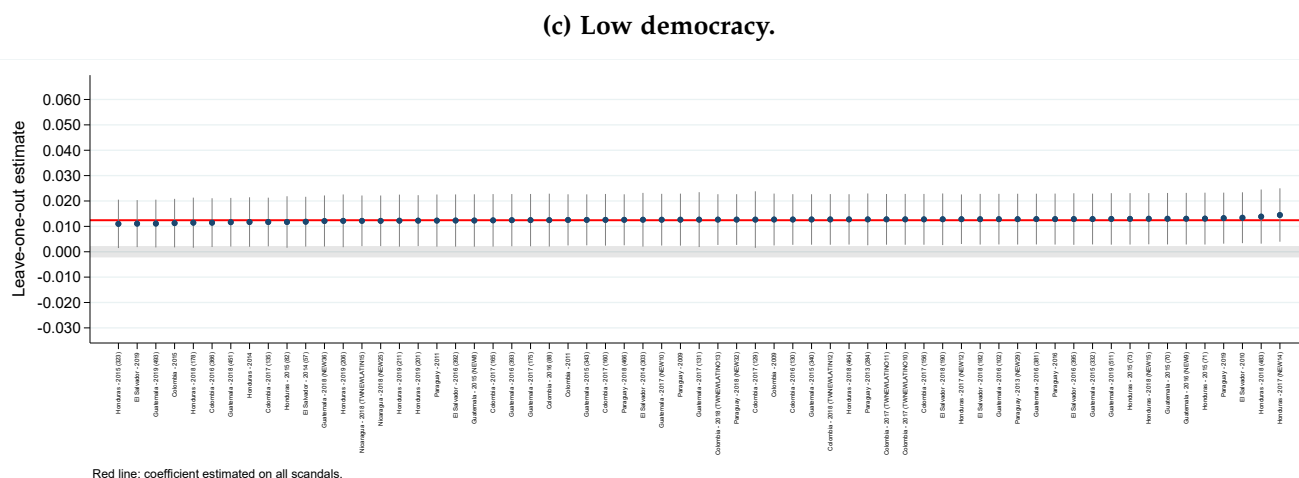


(c) Other Non-Apex: $\beta_{\text{Other Non-Apex}}$, dropping each Non-Apex scandal.



Leave-one-out estimates of the three category coefficients of the hierarchy regression (Table S4): Post $\times$ President, Post $\times$ Other Apex, and Post $\times$ Other Non-Apex, on violent protests, ± 30 -day window, each re-estimated dropping the labelled scandal in that category. Vertical bars are 90% confidence intervals; the red line is the coefficient on all scandals and the faint line marks zero; the three panels share a common vertical scale. Standard errors clustered at country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

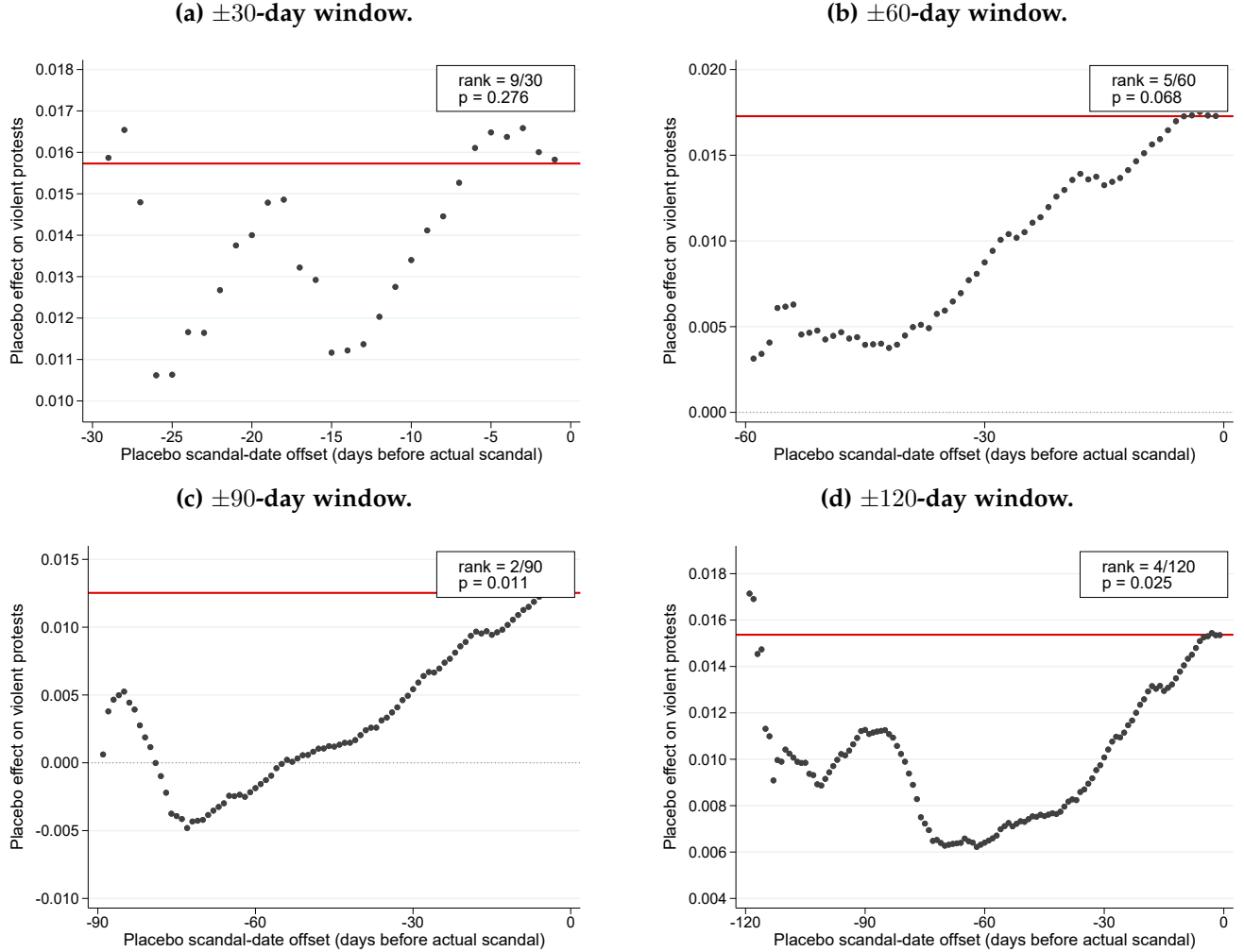
(a) High democracy, dropping each high-democracy-country scandal.



S15 Placebo test: an enumerated pre-scandal cutoff

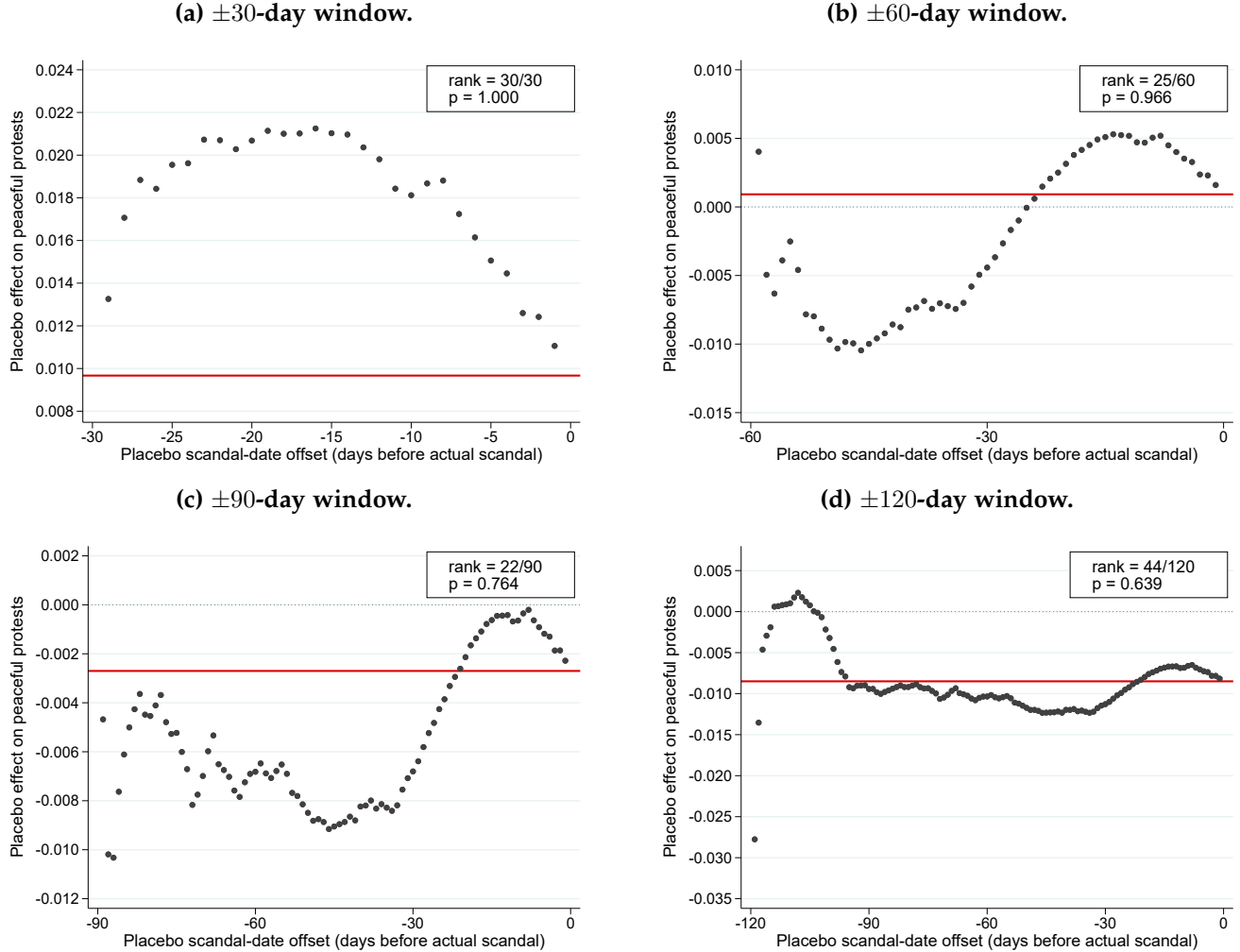
If the effect really begins at the public-disclosure date and there is no anticipation, then artificially placing the post-scandal cutoff at a *pre*-scandal day within the same event window should yield null coefficients. For every offset $k \in \{-T + 1, \dots, -1\}$ we redefine $\widetilde{\text{Post}}_{st} = \mathbf{1}\{w_{st} \geq k\}$ and re-estimate the OLS specification on the original event-window sample—no country-day is added or removed, only the treatment cutoff is shifted into the pre-scandal window. [Figure S29](#) plots the resulting placebo coefficients $\hat{\beta}(k)$ against k for the full sample; [Figures S31](#) and [S33](#) repeat the exercise on the two subsamples of [Table 2](#). The observed $\hat{\beta}$ (red horizontal line) sits above the pre-scandal placebo series for violent protests—most clearly for the Apex subsample—and near zero for peaceful protests.

Figure S29. Placebo test, full sample: violent protests, $\hat{\beta}(k)$ under an enumerated pre-scandal cutoff.



Enumerated pre-scandal cutoff placebo test for violent protests on the full sample of 176 scandals. For each offset $k \in \{-T + 1, \dots, -1\}$ we replace the true post-scandal indicator with $\widetilde{\text{Post}}_{st} = \mathbf{1}\{w_{st} \geq k\}$ —sliding the treatment cutoff to a pre-scandal day—and re-estimate Equation 1 on the $\pm T$ event window, adding or removing no country-day. Gray circles are the resulting placebo coefficients $\hat{\beta}(k)$ plotted against k ; the solid red line is the observed $\hat{\beta}$, the full-sample violent estimate at the $\pm T$ window; the legend gives the rank of the observed estimate among the placebos and the two-sided p -value. The four panels correspond to $T \in \{30, 60, 90, 120\}$ days. Standard errors clustered at country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

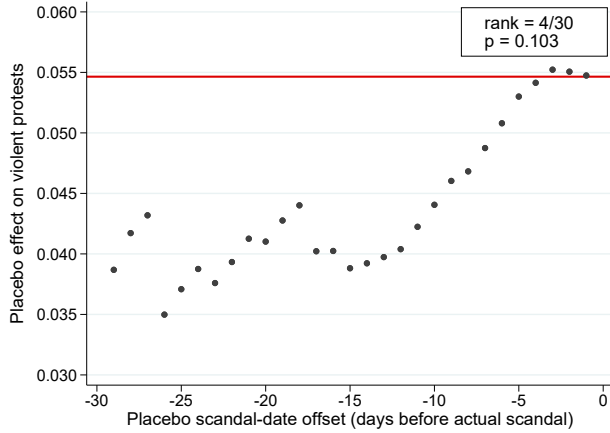
Figure S30. Placebo test, full sample: peaceful protests.



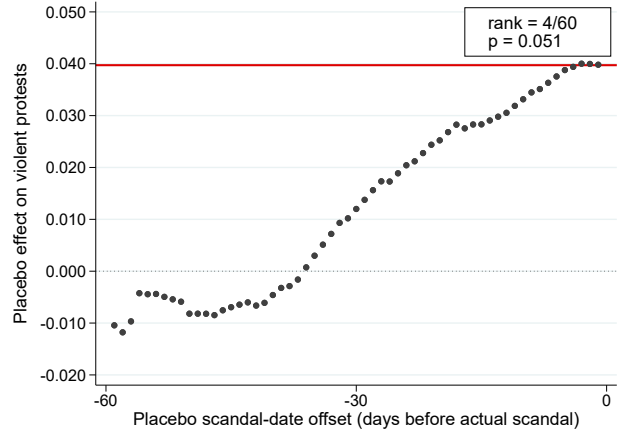
Enumerated pre-scandal cutoff placebo test for peaceful protests on the full sample of 176 scandals. For each offset $k \in \{-T + 1, \dots, -1\}$ we replace the true post-scandal indicator with $\widetilde{\text{Post}}_{st} = \mathbf{1}\{w_{st} \geq k\}$ —sliding the treatment cutoff to a pre-scandal day—and re-estimate Equation 1 on the $\pm T$ event window. Gray circles are the resulting placebo coefficients $\hat{\beta}(k)$ plotted against k ; the solid red line is the observed $\hat{\beta}$, the full-sample peaceful estimate at the $\pm T$ window; the legend gives the rank of the observed estimate among the placebos and the two-sided p -value. The four panels correspond to $T \in \{30, 60, 90, 120\}$ days. Standard errors clustered at country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

Figure S31. Placebo test, Apex subsample: violent protests.

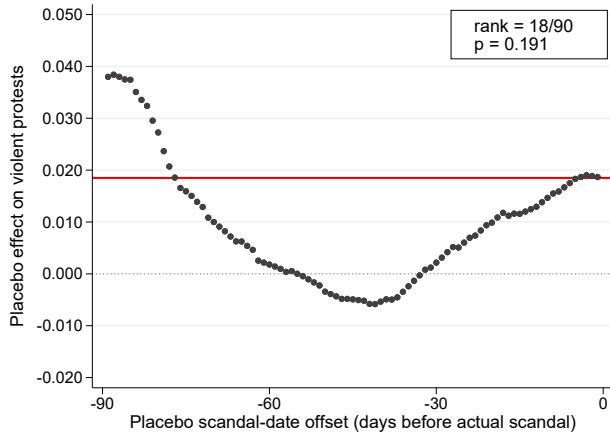
(a) ± 30 -day window.



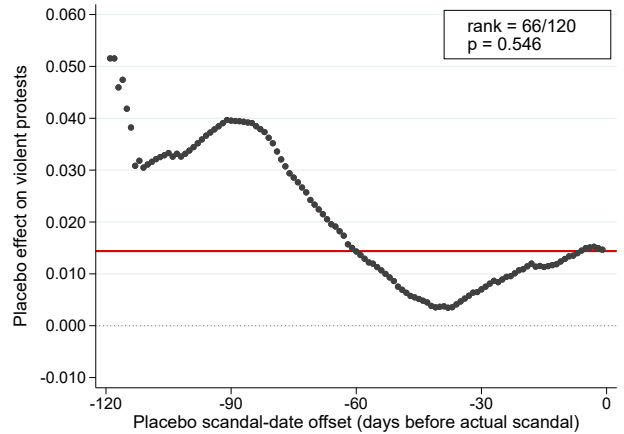
(b) ± 60 -day window.



(c) ± 90 -day window.



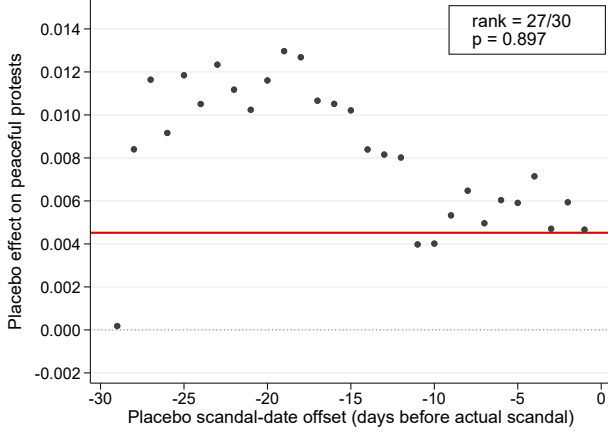
(d) ± 120 -day window.



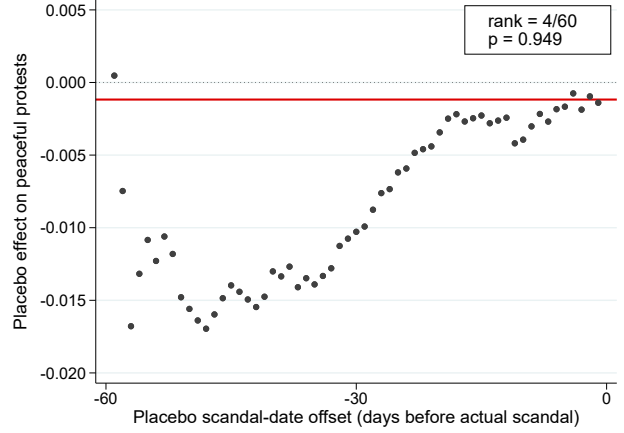
Enumerated pre-scandal cutoff placebo test for violent protests on the Apex subsample (63 scandals). For each offset $k \in \{-T + 1, \dots, -1\}$ we replace the true post-scandal indicator with $\widetilde{\text{Post}}_{st} = \mathbf{1}\{w_{st} \geq k\}$ —sliding the treatment cutoff to a pre-scandal day—and re-estimate Equation 1 on the $\pm T$ event window. Gray circles are the resulting placebo coefficients $\hat{\beta}(k)$ plotted against k ; the solid red line is the observed $\hat{\beta}$, the apex-subsample violent estimate at the $\pm T$ window; the legend gives the rank of the observed estimate among the placebos and the two-sided p -value. The four panels correspond to $T \in \{30, 60, 90, 120\}$ days. Standard errors clustered at country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

Figure S32. Placebo test, Apex subsample: peaceful protests.

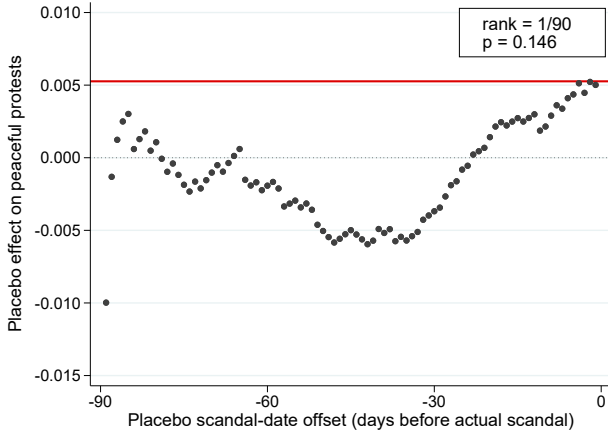
(a) ± 30 -day window.



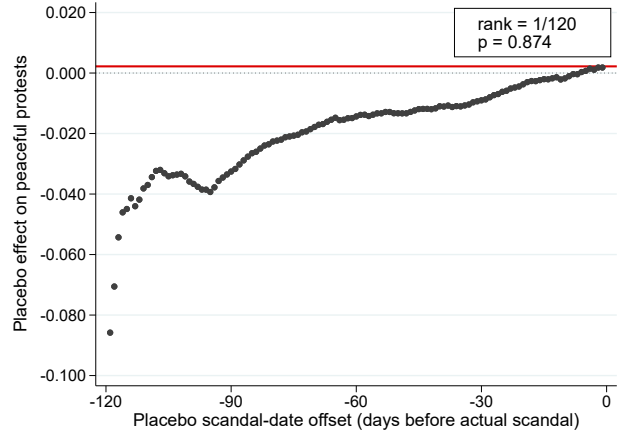
(b) ± 60 -day window.



(c) ± 90 -day window.



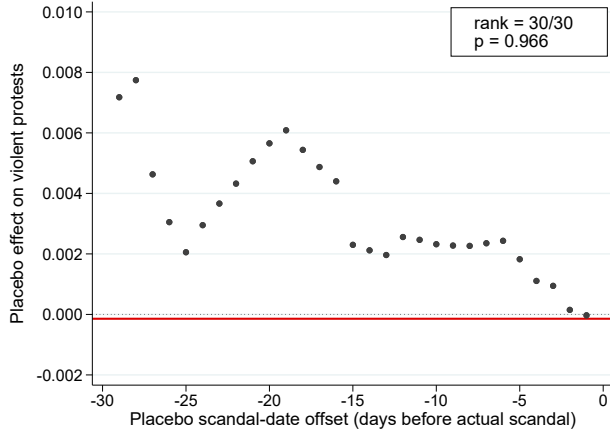
(d) ± 120 -day window.



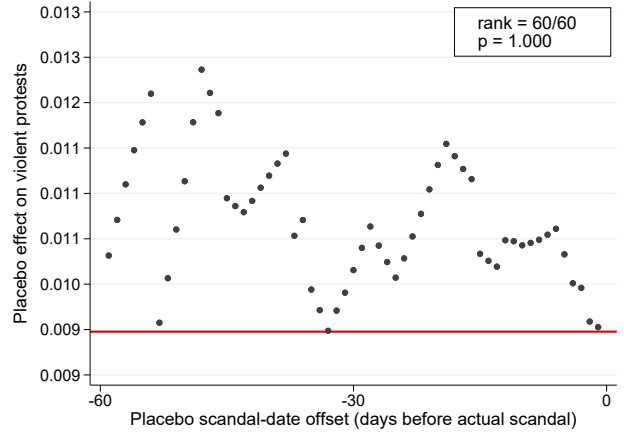
Enumerated pre-scandal cutoff placebo test for peaceful protests on the Apex subsample (63 scandals). For each offset $k \in \{-T + 1, \dots, -1\}$ we replace the true post-scandal indicator with $\widetilde{\text{Post}}_{st} = \mathbf{1}\{w_{st} \geq k\}$ —sliding the treatment cutoff to a pre-scandal day—and re-estimate Equation 1 on the $\pm T$ event window. Gray circles are the resulting placebo coefficients $\hat{\beta}(k)$ plotted against k ; the solid red line is the observed $\hat{\beta}$, the apex-subsample peaceful estimate at the $\pm T$ window; the legend gives the rank of the observed estimate among the placebos and the two-sided p -value. The four panels correspond to $T \in \{30, 60, 90, 120\}$ days. Standard errors clustered at country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

Figure S33. Placebo test, Non-Apex subsample: violent protests.

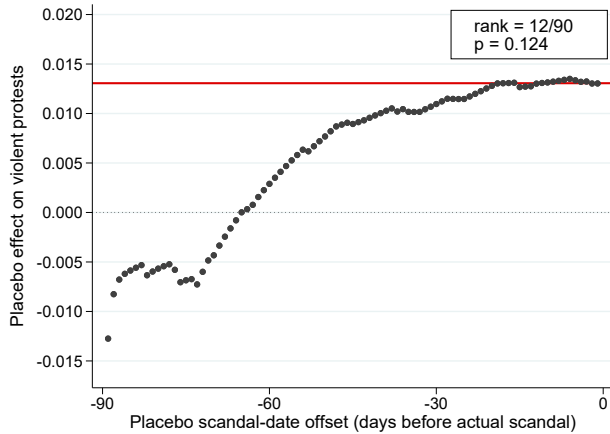
(a) ± 30 -day window.



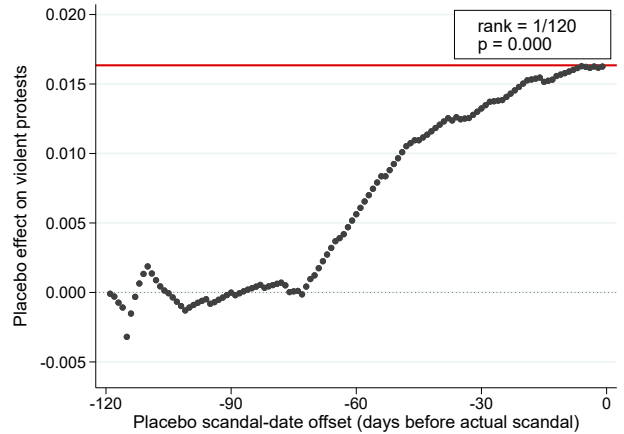
(b) ± 60 -day window.



(c) ± 90 -day window.



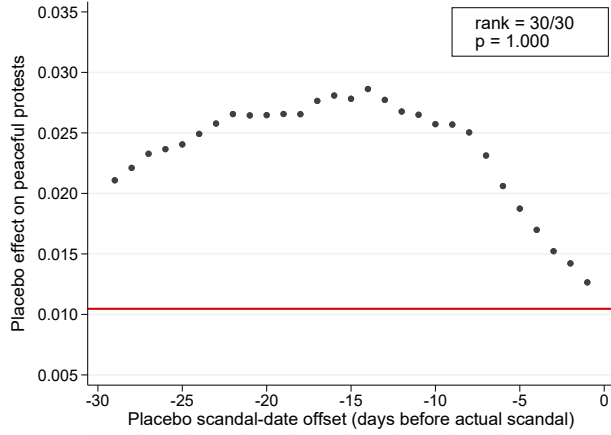
(d) ± 120 -day window.



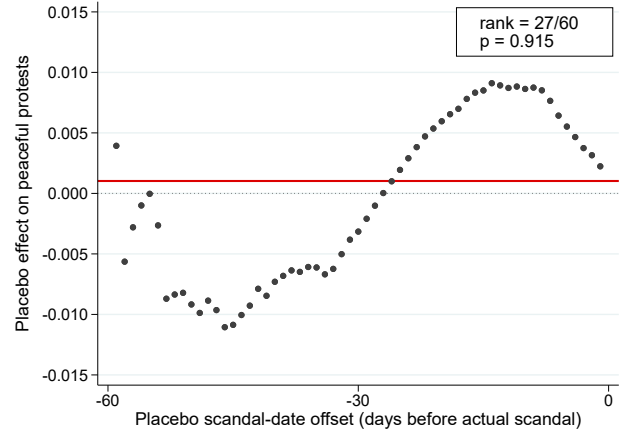
Enumerated pre-scandal cutoff placebo test for violent protests on the Non-Apex subsample (113 scandals). For each offset $k \in \{-T + 1, \dots, -1\}$ we replace the true post-scandal indicator with $\widetilde{\text{Post}}_{st} = \mathbf{1}\{w_{st} \geq k\}$ —sliding the treatment cutoff to a pre-scandal day—and re-estimate Equation 1 on the $\pm T$ event window. Gray circles are the resulting placebo coefficients $\hat{\beta}(k)$ plotted against k ; the solid red line is the observed $\hat{\beta}$, the non-apex-subsample violent estimate at the $\pm T$ window; the legend gives the rank of the observed estimate among the placebos and the two-sided p -value. The four panels correspond to $T \in \{30, 60, 90, 120\}$ days. Standard errors clustered at country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.

Figure S34. Placebo test, Non-Apex subsample: peaceful protests.

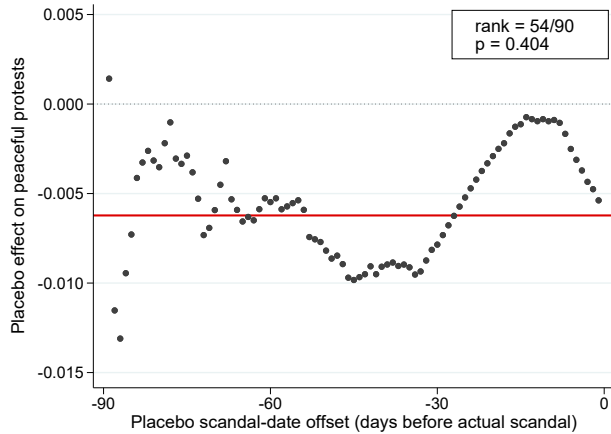
(a) ± 30 -day window.



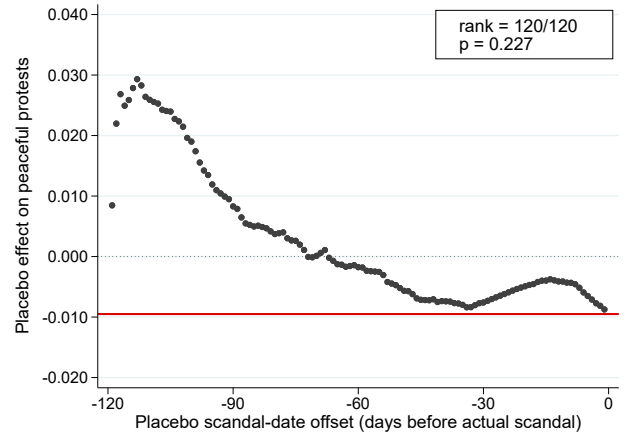
(b) ± 60 -day window.



(c) ± 90 -day window.



(d) ± 120 -day window.



Enumerated pre-scandal cutoff placebo test for peaceful protests on the Non-Apex subsample (113 scandals). For each offset $k \in \{-T + 1, \dots, -1\}$ we replace the true post-scandal indicator with $\widetilde{\text{Post}}_{st} = \mathbf{1}\{w_{st} \geq k\}$ —sliding the treatment cutoff to a pre-scandal day—and re-estimate Equation 1 on the $\pm T$ event window. Gray circles are the resulting placebo coefficients $\hat{\beta}(k)$ plotted against k ; the solid red line is the observed $\hat{\beta}$, the non-apex-subsample peaceful estimate at the $\pm T$ window; the legend gives the rank of the observed estimate among the placebos and the two-sided p -value. The four panels correspond to $T \in \{30, 60, 90, 120\}$ days. Standard errors clustered at country $\times$ year $\times$ day-bin. Sample period 2008–2018; Venezuela excluded.